

*A.A. Takes Its Inventory—
The General Service Conference Structure*

THE FORTY-THIRD ANNUAL MEETING
OF THE GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS

*1993
Final Report*

Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York, NY, April 18–24

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Confidential—full names used

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This usage—to facilitate communication within the Fellowship—was approved by the 1975 Conference. Such confidential use does not, of course, violate in any way our Tradition of anonymity in *public* communications media (press, radio, TV, etc.).



43RD GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE

A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure

The time period from April 1992 to April 1993 may well be known throughout the A.A. Fellowship as "the year of the inventory." Since the 42nd Conference picked the theme for the 43rd Conference: "A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure," A.A. entities throughout the U.S./Canada service structure have been making "a searching and fearless moral inventory . . ."—of groups, areas, districts, area service committees, the General Service Board, and A.A.W.S. and Grapevine Boards, as well as the G.S.O. and GV staffs. These inventories have been summarized and printed in area, district and intergroup newsletters, shared with others by mail, fax and one-on-one.

Then, April 18–23, members of the 43rd U.S./Canada General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous met at the Holiday Inn Crowne Plaza, New York City, to share their experience, strength and hope of the past year.

Just what is this Conference? Who are its members? What do they do all week? How would we explain it to a newcomer?

The annual General Service Conference has often been described as not unlike the average A.A. group business meeting—only longer, involving more issues, and often louder.

General service trustee Stanley Silverman said it is where "all my character defects are challenged," and went on to relate that during a heated floor argument a delegate turned to him and said, in identification, "Hey, this is just like a barroom brawl."

The Conference reminds Gene Benson, delegate from the state of Oklahoma, of an old Indian legend: A group of Indians sat in a circle with an eagle feather, representing the Truth, in the center. Each Indian was asked to describe the feather, and each saw it a different way and from an individual point of view—but the Truth never changes.

Who goes to the Conference? The 133 Conference members are delegates from the 91 service areas of the U.S. and Canada, 21 trustees (14 alcoholic and 7 nonalcoholic) of the General Service Board, plus directors of the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members.

This year, the average age of a delegate was 54 years, with the oldest being 75 and the youngest 34 years; average length of sobriety was 15 years, longest sobriety 35 years and shortest 6 years. In regard to service, the average length of time was 12 years, the longest being 30 and shortest 4 years.

What happens at the Conference? The week is long and full, usually beginning at 9:00 a.m. (sometimes earlier) and going until 9:00 or 10:00 in the evening (with some committees meeting into the small hours of the morning).

The 43rd Conference was officially opened Sunday morning with the calling of the roll by G.S.O.'s general manager, George Dorsey, followed by details of the week's activities outlined by G.S.O. Conference coordinator Pat Rosenstiel, and greetings from the delegate chair, Elaine Strome, of Alberta/Northwest Territories. The keynote address was given by East Central regional trustee Jan Whitney.

Sunday evening is a time of fellowship and seeing old friends, and many past trustees, former delegates, and friends of A.A. arrived at the hotel ballroom for the opening dinner. An open A.A. meeting followed the dinner, chaired by Dick Brummel (Kansas); Dian Wright (S.W. Ohio) led the meeting. Speakers were Caroline Bradley (N.Y. Hudson/Mohawk/Berkshire), Chago Rodriguez (Puerto Rico), David O'Leary (trustee-at-large/Canada), Michael McPherson (A.A.W.S. director) and Joanie Moncrief (G.S.O. staff).

Monday morning the Conference, co-chaired this year by Class A (nonalcoholic) chairman of the board Michael Alexander and George Dorsey, G.S.O.'s general manager, began with

board and committee reports. Monday through Wednesday afternoons the eleven standing Conference committees met to discuss agenda items (see Committee and Staff Reports, p. 33) and prepare their recommendations to the entire Conference body. Many of these recommendations resulted in Conference Advisory Actions (see page 13).

Throughout the week the agenda included area highlights, by new Panel 43 delegates (page 57); workshops (page 11); sharing sessions; and presentations/discussions (page 17).

Tuesday evening, at the Delegates Only Meeting, Diane Watson, California, Northern Coastal Area, was elected delegate chair for the 1994 Conference; Lois Concelman, Western Pennsylvania, will serve as alternate chair.

In the past year a delegate's Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions met several times. The committee's report and recommendations were presented to the Conference, and appear here on page 9.

Trustee elections were held Wednesday afternoon. Gay Garner of Decatur, Georgia, will replace Jacqueline Martin as the new trustee from the Southeast Region. Donald Watson of Kalamazoo, Michigan, will be the new East Central Regional trustee, replacing Jan Whitney. Larry Nelson of Imperial Beach, California, will become the new trustee-at-large/U.S., filling the position now held by John Quinn. Jane Schulberg, of New York, will replace Stanley Silverman as Grapevine general service trustee and Harold Greene will be replaced on the A.A.W.S. board by new general service trustee Michael McPherson.

Three Class A (nonalcoholic) trustees also rotated at the end of the 43rd Conference. Michael Alexander, elected chairman of the General Service Board in 1988, will retire after many years of service to the Fellowship. Mike served as trustee from 1976 to 1985, and returned as chairman in 1988. The new chairman will be W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr., of El Dorado Hills, California. Jim, too, is no stranger to A.A. service, having served as trustee from 1977 to 1986. Robert Morse, board treasurer, who was elected in 1984, will be replaced by Gary Glynn of New York. For reasons of health, Amos Reed, Class A trustee from 1986, took an early rotation. Amos' position on the board will not be filled this year.

"Meetings, meetings, meetings . . ." is a mantra instilled in every A.A. from the minute they walk through the doors—so deeply that it becomes as natural as breathing. So, many Conference members started the day at 7:30 at the G.S.O. Serenity Group. The delegate from Alaska, O.B. Culley, chaired; John Curtin, Maryland, served as secretary/treasurer. The theme each morning was based on a reading from an A.A. book. In keeping with A.A.'s Seventh Tradition of self-support, the basket was passed each morning, and at the end of the week a contribution was made to the General Service Office.

Friday before Conference a group of delegates from the Pacific region set out for a meeting of New York's Kips Bay Group. They arrived early (or maybe they just got the time wrong) and were there to greet the group members and help set up.

Western New York delegate Terry Wymer ended each day (as he did the year before) with the midnight meeting at New York's Alanon House, which he referred to as his "home group away from home group." But, outside of the general session room and committee meeting rooms, the coffee pot was always on—as it is wherever A.A.s gather.

A group of A.A. and Al-Anon volunteers provided activities throughout the week for spouses and friends who had accompanied delegates to New York. And, because many delegates arrived a few days early, a hospitality suite was provided by

the Intergroup Association of Alcoholics Anonymous of New York. Here, too, the coffee pot was always on and local A.A. volunteers were available to provide information and basic A.A. sharing and fellowship.

During breaks on Tuesday and Thursday, delegates could attend a presentation of a computer software package, demonstrated by Bob Gregson and Bill Brennan, nonalcoholic employees of the General Service Office. This software package will enable areas with the necessary equipment to review their group records, extracted from G.S.O.'s mainframe.

Friday afternoon the Conference officially closed in the usual way, with the Serenity Prayer—in English, French and Spanish.

Saturday morning members of the Conference met for the closing brunch and talks by rotating trustees. Michael Alexander addressed the group for the last time as chairman of the board, culminating an association with Alcoholics Anonymous that began when he was a young lawyer—over 40 years ago. Mike's overwhelming emotion, he said, was one of gratitude, "for every man, woman and child, past, present and future, each of whom has formed the fabric of this Fellowship." Like the butterfly theory, "the act of any member may raise currents that might turn the tide of A.A."

Farewell talks from rotating trustees followed: regional trustees Jacqueline Martin (Southeast) and Jan Whitney (West Central); general service trustees Harold Greene and Stanley Silverman; and trustee-at-large/U.S. John Quinn. Each in turn expressed gratitude and appreciation for having had the opportunity to serve.

Two rotating Class A trustees were unable to attend, but each sent a message. Robert Morse wrote that when he joined the board nine years ago he had "no children and no gray hair"; now he has "three children and a full head of gray." During the time he served as treasurer he saw the "greatest surpluses and greatest deficits." Bob is a second generation Class A trustee, following his late father, Robert Morse, Sr.

Amos Reed's message read, in part, "I continue to be convinced that Alcoholics Anonymous provides the best, and maybe the only way, for alcoholics to get their lives in order and to keep them in order as they work the program. . . . There is no substitute for self-responsibility coupled with loving group interaction (love) that combines humility with meaningful outreach to fellow sufferers. . . . The Higher Power's presence is essential."

As members of the 43rd Conference return to their areas, Bob Morse's words are particularly appropriate: "In some ways all of you are very lucky. While I rotate, I will be with you in spirit. When you leave here, you have the real benefit of rotating back to your groups, to the physical reality of service work. I will miss that."

The wives of Joe Sostarich, Panel 42 delegate from Kentucky, and Les Leuthaeuer, West Central regional trustee, both serve as Al-Anon trustees. Surely, there was a time when none of them would have believed that!

When Conference co-chairs, George and Mike, were taking a lunchtime walk they were approached by an elderly lady. She informed these two veteran Manhattanites, "Gentlemen, don't you know you should never wear your badges on the street. Muggers will know you're from out of town."

Greetings from Delegate Chairperson

Welcome to the 43rd General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous. Those of us assembled are indeed truly blessed by having this opportunity to serve as world servants of Alcoholics Anonymous. There are some dear friends from Panel 42 who are absent this year. May we, in our hearts, hold warm and loving memories of Paul Baatz, Area 87, who passed away suddenly, and for fellow delegates who, for personal reasons, have been unable to continue. We welcome and give loving support to the alternate delegates. May we all pray for guidance as we gather in unity, under the grace of a loving God.

This Conference will mark the end of a long, dedicated service commitment by our retiring chairman of the board, Class A trustee Michael Alexander. To Michael and all rotating Class A and Class B trustees, may I say, we love you and will surely miss you. To our dear friend, Class A trustee Amos Reed, retiring due to illness, our love and prayers are with you. May you all enjoy the journey of life—One Day at a Time.

The theme for this year's Conference, "A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure," has, since last Conference, lead to new insights and awareness for individual members, groups, districts, areas, Conference and trustees' committees, and General Service and Grapevine Offices. We have in a sense, taken our own Fourth Step. The results and continued sharing this week may be considered our Fifth Step, revealing our attitudes, actions and direction. Who we are, what we are and where we are going.

May we as a Conference be entirely willing to listen, discern, and act when necessary, ever mindful of His will for us, expressed through humility. Humility, as expressed by a newmember, is being "right sized," as individuals and as Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole. Let us always keep in mind our "right size," "right place" and "right purpose" in the world. I believe that Alcoholics Anonymous is one of the greatest forces for good that exists in the world today as long as we stay focused on our primary purpose and stay right sized. As individual members, through the grace of God, we are uniquely qualified to carry the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic, by sharing our experience, strength and hope. May we never stray from this purpose. This week, everything shared, all decisions made, should always focus on our primary purpose, for that is our reason for existing.

As we progress through this week, take comfort in the fact that we can trust the committee system. As we share together, there will be times of disagreement and frustration, but there will also be times of unity, joy and accomplishment. Hang onto that trust, it always works.

In quoting Concept Twelve, Warranty Six, last two paragraphs:

"Freedom under God to grow in His likeness and image will ever be the quest of Alcoholics Anonymous. May our General Service Conference be always seen as a chief symbol of this cherished liberty.

"To a man, we of A.A. believe that our freedom to serve is truly the freedom by which we live—the freedom in which we have our being." (*Twelve Concepts for World Service*, p. 74)

May God be with us as we serve.

*Elaine Strome (Alberta/Northwest Territories)
delegate chairperson*

Keynote Address

How many of the following topics sound relevant to the issues of today in Alcoholics Anonymous: unity, our primary purpose, trustees and Conference committees, proliferation of A.A. literature, the blurred lines of authority and responsibility, principles before personalities?

As a matter of fact, these were the very concerns of a previous gathering of trusted servants. The gathering—the 31st General Service Conference; the year—1981; the theme—“A.A. Takes Its Inventory.”

There is nothing new about what you are going to hear in this address. What’s amazing is that the message herein has stood the test of time and will continue to serve us supremely well as long as we honor that message.

When the theme for our 43rd General Service Conference, “A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure,” hit the bricks of our Fellowship during the past year, an awesome wave of self-examination rippled throughout Alcoholics Anonymous. During my A.A. travels, groups, districts, areas, service conferences and central offices/intergroups were taking their inventories. Just like all those A.A. “rules” of yesterday, the results of taking stock were “as broad as the continent.” However, one common thread was woven throughout—that of practicing spiritual principles through our Twelve Traditions.

I am confident that as this Conference unfolds and finally unfurls on Saturday morning, our spiritual principles will be well defined. Our deliberations will have been reached by communicating our diverse opinions with each other, perhaps with some heated debate. That’s as it should be. It’s been said that if there were only two alcoholics and they were both alike, one would be unnecessary.

We will have made a searching and fearless moral group inventory of ourselves. Of course, this means we must then admit to ourselves, our Higher Power and to each other the exact nature of our wrongs. To err is human, but to admit it is not. However, swallowing our pride occasionally will never give us indigestion. On the plus side, our reward for doing good work is the ability to do better.

Our evaluation of the General Service Conference structure will undoubtedly address some issues that were envisioned by Bill Wilson some 30 years ago. As stated in the introduction to the *Twelve Concepts for World Service*, “Quite rightly, each new generation of A.A. world servants will be eager to make operational improvements. Unforeseen flaws in the present structure will doubtless show up later on. New service needs and problems will arise that make structural changes necessary. Such alterations should certainly be effected, and these contingencies squarely met.”

Bill goes on to explain that if we find ill-advised departures from the Concepts have been made, our past experiences are still recorded therein, providing a safe haven of return. Further into the introduction we read, “Concern has been expressed lest the detailed portrayal of our internal structure might not later harden down into such a firm tradition or gospel that necessary changes would be impossible to make. Nothing could stray further from the intent of these Concepts. The future advocates of structural change need only make out a strong case for their recommendations—a case convincing to both the Trustees and to the Conference.”

During past Conferences we have discussed the number of delegate areas, the ratio of Class A and Class B trustees on the board, the roles of trustees and re-regionalization.

If we are to reach right decisions in these areas, we must first have cleared away the wreckage of the past, so to speak.

The chapter “Into Action” from *Alcoholics Anonymous* tells us that after the Eighth and Ninth Steps we are going to be amazed to find that we have no regrets of the past nor wish to shut the door on it. We will not seek personal gain. Our fears concerning economics will dissipate. We will intuitively know how to handle situations that used to baffle us. And that God, as we understand Him, is working for us and through us. This not only applies to us as individuals, but as a group as well. The Conference is an A.A. group.

The group, in order to arrive at a right decision, should be fully informed and willing to listen to the minority opinion. We will debate until we have substantial unanimity. In my opinion, substantial unanimity does not mean a 51 percent majority. Sometimes in A.A. even a two-thirds majority will not do.

I can remember when I was a delegate standing before the microphone with my heart in my throat challenging the “Challenge of the Seventh Tradition.” I have had the experience of taking the minority side as a trustee also. I remember my Aunt Gustie saying, “It’s not just the things we do that we regret; it’s sometimes the things we do not do.” I knew I had been chosen to “do the job.” So courage overtook fear and I spoke my conscience. Perhaps the vote did not go my way, but I didn’t go home *wishing* I had spoken up. Courage, to me, doesn’t mean the absence of fear, but “going through with it” in spite of fear.

It is important to remember that all members of the Conference are equals—that there are no inferiors or superiors. We are democratic in thought and action. If you have any doubts, try reading the Warranties of the Twelfth Concept just one more time!

This from the Conference Charter:

“General Warranties of the Conference: In all its proceedings, the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition, taking great care that the Conference never becomes the seat of perilous wealth or power; that sufficient operating funds, plus an ample reserve, be its prudent financial principle; that none of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others; that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy; that though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in thought and action.” (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S34)

A leader in A.A. is sometimes categorized as either a “politico” or a statesman. In *The Language of the Heart* (p. 288) Bill describes a politico as “. . . an individual who is forever trying to ‘get the people what they want.’ A statesman is an individual who can carefully discriminate when, and *when not* to do this.”

This Conference is all about seeking the group conscience of this body with our Higher Power permeating our thoughts, words and deeds, thus leading us to right decisions for A.A. as a whole. Maybe the right decision will be not to make a decision on a given matter at this time. A.A. is never in a hurry. However, when the truth keeps staring us in the face and procrastination is exercised in the name of prudence, then we are shirking our responsibilities. Winston Churchill brings home an excellent point; he said, “Too often when men stumble over the truth, they tend to pick themselves up and hurry off as if nothing happened.” This is not to say that prudence should



be tossed to the wind. Prudence is of monumental importance in all our affairs. The Twelve Traditions (long form) are the finely tuned attributes of discretion, careful judgment and forethought.

Where are we now and where are we going? In a way, we are at the turning point. Those who have gone before us have thus far guided us safely through our most adventurous uncharted waters, avoiding most pitfalls, stopping short of slipping over the cascading falls. Through rotation, there is always a changing of the guard. That which we are guarding, the Twelve Steps, Twelve Traditions and Twelve Concepts, never change. We, at this Conference, are on watch at this particular moment. My part is to *improve* the present moment.

We are, most assuredly, making it possible for the Twelfth Step to flow serenely and without fanfare to remote places on this planet, to enter the lions' den, the penthouse, and the dark alley. A.A. is a spirit. It can neither be touched nor completely understood. It is as wide as the world, yet small enough to fit snugly into the hearts and minds of man. It has given love of truth, love of life, with enough left over to share with each other.

Little did Albert Einstein know how truly his words would reflect the principles of our General Service Conference and the highest form of A.A. communication—the touching of souls when one drunk talks to another. He stated, "Vision is having an acute sense of the possible. It is seeing what others do not see. And when those with similar vision are drawn together, something extraordinary occurs." (I must admit, I took this quote from a T-shirt I saw somewhere in Ohio.)

This 43rd General Service Conference will be addressing the present structure with a vision toward the future structure of Conferences. Bill Wilson wrote in a February 1961 Grapevine article: "Perhaps our very first realization should be that we can't stand still. Now that our basic principles seem established, now that our functioning is fairly effective and widespread, it would be temptingly easy to settle down as merely one more useful agency on the world scene. We could conclude that 'A.A. is fine, just the way it is.' . . . We know that the price of such self-satisfaction is an inevitable backslide, punctured at some point by a very rude awakening. . . . For us, the 'status quo' can only be for today, never for tomorrow. Change we must; we cannot stand still." (*The Language of the Heart*, p. 321)

"As we now enter upon the next great phase of A.A.'s life, let us therefore, rededicate ourselves to an even greater responsibility for our general welfare. Let us continue to take our inventory as a Fellowship, searching out our flaws and confessing them freely. Let us devote ourselves to the repair of all faulty relations that may exist, whether within or without.

"And above all, . . . let us, at any cost or sacrifice, so improve our communication with all these that they may find what we have found—a new life of freedom under God." (*ibid*, p. 322)

Once again, we, the Conference members, are meeting to carry on with the master's plan for Alcoholics Anonymous. I trust that, deep within each of us, we hear that still, small voice that's saying "Let it begin with me."

Jan Whitney, East Central regional trustee

Report of the Meeting of The Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions

Tuesday afternoon the Conference listened to the report of the Ad Hoc Committee, which was read by the delegate chairperson. After lengthy discussion on the Conference floor Tuesday and Thursday, Conference members adopted committee recommendations A and B, resulting in Advisory Actions 2 and 3 (see p. 13). Recommendations C and D were not accepted. Recommendation E was withdrawn by the committee, given the fact that C and D were not adopted by the Conference.

Late Friday afternoon, during a final Sharing Session, the Chips and Medallions subject came up again. Following more floor discussion, general service trustee Jean Smith made the following statement to the Conference:

The A.A.W.S. Board will immediately begin a thorough review of its policies regarding our marks, will do everything possible to avoid initiating litigation, and will prepare a revised policy statement to be ready for next year's Conference.

The Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions met throughout the weekend of February 12-14, 1993, in Chicago. The committee was drawn from the hat in December and is composed of one delegate from each region plus the delegate chairperson, who chairs the committee. The committee secretary from G.S.O. joined us at our request.

From the outset, the committee members were of one mind about how to proceed. Although we had a legal opinion available, we felt that the questions posed were spiritual in nature, and that the framework of the discussion should be centered on the Steps, the Traditions and the Concepts. Over the course of the weekend, members of the committee realized that the issues involved in the study concerning medallions and logos were spiritual in nature.

After general sharing, we took each Tradition (Long Form) and the Warranties as the basis for our discussion on the protection of our trademarks and service marks relative to production of items such as sobriety chips/medallions. We felt that sharing in this manner deepened our understanding of the Traditions and Warranties involved.

We began to see that the issue is "What is best for A.A. as a whole," and not "Does the Fellowship want A.A. sobriety chips/medallions?" or "Can A.A. produce sobriety chips/medallions?" The committee did not focus on the use of sobriety chips/medallions—groups and individuals are free to use them if they wish. The question is whether it is best for A.A. as a whole to have a sobriety chip/medallion with the A.A. name on it authorized and/or issued by an A.A. entity.

Some of the comments made during the Traditions part of the discussion included:

The First Tradition—At the heart of the matter is unity—or the lack thereof. Pride and/or fear will destroy our unity.

The Second Tradition—Therein lies our solution. Where is our ultimate authority and where is our center? Is it internal or external—principles arising from a power greater than people, or values of the world? We must keep in mind that this is also the place where Bill W. points out that "...the good is sometimes the enemy of the best."

The Third Tradition—We were reminded that we are a self-correcting Fellowship. We cannot be all things to all people. The committee needed to root itself in the principles of Alcoholics Anonymous. We felt that it is time for the whole Fellowship to get back to the simplicity and basis of our message. On one side of the coin is a loving God as we understand Him, and on the other side is John Barleycorn.

The Fourth Tradition makes it clear that we must separate the spiritual from the material. Keeping in mind that any action we

take could affect A.A. as a whole...the Traditions work as a whole... all of them must be honored. From page 105 in *A.A. Comes of Age*, ... "When all the chips are down, we must conform to God's will or perish."

The Fifth Tradition—The Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, *The Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions*, *A.A. Comes of Age*, and "The Twelve Concepts for World Service"—are the basic message, the core message of A.A. Everything else is commentary on the basic message: all literature published, comments and sharing at meetings, even the Grapevine, is a sort of national commentary—could chips/medallions be another form of commentary, another "form" of a pamphlet?

The Sixth Tradition calls on us to "divide the spiritual from the material." Money is not a valid consideration in the question of whether or not litigation should be brought against misusers of our logo since A.A. is not in the business of making money. Similarly, the fear that others would be making money off our logo does not hurt the Fellowship on a fundamental level. How do we let go of this tiger we have by the tail? ... We are at the tip of the iceberg of litigation right now. We are at the place where the trustees were when they were offered that \$10,000. We went many, many years without lawsuits. To continue on this path threatens to keep our focus on money and property instead of allowing our view to widen spiritually.

The Seventh Tradition—reminds us "Experience has often warned us that nothing can so surely destroy our spiritual heritage as futile disputes over property, money and authority."

The Eleventh Tradition—explicitly warns against the sensationalism that follows litigation. It is essentially negative attention and puts the Fellowship at risk.

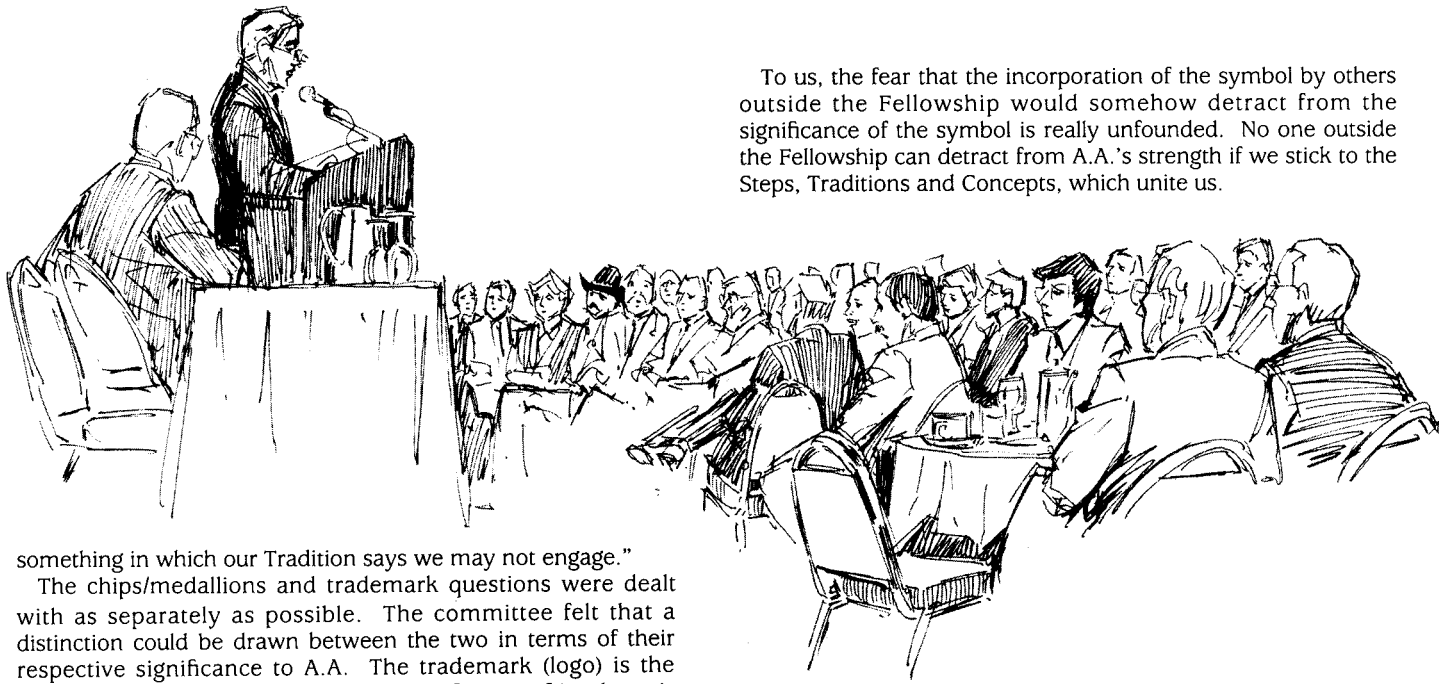
The Twelfth Tradition—Humility is the key, working from the internal to the external, from the smaller to the larger, from "I" to "We," in a spirit of humility and trust. What course of action will keep us on the path of spirituality? If we treat trademark abuses like we do anonymity breaks, would that serve to preserve us in spiritual health? We trust God every day for our lives...isn't trusting realistic?

The committee spent a great length of time in the discussion of the Warranties. Warranty Five states:

"Practically all societies and governments feel it necessary to inflict personal punishment upon individual members for violations of their beliefs, principles or laws. Because of its special situation, Alcoholics Anonymous finds this practice unnecessary. When we of A.A. fail to follow sound spiritual principles, alcohol cuts us down. Therefore, no humanly administered system of penalties is needed. This unique condition is an enormous advantage to us all, one on which we can fully rely and one which we should never abandon by a resort to the methods of personal attack and punishment..."

"In case the A.A. name should be misapplied...it would of course be the duty of our General Service Conference to press for the discontinuance of such a practice—always short, however, of public quarreling about the matter....It was recognized that a public lawsuit is a public controversy,





To us, the fear that the incorporation of the symbol by others outside the Fellowship would somehow detract from the significance of the symbol is really unfounded. No one outside the Fellowship can detract from A.A.'s strength if we stick to the Steps, Traditions and Concepts, which unite us.

something in which our Tradition says we may not engage."

The chips/medallions and trademark questions were dealt with as separately as possible. The committee felt that a distinction could be drawn between the two in terms of their respective significance to A.A. The trademark (logo) is the embodiment of the A.A. name. The significance of its shape is described in *A.A. Comes of Age*, page 139: "The circle stands for the whole world of A.A., and the triangle stands for A.A.'s Three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service....The priests and seers of antiquity regarded the circle enclosing the triangle as a means of warding off spirits of evil, and A.A.'s circle and triangle of Recovery, Unity, and Service has certainly meant all of that to us and much more."

Medallions, on the other hand, are not universally considered an embodiment of the Fellowship as such. Many stories are told about the role that the coins play in an individual's continuing sobriety; the coins act as symbolic recognition of the length of sobriety. They are not the sobriety itself and any attempt to make medallions more than a symbol may lead perilously towards ego-inflation, self-glorification, rather than ego-deflation (see Tradition Twelve).

The committee felt that the desire to protect the unique meaning of A.A.'s symbol is at the foundation of litigation, as well as the fear of the trivialization of the mark. But despite the vehemence with which we feel "ownership" of the symbol, we suspect that the belief that we (or anyone) can "possess" the symbol is a fallacy.

It actually works against the foundation of the Steps that lead us to sobriety. Ownership necessarily involves control and to argue over that control through litigation takes the focus away from the fact that we are ultimately powerless. We can own the meaning of the symbol, and if someone uses the graphic, our meaning will not be diminished, as long as we keep the principles it represents in sight.

The committee finally questioned the goals of litigation, what would actually be gained from a lawsuit. We suspect that the harm done internally as a result of litigation would be far worse than the harm others could do to our "property" from the outside. At the base of this approach is the trust that is the foundation of A.A. It is our trust that A.A. principles will work to protect our name, just as our trust in God is the foundation of our program and of our lives. Warranty Five says that we can "...confidently trust A.A. opinion, public opinion, and God Himself to take care of Alcoholics Anonymous..."

Concept Seven states, "[The] Charter itself is not a legal document...it relies instead upon the force of tradition...for its final effectiveness."

The registered trademarks, service marks and logos are symbols of our spiritual Fellowship, Alcoholics Anonymous, and should be treated as such.

The General Service Conference is a living entity. From the group conscience will eventually emerge an expression of the will of a loving Power greater than ourselves proven to be firmly linked to the Traditions and Warranties, keeping us safe for as long as we are needed.

The committee *recommends* that:

- a) In agreement with the consensus of the 1958 General Service Conference, the use of sobriety chips/medallions is a matter for local autonomy and not one on which the Conference should record a definite position in behalf of the movement.
 - b) It is not appropriate for A.A.W.S. Inc., or Grapevine, Inc., to produce or license the production of sobriety chips/medallions.
 - c) The Conference find that the initiative of litigation involving trademarks and service marks is a violation of Warranty Five.
 - d) The General Service Board take the steps necessary to bring all policies and practices into conformity with the spirit of the Warranties and the report and recommendations of the 1993 Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions.
 - e) The General Service Board develop a *new* policy statement on the "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" (*A.A. Service Manual*, p.S103) that reflects the spirit of the committee's report and recommendations, and report back to the 44th General Service Conference on the policy and its implementation.
- The committee requests that the complete report of the Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions be printed in the *Final Report* of the 43rd General Service Conference.
- The committee also requests that all Conference members receive copies of the new policy statement on or before February 15, 1994 along with a copy of the 1993 Ad Hoc Committee's report and recommendations.

*Elaine Strome, Alberta/Northwest Territories
Conference delegate chairperson*

Workshop I A.A. Takes Its Inventory

Sunday Conference members split up into groups of 12 to 14 for a workshop discussion based on the Conference theme. Following are the workshop questions and a summary of the report backs.

1 Are only "matters seriously affecting A.A.'s worldwide needs . . ." the subject of consideration by the Conference?

Conference members agreed overall that A.A. in the U.S. and Canada affects the rest of the world. This fact carries its own assets and liabilities: on the downside there's sometimes a reluctance to see that a number of "trivial" items come up for consideration that don't help A.A. worldwide; on the other hand, an honest scrutiny of local needs can lead to Conference consideration of certain items that could have a positive effect on A.A. in other countries. For example, the "alcoholic-addict" issue affects A.A. as a whole; the use of medallions does not. "Less developed countries look to us as 'sponsors,' so our decisions become far-reaching worldwide," one Conference member wrote.

A.A.s might ask themselves: "Is this service necessary? Let's protect A.A. as a whole." Taking periodic inventories on what is important could sift out agenda items that are really only of local importance. Whatever affects A.A. worldwide—and much does—A.A.'s primary purpose should always be the key in considering Conference items.

2 How is participation in your area? If it is good, how did it get that way? If it is poor, how did it get that way and what can be done?

The consensus was that participation is going "pretty well." But it's always true that things could be improved and what seems to be needed, in all areas, is better communication—up and down the line, among those doing service. Tapping the services of "all service people, past and present," is helpful. We should try to encourage enthusiasm for service, and a variety of tools for this purpose are available: G.S.R. schools; workshops on service (one delegate spoke of "A Journey into Third Legacy Workshops"); promoting delegates' visits to as many districts as possible; paying D.C.M.s' travel expenses; planning "exciting agenda items." One district's rebuilding technique is to hold two conventions each year, at opposite geographical ends from each other; another uses "cluster meetings"—making sure that some are held where "the action is weaker."

Poor attendance at assemblies, a result of a lack of understanding of general service (as opposed to more popular service on conventions), can be counteracted by a variety of ways, including sponsorship of new members; taking an "aggressive approach toward making D.C.M.s into a more solid unit, as this is where the action is." District meetings might be put in areas where "action" is weak. Distributing workshop questions early also helps a lot. Area committees should share group problems so that G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s are informed. The bottom line, as one delegate put it, is: "If you want people in service, you better make service interesting."

3 The Charter states that area assemblies are concerned only with the world service affairs of Alcoholics Anonymous. Is this true in your area? Is two-way communication (group to district to area to General Service Conference to area to district to group) alive and well?

As one delegate put it, "Most areas are concerned with affairs worldwide, but they're *more* interested in items that affect their particular areas." Still others reported taking up

"every subject imaginable." As to two-way communication, responses ranged from "fairly good, needs improvement," to "getting better," to "not alive and well at all."

To meet the latter challenge—improved communication—much can, and is, being done. Flyers, newsletters, personal letters and telephone calls are some of the ways to keep channels open, as well as the use of an 800 number, and remembering to carry "with enthusiasm" the message to groups and back again. "An informed group conscience is important," said one delegate. It's crucial that delegates understand the importance of informing and reaching as many groups as possible with what is happening at all levels of service. All of the above would contribute to improving the frequently small attendance at assemblies by members who often are turned off by "petty details."

4 Does your area use the "Third Legacy Procedure" in electing area committee members and delegates?

With few exceptions, participants reported using this procedure "virtually all the time" for delegates, and often for some area committee members, as well. Most reported that committee members were generally appointed by elected servants and/or with the approval of their assemblies.

5 How can Conference members and other service workers learn to be trusted servants and not "politicos"?

When this problem occurs, the Fellowship's time-tested experience of serving selflessly will eventually put it to rights. "Once individuals are involved, the Fellowship has a way of reminding them that they are trusted servants," one participant said. A "politico" mentality often emerges among newcomers to service, but work and "rubbing shoulders" with Conference members and other service workers teaches them the lesson that *all* A.A.s learn: to keep principles above personalities. Nonetheless, it makes sense to elect individuals who practice these principles already; they will inspire trust and lead by example.

Following Third Legacy procedures "takes care of politics and allows our Higher Power to take over," one participant said. "Avoid using political language," wrote another, "and stop putting trusted servants on a different level." In the final



analysis, politics recedes naturally when A.A. Traditions and guidelines are followed, when humility is practiced on a daily basis, and when trusted servants remember to “walk the walk.” “Trust yourself, you will be trusted.”

Workshop II A Vision for Us— Where Are We and Where Are We Going?

The second workshop took place on Wednesday, over lunch. As the Fellowship takes its inventory in the present, what are the areas it needs to look at, improve and/or reinforce in order to maintain our co-founder Bill W.’s vision? Participants suggested some of the following:

Focus on Newcomers

- There are many young people coming into the Fellowship; they *can* be the promise of A.A.’s growth in the future;
- Let’s remember to show tolerance and understanding. Our aim is to be “inclusive not exclusive”;
- We want to keep them informed of our Traditions, raise their awareness;
- Emphasize individual responsibility—“Let it begin with me”;
- We must remember to keep taking our inventory;
- Combat misinformation about A.A. that newcomers have received elsewhere.

Remembering our Primary Purpose

- Several participants asked: “Are we trying to do too much?”
- Let’s be aware of the difference between successful, time-tested A.A. practices and the “new and trendy,” and choose the former;
- In spite of the impact on A.A. of dually addicted members, let’s “not forget the wet drunk.”

Service

- There seems to be a “movement afoot toward a return to a greater spirituality,” so let’s capitalize on it;
- It’s time to reemphasize the importance of “individual sacrifice” for the good of the whole;
- “We are the stewards for those who follow,” so let us practice A.A. principles a day at a time, in the present. Where we’re going “will then take care of itself”;
- Are we spending more time on material concerns instead of spiritual ones?



Stick With the Basics

- Our Twelve Steps and Traditions are our foundation;
- Let’s keep alive the importance of the Twelfth Step call and the value to sobriety that comes from one alcoholic sharing with another;
- Effective sponsorship is “needed at all levels.”

Protect A.A. Unity

- Our unity is “our strongest asset.” This needs to be kept in focus in spite of the flexibility A.A. will need in facing change and the future;
- Watch out for “areas of service sprouting their own too-independent wings,” this could hurt A.A.’s unity in the future.

Traditions: Know and Practice Them

- A full understanding of Tradition Two reminds us where the Fellowship’s power lies;
- Keep treatment facilities informed about how our Traditions unite us;
- Urge groups to regularly hold Traditions, as well as Step, meetings.

Literature

- Put more A.A. literature in public view in book stores and other areas accessible to people who “don’t go to central offices”;
- Suggest that A.A. groups start lending libraries of A.A. literature.

A.A.’s continued growth and success in the future will depend in part on how well we face now whatever remaining doubts we have concerning Tradition Three and dually addicted members. The following are some points raised by Workshop participants:

- We have a responsibility in explaining Tradition Three to the new person who may be dually addicted. Regarding A.A.’s future, we might ask ourselves: how many “true alcoholics” will there be in twenty-five years?
- “Dual addiction need not be a problem if we adhere to the Traditions.”
- The Fellowship “needs to clarify and strengthen its identity so that the word ‘drug’ is not fearful.”
- We can attract (instead of promote) dually addicted new members to A.A. just as easily as the alcoholic.
- “Alcoholism” is the one thing that “binds and unifies us so we can carry our message effectively.”

Regarding the Fellowship’s future, the consensus was that, because A.A. is “growing so rapidly, we have to remain alert to, and keep up with, strains and challenges” as they arise. Above all, A.A. needs to protect its Steps and Traditions—“we have to do this for those alcoholics who will come to us in the future.”

On the other hand, we should “beware of fear of change.” Are we allowing ourselves to be too influenced by “outside sources” regarding where we are going? Are we keeping in mind that the Traditions are there to assure A.A.’s future for as long as God “might need us” (as Bill W. urged in his address at the first Oklahoma State Convention in 1951)?

John Sweeney (New Hampshire) admitted, somewhat shame-faced, that he had been in A.A. 12 years when it suddenly dawned on him that Victor E. was a metaphor for Victory (over booze, of course).

Sitting across the table, Mark Langsam (D.C.) looked at him in astonishment. “Good grief,” he moaned, “I’ve been sober for 18 years and I’ve just learned something.”

Conference Advisory Actions

Conference Advisory Actions represent recommendations made by the standing committees and approved by the Conference body as a whole, or recommendations discussed and voted on by all Conference members during general sessions. The group conscience of the Fellowship in the United States and Canada was expressed in the following Advisory Actions, which the General Service Board accepted in its legally required annual meeting following the Conference.

FLOOR ACTION

It was recommended that:

- 1 The General Service Office review the current practice of mailing label distribution and devise a new policy that will encompass the principle of anonymity.

AD HOC COMMITTEE ON CHIPS/MEDALLIONS*

It was recommended that:

- 2 In agreement with the consensus of the 1958 General Service Conference, the use of sobriety chips/medallions is a matter for local autonomy and not one on which the Conference should record a definite position in behalf of the movement.
- 3 It is not appropriate for A.A.W.S., Inc., or the A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to produce or license the production of sobriety chips/medallions.

AGENDA

It was recommended that:

- 4 The format of the A.A. meeting following the Opening Dinner of the 1994 General Service Conference be as follows: The chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee chair the meeting, with his or her duties limited to introducing the meeting leader and monitoring the time allotted by means of a light-timer system; and the alternate chairperson of the Conference Agenda Committee be leader of the meeting, introducing five speakers: one Class B trustee, two delegates, and two other A.A. members alternating from among the G.S.O. staff, Grapevine staff, archivist, and corporate boards.

- 5 The theme for the 1994 General Service Conference be: Spirit of Sacrifice.

- 6 The following be presentation/discussion topics for the 1994 General Service Conference:

- a) Spirit of Sacrifice: Bill's and Dr. Bob's Farewell Messages
 - 1 Bill's Message
 - 2 Dr. Bob's Message
- b) Spirit of Sacrifice in the Long Form of the Traditions:
 - 1 Traditions One, Two and Three
 - 2 Traditions Four, Five and Six
- c) Spirit of Sacrifice in the Long Form of the Traditions:
 - 1 Traditions Seven, Eight and Nine
 - 2 Traditions Ten, Eleven and Twelve

- 7 The following be the workshop for the 1994 General Service Conference: The Twelfth Step in Action:

- a) Where have we been?
- b) Where are we now?
- c) Where are we going?

* For the complete report of the Ad Hoc Committee, see p. 9.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

It was recommended that:

- 8 At the next printing of the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community" the following revisions be made:

- a) Change the heading "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" to "A.A. and Alcoholism."
- b) Delete the subheading "How A.A. Views Alcoholism" and change "Alcoholism is, in our opinion . . ." to "From the beginning, many A.A. members have come to believe alcoholism is a progressive illness—spiritual and emotional (or mental), as well as physical."

- 9 Because the phrase "A.A.'s position in the field of alcoholism" could imply a point of view or an opinion, consistency in our literature be maintained by changing that phrase wherever it appears in A.A. literature to "A.A. and Alcoholism" or similar wording that would remove the sense of a point-of-view or opinion when such material is due for reprint.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

No recommendations



FINANCE

It was recommended that:

- 10 Contributions from conferences, conventions, and round-ups not be limited to the maximum amount an individual may contribute in a given year, and in accordance with our Seventh Tradition, only funds from A.A. members attending the event should be contributed to support A.A. services.

- 11 In light of declining contributions, a new self-support pamphlet be prepared deleting the charts and percentages, stressing the spirit of the Seventh Tradition, Bill's vision of self-support, a brief history of A.A. finances, the G.S.R.'s responsibility concerning the financial needs within the service structure, visual aids and description of the various services provided throughout the structure. It is requested that a draft be sent

When Russell Cook (SE Texas) lived in Louisiana he sponsored a newcomer named Mike O'Connor, who is now Louisiana's delegate. Both are Panel 43 delegates.

to the 1993 Conference Finance Committee following the October 1993 trustees' Finance Committee meeting, and brought back to the 1994 Conference Finance Committee meeting for approval.

12 No change be made at this time to delegate fees, but in the spirit of self-support, areas are encouraged to make a contribution, if possible, to defray the average cost per delegate. This statement should be incorporated in the annual Conference notification to delegates of fees due.

GRAPEVINE

It was recommended that:

13 After considering 1992 Advisory Action #12 concerning the feasibility of a quarterly Spanish newsletter:

- a) The current policy of publishing monthly Grapevine articles in Spanish be reaffirmed;
- b) Because of staffing needs and other cost factors, a quarterly newsletter not be implemented at this time;
- c) Delegates and the Grapevine Corporate Board continue



to explore different ways of carrying the message to the Spanish community through Grapevine materials.

14 The Grapevine Corporate Board not actively pursue the placement of Grapevine materials for resale in commercial (non-A.A.) outlets.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

It was recommended that:

15 As at previous International Conventions, non-A.A. speakers be invited to participate at the 1995 International Convention, with the number not to exceed twenty-one people.

LITERATURE

It was recommended that:

16 A.A.W.S. produce an anonymity display card with the following verbiage:

"Anonymity is the spiritual foundation of all our Traditions. Please respect this and treat in confidence who you see and what you hear."

17 Because of strong sentiment against any changes in the first 164 pages of the Big Book, the request to rewrite the first

three chapters of the Big Book not be implemented.

18 The 1977 Advisory Action pertaining to the production of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book be reaffirmed:

"The publication of a facsimile of the first edition of the Big Book should not be undertaken as it would destroy the sentimental value of the actual first edition."

The committee further felt no need exists for such a book.

19 A.A.W.S. produce a pocket-sized version of the Big Book with all front matter (Preface and various forewords, Doctor's Opinion), basic text, Dr. Bob's Story and Appendices.

20 The A.A. history book project be deferred for two years so that a new team of A.A. servants can look at the history book with fresh ideas.

POLICY / ADMISSIONS

It was recommended that:

21 The alternate delegate from Area 62, South Carolina, George Rollins, be seated as a Conference member in place of the delegate, Joe McGarity, who is unable to attend.

22 The 46th General Service Conference be held April 21-27, 1996, since these dates do not conflict with any major religious holidays.

23 The area delegate term not be extended to three years, since the current two-year term offers a wider opportunity for service, and helps maintain continuity throughout the A.A. structure.

24 In response to the proposal to create a standing Conference Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums, the 1990 General Service Conference Action #30 be reaffirmed, as follows:

"There be a continuation of the Conference International Convention Ad Hoc Committee, which would also address issues of Regional Forums, through 1995. This committee, to be composed of one delegate from each region, could serve as the Site-Selection Committee for the International Convention in the year 2000. The committee suggests this recommendation be reviewed in 1995 by the Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions."

25 In response to the proposal to create a Conference Committee on Archives, the 1987 General Service Conference Action #45 be reaffirmed as follows:

"While the committee recognizes the need for and encourages the development of area Archives and Archives committees, with the resulting benefit to the General Service and the Fellowship as a whole, a Conference Archives Committee should not be formed at this time because the needs of local Archives committees are being well served by the trustees' Archives Committee and the General Service Office Archivist."

26 In order for groups/districts/areas to fully participate in the Conference process, the following steps be taken:

- a) Conference agenda items be submitted as early as possible but no later than January 15 each year.
- b) Final Conference committee agendas be automatically sent to all Conference members by February 15 each year.

- c) Background material for each specific committee be sent to its members by February 15 each year, with other committees' background material available upon request.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

It was recommended that:

27 The results contained in the final draft of the 1992 Membership Survey be applied to update the survey pamphlet, poster and one-way display.

28 The trustees' Public Information Committee undertake a thorough study, followed by a complete report that particularly addresses the need for, and the effectiveness of, A.A. Membership Surveys within the context of our *singleness of purpose*.

29 That each area delegate encourage discussions within all A.A. groups on the spiritual principles of Anonymity, including photographs, publications and posthumous Anonymity, as related to our Eleventh and Twelfth Traditions.

30 The radio public service announcement R-06 be discontinued as an inventory or catalog item, because these spots contain mixed messages about what A.A. is, and the A.A. message is better communicated in other radio spots.

31 The trustees' Subcommittee on Radio and Television Public Service Announcements carefully review the radio spots contained in R-09, with particular attention to spot #5, "We're All in This Together," and report back to the 1994 Conference Public Information Committee.

Conference Report and Charter Committee.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

It was recommended that:

34 In an effort to guide members more fully in understanding Twelfth Step activity with prospective members, the pamphlet "Bridging the Gap" be revised in two sections as follows:

In the section "Temporary Contact Guidelines"—

- a) "Keep in mind that this is basic Twelfth Step work.
- b) "Experience suggests that it is best to be accompanied by another A.A. member when meeting our newcomer. One of the two temporary contacts should have at least a year of sobriety.
- c) "Experience also suggests that men work with men and women work with women.
- d) "The intent is to provide the newcomer with your help for a limited time. You need not have experience with treatment facilities. Your qualifications are experience as an alcoholic and recovery in A.A.
- e) "It may be helpful for you as a temporary contact to attend workshops on bridging the gap and attend meetings of your area's hospital and/or treatment facilities committees."

The above would replace the following:

- a) "It is suggested that the temporary contact be sober one year or more.

- b) "Keep in mind that this is basic Twelfth Step work. The intent is to provide the newcomer with your help for a limited time. You need not have any experience with treatment facilities. Your qualifications are experience as an alcoholic and recovery in A.A. It may be helpful for you as a temporary contact to attend work-

shops on Bridging the Gap and be a member of your area's treatment facilities committee or hospital committee."



REPORT AND CHARTER

It was recommended that:

32 The following be added to the A.A. *Service Manual*: "To encourage participation of the maximum number of groups, some areas have incorporated linguistic districts within their structure. These districts usually have a bilingual D.C.M. or liaison. Their boundaries may be independent of the conventional district boundaries."

33 Information on alternate district structures be added to the 1994-95 A.A. *Service Manual*, and that the committee's background material be referred to Publications to write a revised section on districts for final approval by the 1994

In the section "Points to Remember"—

"A.A. does not provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or other welfare or social services.

"The professional treatment facility is in charge of its patients or clients and is responsible to them. While we cannot compromise our A.A. Traditions, we should remember that we are there as guests of the facility, and must abide by their rules. We are there to carry the A.A. message to the newcomer, and to answer any questions regarding the A.A. program of recovery and the A.A. way of life. Statements that may be interpreted as medical or psychological diagnosis or advice on medication should be avoided. We are there only to share our experience of staying away from one drink, one day at a time, through

the program of Alcoholics Anonymous.

"In many cases, months of hard work have gone into establishing a relationship which enables us to be invited into a facility. A careless action could destroy that trust and interfere with carrying the message. If problems arise, inform the local service committee. They may wish to present an A.A. informational meeting.

"No one speaks for A.A. as a whole. When we carry the A.A. message to those in treatment, we are just one drunk talking with another. How we look, act and talk may be all they are going to know about Alcoholics Anonymous. Since we may be seen as part of A.A., let our new friends see, hear and talk to a winner!"

The above would replace the following:

"A.A. does not provide housing, food, clothing, jobs, money or other welfare or social services.

"The professional treatment facility is in charge of its patients or clients and is responsible to them. If A.A. members do not conform in every way to the rules and regulations of the facility, it has a perfect right to keep A.A. members out. A.A. members go into treatment facilities as guests. Avoid statements or situations that may be interpreted as medical or psychological diagnosis or prognoses or advice on medications. Avoid challenging the teachings of the facility; guide the newcomer to A.A. membership and the A.A. way of life.

"Some of these suggestions may be strongly stated. In many cases, months of hard work have gone into establishing a relationship which enables us to be invited into a facility. A careless action could destroy that trust and interfere with carrying the message.

"When we carry the A.A. message to those in treatment, we are not just one drunk talking with another. While no one speaks for Alcoholics Anonymous as a whole, how we

look, act and talk may be all they are going to know about Alcoholics Anonymous. Since we may be seen as part of A.A., let our new friends see, hear and talk to a winner!"

35 Minor editorial changes in the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet be accepted.

36 A.A.W.S. consider production of an A.A. poster similar to the one used by an area P.I. committee.

37 A.A.W.S. explore the production of an inexpensive pamphlet holder of durable material that could hold up to four different pamphlets in a format which may be free-standing or wall-mounted.

TRUSTEES

It was recommended that:

38 Hereafter, Class A trustees be limited to two (2) consecutive three-year terms. Since the committee recognizes the necessity of a degree of flexibility in the terms of Class A trustees, the chairperson of the General Service Board—after approval by that board—is granted the opportunity to extend one (1) additional three-year term for Class A members of the General Service Board, where necessary.

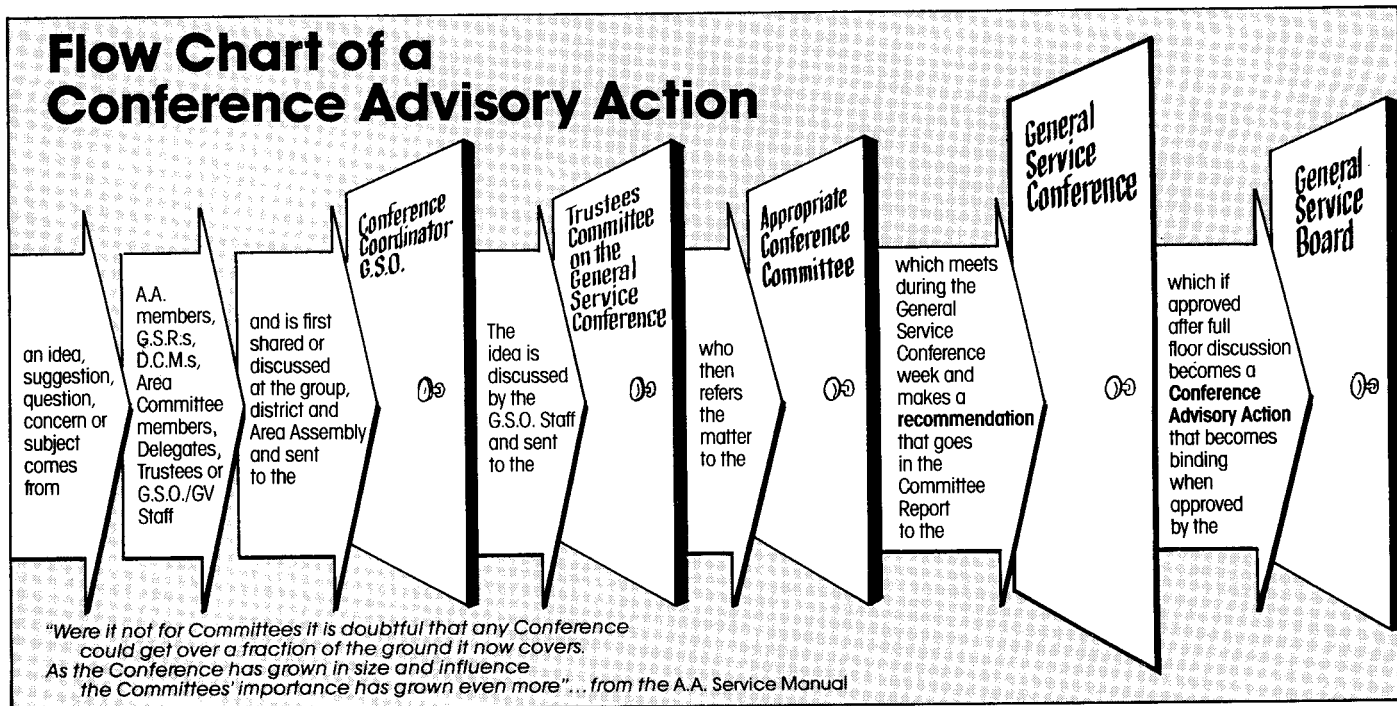
39 The chairperson of the General Service Board serve for no more than four consecutive years.

40 The slate of trustees and officers be elected at the annual meeting of the General Service Board in April 1993 (see page 00; the Conference and board approved the slate approved by the trustees' Nominating Committee).

41 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. World Services Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved).

42 The slate of directors be elected to the A.A. Grapevine Corporate Board (see page 37; slate of directors approved).

Flow Chart of a Conference Advisory Action



Presentations And Reports

A.A. TAKES ITS INVENTORY

This year, the presentations that addressed the Conference theme—A.A. Takes Its Inventory—were based on six articles of the Conference Charter. The first three presentations were given on Monday morning. Jackie Martin, Southeast regional trustee, was the moderator.

Smith, nonalcoholic chairman of the board, encouraged the idea whole-heartedly and indicated that the risk of the Conference adventure was far less than the risk of doing nothing at all—a policy which he thought would in the future result in a collapse or certainly a grievous impairment of A.A. at its very heart of service. He also reminded us that “self-direction was the very first responsibility” of every democratic society, as stated in Tradition Two.



The Purpose of the General Service Conference

I am sure that by now some of you are wondering if it was really a smart idea to let your name stand as a delegate. I am also sure that by the end of the week you will have represented your area well and will experience one of the most spiritual aspects of being involved in a Conference, that of being one small part of a great whole. That's what it is for me.

By 1946 A.A. had grown by leaps and bounds. Our co-founders were concerned that the trustees of the Alcoholic Foundation were not linked to A.A. as a whole. They were linked to the few A.A. people working at the Foundation office and to Dr. Bob and Bill W. However, there was no way they could communicate with the whole of A.A. Dr. Bob had become ill during this time and our co-founders saw an urgent need for a plan to establish an avenue by which the collective group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous could be heard, whether it be the majority or minority. Thus our society would truly conform to Tradition Two.

Dr. Bob and Bill met fierce resistance in trying to convince people that there should be any kind of change at all. Bernard

This was the turning point. The trustees' Committee on Structure recommended the immediate creation of the General Service Conference. In 1950 the trustees authorized Dr. Bob and Bill W. to proceed with a plan for a Conference structure. Bill immediately started work on a draft of a plan with the assistance of Helen B., an A.A. staff member. The Conference plan was presented to the first General Service Conference in Cleveland, Ohio, in 1951. The plan was accepted at that Conference and was to be tried on a five-year experimental basis. The trustees were now linked with the group conscience of the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous; the circle was complete.

It was also at this Conference that the name of the Alcoholic Foundation was changed to the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous. On July 3, 1955, at the Convention held in St. Louis, Missouri, Bill W. presented to the General Service Conference a resolution that if passed, would make the General Service Conference the guardians of our World Services and the Twelve Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous. The motion was unanimously carried and the Conference became the sole successor to our co-founders, and the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship. We were now self-directed and had inherited the duties and responsibilities of looking after our own affairs.

This week, we are assembled together as a service family of delegates, trustees of the General Service Board, directors of

A.A. World Services and the Grapevine, staff members of the General Service Office and the Grapevine. Our purpose is to consider matters that affect our much larger family, A.A. as a whole. We are here this week to fulfill a commitment to our co-founders and to the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous. This we will continue to do with the help of one ultimate authority, a loving God as He may express Himself in our group conscience.

Verna Robinson, Saskatchewan

The Conference Relation to A.A.

"The Conference will act for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its world services, and it will also be the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its view upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition. Delegates should be free to vote as their conscience dictates; they should also be free to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion, or their own direct instruction.

"But no change in Article 12 of the Charter or in the Twelve Traditions of A.A. or in the Twelve Steps of A.A. may be made with less than the written consent of three-quarters of the A.A. groups, as described in the Resolution adopted by the 1955 Conference and Convention." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S32)

This is Article Three of the Current Conference Charter, and it charges the Conference with four specific areas of responsibility:

1. Acting for A.A. in the perpetuation and guidance of its world services - This is done by gathering annually to participate in discussions and make decisions on a wide variety of issues placed before the Conference. A sampling of these are: electing some trustees; and accepting or not accepting others that were selected; listening to progress reports, on a variety of issues, from our services; and, by being the eyes, ears, and voice of A.A., monitoring and reporting on the activities and direction of its world services.

2. *Being the vehicle by which the A.A. movement can express its view upon all matters of vital A.A. policy and all hazardous deviations from A.A. Tradition* - This is a difficult task at best for many of "us" egotistical, powermonger-type alcoholics. Thankfully, Article Twelve gives us the means to accomplish this. The Conference must ensure that it does not become "the seat of perilous wealth or power"; that it maintains prudent financial principles; that no one has a position of unqualified authority over any other; that all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity; that no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy; that it perform no acts of government, and that it will always remain democratic in thought and action. These are the Warranties that will help to ensure that the voice of A.A. will always be heard.

3. *Safeguarding the freedom of the delegates to vote as their conscience dictates and to decide what questions should be taken to the group level, whether for information, discussion, or their own direct instruction* - This is a shared responsibility between the Conference and the A.A. members responsible for the delegates they elected to serve them. The Conference need always be mindful that it remain as it was set up to be, free of politics and undue authority. All voices at the Conference must be respected and listened to. No issue should be deemed so important that it must be acted upon immediately despite a lack of substantial unanimity. The delegates come to the Conference

not as senators or mere messengers but as representatives from their areas to the group conscience of Alcoholics Anonymous.

4. *To guard against any changes being made in Article Twelve of the Charter, the Twelve Traditions, or the Twelve Steps of A.A. with less than written consent of three quarters of the A.A. groups, as described in the Resolution of the 1955 Conference and Convention* - This seems, on the surface, to be so simple it requires little discussion. Upon closer examination, however, the Conference should ask not only if the words have been changed but also if the spirit or intent has changed or become weakened by past or proposed actions. Bill's resolution offered at the 20th Convention of A.A. in 1955 states: "That in all its proceedings the General Service Conference shall observe the spirit of the A.A. Tradition..." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S36)

In this time of Inventory how does the General Service Conference measure up? Are we observing "the spirit of the A.A. Tradition?" Have we, or are we going to compromise our principles? Is our primary purpose still clear? Are there power struggles or public controversy? Are our financial principles prudent? These are just some of the questions that members of the Conference must ask themselves as we propose actions or make decisions.

Since we alcoholics have been so notoriously inept in our relationships in the past, let us join together in the Fellowship of the Spirit and work to protect the "Conference's Relation to A.A."

Bob Halvorson, Montana

The General Service Conference and Its General Procedure

In 1955 the General Service Conference was authorized to act for A.A., and inherited the founders' duties and special responsibilities. In the spirit of taking a fearless moral inventory I propose to examine whether we have successfully lived up to that inheritance.

The general procedures for the Conference are listed as Article 11 of the Conference Charter and are very broad in their scope. Let's look at how we are supposed to proceed:

First, our Conference is a year-round operation. Therefore, in a sense, the general procedures should begin as each of us assumes the position that qualifies us for Conference membership, whether by election, nomination and confirmation, or as the result of being hired to fulfill a position at the General Service Office. Under Article 11, the Conference is charged with broad areas of responsibility: hearing the financial and policy reports of the General Service Board (G.S.B.), and its related corporate services; advising, with the trustees, directors and staff members, upon all matters presented which affect A.A. as a whole; engaging in debate with each other; appointing necessary committees; passing suitable resolutions for the advise or direction of the G.S.B.; discussing and recommending appropriate actions respecting serious deviations from A.A. tradition (little t); drafting any needed bylaws; supplying a full report of our proceedings to all delegates and committee members; and sending a condensed version to A.A. groups throughout the world.

In order to be effective, the Conference should promote efficient communication among its members. For the delegate to convey the group's wishes to the G.S.B. and its related corporate services, the groups need to hear the G.S.B.'s financial decisions and policy reports. These should be transmitted

through the delegate via reports from the G.S.B., using various publications, newsletters, Forums, and individual communications.

The delegate and all other Conference members should advise, with the trustees, directors, committees, and staff, on matters affecting A.A. as a whole. Conference members, however, are not expecting to thoroughly understand the background of all matters of importance to A.A. Although most of us are interested in many agenda items, due to the large number laid on the table at each Conference, we are asked to focus only on our own specific committee items. After careful study and debate of these items in the intimate committee atmosphere, each committee is charged to recommend for action those items it believes are in the Fellowship's best interest. The Conference as a whole then has the responsibility of using its collective wisdom to ratify or reject those committee recommendations.

Do these general procedures, in fact, qualify as a workable substitute for the founders? I think they do. As an example, let me focus on the debate procedure for committee recommendations. This is where I see a magic happen that is not contained in Article 11. One by one the Conference as a whole is presented with, debates, and passes on each committee recommendation. Each member is given a chance to express herself or himself. Only after all who wish to have expressed their concerns, opinions, feelings, and/or exhortations does the Conference pass on these resolutions. After the vote, each who voted in the minority *again* has an opportunity to voice his or her opinion. If doubt is created in the mind of *any* of the majority, that person has the opportunity to ask that the vote be reconsidered. If a majority agree to reconsider, the original motion is *again* put before the Conference. This procedure can be lengthy and unwieldy, but my experience is that the process works. When the Conference is over, I believe that each item has been given the benefit of as informed a group conscience as possible.

General procedures, as set out in the Charter, are the guides for us to follow, but our evolved Conference procedures and process produce a wonderful synergy of spirit. Although I had served as my area's chairman and alternate delegate, something changed when I became delegate and I got caught up in the Conference process even before attending my first Conference. I was engaged at a new spiritual level and my relationship with other Conference members and people in my own area changed. At the Conference this "spirit" has intensified and concern for the well-being of the Fellowship is the overriding feeling. One of my committee's responsibilities is the policy of the Conference, and I have come to realize that policy and process have to do with much more than general procedures. It is my belief that the Conference merits its heritage and will continue to do so just so long as we continue the process of self-examination, and trust that a power greater than ourselves will guide us.

Jim Clough, California (Mid-Southern)

REPORT ON FINANCE

Monday afternoon following an Area Highlights session, a Finance report was given by the Treasurer of the A.A.W.S. Board. For more details please see Finance section of this Report.

Aloha and welcome to an adventure through the world of A.A. finance. I am sure it will prove to be a spiritual experience for



me and hopefully for all of us.

Last year, my predecessor, Michael McPhearson, director of A.A.W.S., gave this report, which proved to be the highlight of the Conference. His presentation was thorough, open and honest, which is the epitome of A.A. communication. Michael gave us a comprehensive look at the 1992 budget. I have been taught in A.A. that if something works well, don't fix it. Thus I have utilized the same format that Michael used last year. So Mahalo nui loa, Michael, for setting the stage for us today.

Let's begin with a reminder from Bill W. who encouraged us to remember that money and spirituality do mix. A.A. finances are about love, service, sacrifice and responsibility. In order to rightly relate these principles to fiscal responsibility for each member of A.A., we need to communicate clearly, thoroughly and spiritually on how each A.A. sacrifice "in the hat," or each sacrifice through the purchase of A.A. literature, goes to support and assist each member in fulfilling their primary purpose of carrying the message to alcoholics that still suffer.

I will be touching on the 1993 budget and review the different trends relating to income from A.A. literature, contributions and expenses of your General Service Office, and A.A. World Service.

Don Meurer, A.A. controller, and his staff have been responsible for gathering and correlating all of the numbers, charts and graphs.

The results for 1992 were phenomenal, right on budget! The vision necessary to forecast the results accurately is a sure sign of financial responsibility and prudent budgeting. It is our hope and prayer that we have exercised the same vision for the 1993 budget.

First, let's consider the 1993 budget, which was developed over many months of committee meetings of the A.A.W.S. Finance and Budget Committee. It was approved by the A.A.W.S. Board and presented to and approved by the trustees' Finance Committee and the General Service Board. Many long hours of discussion went into producing the 1993 budget. As with previous budgets, the A.A.W.S. Finance and Budget Committee developed this budget with zero-based budgeting. We started this process with these words in our hearts and minds: "Concerning any given service, we therefore pose but

one question: 'Is this service really needed?' If it is, then maintain it we must, or fail in our mission to those who need and seek A.A." (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S8).

As we review the 1993 budget, I would like to suggest that instead of seeing this budget as a standard Income and Expense Statement, let's interpret the word "income" to mean "A.A. sacrifices," and the word "expenses" to mean "service given." This seems to be in keeping with the spiritual nature of A.A. finances.

The "A.A. sacrifice" (income) portion of the budget is a difficult part of the budget to forecast as it moves up and down each month. The 1993 budget projects a total income for the year of \$9,295,700. This represents a 5% decrease in total G.S.O. income as compared to 1992 actuals. The makeup of the total income is derived from gross sales of literature less discounts, less cost of products, less royalties, for a gross profit of \$5,285,700. This added to the budgeted contributions for 1993 of \$4,000,000, 3% lower than last year, plus interest income for the total G.S.O. income of \$9,295,700.

The total budgeted operating "services" (expenses) for 1993 are \$9,064,000. Subtracted from the total income this leaves a budgeted net operating income of \$231,700. It is perplexing but obvious to the A.A.W.S. Board and the General Service Board that the downward trends in literature sales and contributions will continue for a third consecutive year.

Fifty-seven percent of the total gross income comes from literature sales and 43% from contributions. These percentages have not varied by much over the years, except for the "hiccup" experienced by the "Challenge of the Seventh Tradition" during the late 1980s. We anticipate no new nonrecurring expenses (you will recall that the last several years we have had nonrecurring expenses for construction costs and duplicate rent associated with the move to our new offices). Thus, the total net income for the year is \$231,700.

Our Big Book and Twelve and Twelve are by far the leaders in numbers of books sold and represent the major component of the total dollar sales. Through the years the Fellowship has relied on the Big Book as one of the primary tools for carrying the message of our recovery program to those who seek help. In 1992 our two basic titles accounted for over 61% of total gross sales. The decline started in 1990 and we project it to continue with a 4% decline in sales for this year.

As to the ten-year history of dollar sales of the Twelve and Twelve, we have projected that this decline will continue through 1993. The introduction of the soft cover had a modest impact but not enough to alter the 6% decrease in sales projected in the 1993 budget.

We need your help and thoughtful suggestions! The sales of Big Books and Twelve and Twelves have continued to decline over the past three years (Big Book, 11% decline from 1990 through 1992; Twelve and Twelve, 17% decline from 1990 through 1992) and we project in the 1993 budget that this trend will continue at rates of 4% and 6% respectively.

Does this continuing decline reflect a decreasing growth in the A.A. membership? An economic hardship? A recycling of our Big Book? Other recovery literature that is more accessible and more useful to A.A. members? Have sponsors and groups stopped the practice of making sure a newcomer has a Big Book? What's the solution? Should we produce a fourth edition with or without the stories, or with new stories, make it smaller, change the color or sex neutralize it? To find answers to questions like these is why we have a Conference. The Conference Literature Committee will be dealing this week with this very question and we will collectively seek God's will in finding the proper A.A. solutions for this and many other challenges that beset us.

Next, let's turn to the "services given" (expenses) side of the 1993 budget. As we review the services for the year you will note that each one of these line items relate to carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Giving service is the sole reason for our existence (our Twelfth Step), and the services outlined in the 1993 budget are what we believe the General Service Conference and the A.A. Fellowship have requested that the General Service Office provide. A great portion of our Twelfth Step work is done through the employees and staff at your General Service Office.

Total budgeted operating expenses for the year reflect a 1% increase over 1992 actuals. A very modest increase. Let's look at the history of salaries compared to total operating expenses for the past 20 years. Salaries, \$3,683,000, make up 41% of the cost of services to the A.A. Fellowship, a major portion of our total expenses. Through excellent cost planning and good management leadership, this overhead expense has been maintained at lower levels. This has been a major achievement in the light of a growing worldwide Fellowship and an erratic economy.

All of the other services listed on the expense side of the 1993 budget are vital parts of the whole of our combined efforts to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. Each one of these many "services" (expenses) enable us as a Fellowship to fulfill our Twelfth Step responsibilities.

I thank you for allowing me to present your 1993 budget. When reviewing this budget I encourage all of us to evaluate it on its abilities to fulfill our primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers. It's a tight, well thought-out vision of what services we believe you, the delegates and Conference members acting for the Fellowship, have requested the General Service Office to provide.

The preliminary results for the first quarter of 1993 show literature sales very close to budget. Contributions are continuing to slip below budget and are alarmingly below the same period last year. In light of the trend in contributions the A.A.W.S. Board and management are continuing to watch expenses very closely and determine what group service activities could be curtailed, if this should become necessary.

My prayer is that we all assume the responsibility to inform our Fellowship of the spiritual health of their world services. That we communicate how each little "sacrifice" goes to save another human soul from the depth of alcoholic despair.

Greg Muth, Pacific regional trustee

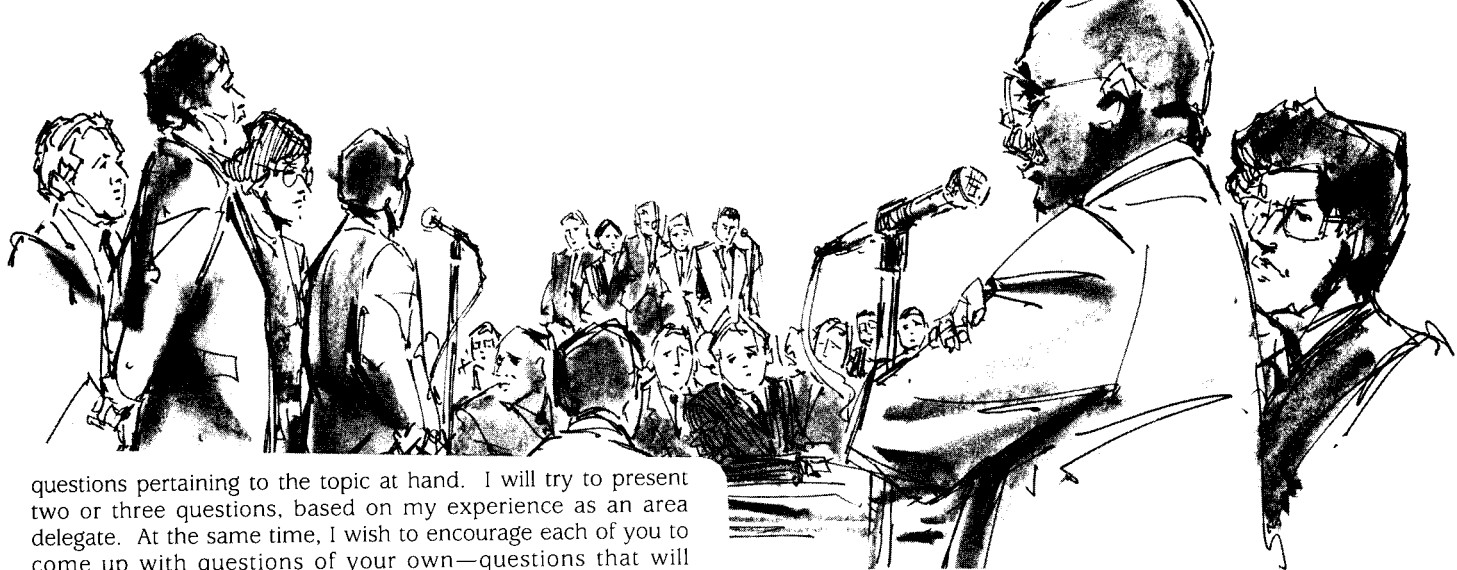
A.A. TAKES ITS INVENTORY

The second group of presentations on the Conference theme opened Monday evening's session. Moderator was Class A trustee John N. Chappel, M.D.

Conference Relation to the General Service Board and Its Corporate Services

In an effort to accommodate the theme of the 1993 General Service Conference, A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure, I will attempt to share a little something on the topic of "Conference Relation to the General Service Board and Its Corporate Services."

Whenever we of Alcoholics Anonymous pursue an inventory, whether it be on a personal or collective basis, the method of setting aside judgment in favor of a simply "fact-finding and fact-facing" venture remains a most effective process. In order to expedite this process we will need to first ask ourselves some



questions pertaining to the topic at hand. I will try to present two or three questions, based on my experience as an area delegate. At the same time, I wish to encourage each of you to come up with questions of your own—questions that will ultimately assist in allowing the Third Legacy Structure to function as effectively as is possible.

The first point that I would like to see us examine is: Is the Conference directing actions or expressing ideas to the General Service Board that are comprehensive, or do we sometimes participate just for the sake of participation? Not only during the annual meeting of the General Service Conference, but throughout the year.

As I consider this point, my thoughts go back to my days in high school, when I played football. After what I believed to be a most spectacular play on my part, my coach would sarcastically yell onto the playing field, "That was great, Charlie; it didn't work worth a poop, but it certainly looked good!" Throughout this Conference week and in the days following, as we direct and interact with the General Service Board and its many services, I believe that it would benefit each of us to take time to ask ourselves what our motives really are. Are we acting effectively and in a necessary way, or merely acting?

The second question that I would explore would be: Are we, as a Conference or as individuals, striving to maintain a sense of unity or continuity between the various service branches, starting with the General Service Board?

I sense that, in the past few years, a "mist of separation" has settled on the Conference body. A position of "us and them" seems to have taken some root on the part of the Conference toward the General Service Board and the many service parts that it is responsible for—a situation that, I believe, is based for the most part in misunderstanding and/or "...contempt prior to investigation." I don't believe that any discussion is required to remind this group how dangerous division can be to our way of life or to the way that we conduct our business via the "Conference Plan." Today, searching for a cause of distrust by dwelling in the past is probably less pertinent than seeking an immediate remedy. A "fact-finding and fact-facing" look at the relation of the Conference to the General Service Board may prove to be just what the doctor ordered. An inventory that is pursued from a position of honesty and open-mindedness is going to result in the exposing of valuable as well as irrelevant items.

My third and final question asks: Are we really open to change (collectively) within the Conference structure? Today I believe that we can answer with a confident yes. Even though the process of change has been a point of fear for many of us, the change in leadership in the General Service Office last year and a similar change in the General Service Board this year is already beginning to have a positive impact on the relationship of the Conference to both the General Service Board and A.A.W.S. At this point I want to make sure that there is no

misunderstanding. I speak from a position of respect and gratitude toward those who have so selflessly served us in the past, both recently and in years gone by. However, with new leadership come new ideas and strengths. In our Concept IX, Bill Wilson speaks of the critical importance of leadership at all levels of A.A. I believe that we are now beginning to feel a renewed sense of unity in the relationship of the Conference to the General Service Board.

In closing, as we participate in this collective appraisal of Alcoholics Anonymous, it's my hope and prayer that we may find the spiritual strength and collective humility to prayerfully act on what we find. And in so doing, we may continue in our primary quest of carrying our life-giving message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Chuck Stokes, Northern Wisconsin/Upper Pen. Michigan

The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities

Not long ago, I spent a sleepless night—in Bill Wilson's words—"viewing with alarm for the good of A.A." A friend listening to my concerns made an extremely useful comment: "I suggest you look at this in a broader context." When I took this suggestion and considered that all of us are members of A.A. but are also in a larger world where we are affected by economic, political and cultural factors, it helped me to understand some of the things that I view with alarm—things in my home group, things concerning the General Service Board, things about A.A. as a whole. It helped me to see that not only are we experiencing change, but also we are fighting it like a person who hates change so much that she is angry that there are different days of the week. In my early sobriety, when things started to change so much that I didn't know who I was—which was fairly frequently—I always took an inventory to try to find out. Right now, I feel like A.A. is in somewhat the same state, so it is especially useful that this is "The Year of the Inventory." Let me say that even though the General Service Board did take its inventory, and the loving invitation to speak arrived after we had met, the opinions in most of this presentation are only my own; however, I will make reference to that inventory, which I believe everyone has received.

The title of the presentation I was asked to make is: The General Service Board: Composition, Jurisdiction, Responsibilities—the exact words taken from Point Ten of the Conference Charter, under which we operate. I'd like to address each of the three parts of the title separately, noting the

areas defined by the Charter; then, in the spirit of inventory, at least raise questions I see about how effectively we are meeting the primary purpose of every A.A. entity: to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Composition: The General Service Board is an incorporated trusteeship composed of alcoholics and nonalcoholics who elect their own successors subject to the approval of the Conference. Currently, as you know there are seven nonalcoholics and 14 alcoholics, the latter of which include eight regional trustees, two trustees-at-large, and four general service trustees. Overall, the number of 21 trustees seems to work well—any more would be unwieldy. In my experience, the nonalcoholic trustees play a vitally important role in the Fellowship. The question I would raise here is, Should there be seven? Could five with appropriate backgrounds bring the necessary expertise? Would the addition of two more regional trustees, instead, be more valuable? What about the role of the trustee-at-large? Would the Fellowship be more effectively served if these two positions were to become regional trusteeships? I find the balance of two general service trustees on each corporate board effective for the reasons outlined in *The A.A. Service Manual*, but others question whether these should become regional trusteeships. Relative to the subsidiary corporate boards, the question I would raise is whether there should be an additional alcoholic trustee/director on the A.A.W.S. Board so that each of its standing committees could be chaired by a trustee.

Jurisdiction: As the chief service arm of the Conference, the General Service Board has entire freedom of action in the routine conduct of the policy and business affairs of the A.A. service corporations, except where decisions on matters of policy, finance or A.A. Tradition would affect the Fellowship as a whole. It is essentially custodial. Related to this, our inventory expressed the desire that we mindfully accent the spiritual implications of all we do.

Responsibilities: The General Service Board is primarily responsible for the financial and policy integrity of its subsidiary services, A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine. Here is where I feel the General Service Board must most sternly take continuing inventory. It is doubtful that the number of alcoholics in this country is decreasing, yet we are seeing a dramatic decrease in the number of units of literature sold and in the contributions coming in to the General Service Office. (Some areas and some intergroups are reporting the same phenomena.) Regarding literature, it's not that new members are not buying; it's that they are not buying our literature. Bookstores have whole sections devoted to recovery literature based on our Twelve Steps. The great danger here is not that we're losing income on lost sales. It is rather that the integrity of the A.A. message—our singleness of purpose—is being blurred badly because our members are choosing to buy different material that seems more relevant to them—and it is not ours.

The pattern regarding contributions could be a reflection of the prolonged recession we've been in. But I think we would be foolish not to consider other causes: Are members exercising the power of the purse because they do not approve of what we're doing? Or don't understand it? Or perhaps don't even know about it? Is money being diverted to social events because members have lost sight of our primary purpose? Do many current members have primary allegiance to the treatment center from which they graduated? And if so, what does that mean for the newcomers they sponsor? What happened to the spirit of sacrifice that used to underline service, our primary purpose?

The primary purpose of the General Service Board is to carry the A.A. message to the alcoholic who still suffers. I believe that we need to look closely at both our composition and our

responsibilities to see that we do so as effectively as possible. A number of items that came up during our inventory address our need—while focusing on our spiritual purpose—to have a vision for A.A. as a whole, and take a global view in doing so; to be flexible in a changing world; to address the fall-off in literature sales and maintain the integrity of the A.A. message; to be inclusive and carry the message to all who reach for it; to ensure that we always have input from all regions and recognize the shifting focus of many service functions to local areas; and above all, to foster mutual respect and to go forward with the deep gratitude and love that brought us into service.

Jean Smith, general service trustee

THE GENERAL WARRANTIES OF THE CONFERENCE

Immediately following the above were two presentations on the General Warranties.

The General Warranties

When I received a loving invitation to share on this topic, I was talking with a sponsee about the importance of his being involved in our Fellowship to his continued sobriety and the contribution this involvement could make to his life and the lives of countless others. His concerns were primarily with recovery, but I cannot separate my recovery from service. I asked him if he knew about the General Warranties of the Conference, and he replied, "The what?" His response typifies that of most persons with whom I have broached this topic.

In January of 1992, our area held an inventory assembly meeting, and one of the ideas that was expressed, and subsequently adopted in Western New York was to have the alternate delegate do a brief presentation at each assembly meeting on one of our Concepts. In November 1992, our alternate delegate, Shawn O., characterized our Warranties as "a workable middle ground between fear and recklessness." It is in this middle ground that I must strive to stay in the rendering of service to our Fellowship. Dan Byrne, past West Central U.S. regional trustee, referred to the General Warranties of the Conference as "the safety valve for our service structure" in his presentation on "The Twelve Concepts—How Can We Live the Concepts in Service?" at the 37th Conference.

The qualities of spirituality and prudence engendered in these General Warranties provide a safeguard against the fear and recklessness about which my alternate spoke.

Warranty One, "The Conference shall never become the seat of perilous wealth or power," warns against the very human temptations of wealth and personal prestige and power. I have seen the effect of the accumulation of "perilous wealth" on individual groups. This situation invites dissent in the usage of funds and promotes the inclination to broaden or change our primary purpose. Both conditions serve to weaken our greatest asset in carrying the A.A. message of recovery—our unity. General Service and the Conference are seen, by many I have met in A.A., as the "politics" of A.A. Our first Warranty provides a reminder of the type of corruption that can result from the accumulation of too much money or too much power in the hands of too few.

I cringe at the mention of politics and A.A. together, because of the potential for harm to our primary purpose, and subsequently our sobriety and the sobriety of those yet to find our Fellowship. Our ultimate authority should be a loving God as He is expressed in our group conscience, and not the dictate of one or any few individuals, or the purchasing power created

by the accumulation of large sums of money. I have heard it said many times that a small group with a moderate treasury has more unity than a large group with large sums of money. As long as we continue to decline outside contributions and limit individual member's donations, we will not become wealthy in any perilous sense. And if we trust "a loving God" as our ultimate authority, then we can avoid the corruption usually associated with a governing body.

Warranty Two states that "Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve, should be its prudent financial principle." Our area has reacted at times with fear, and at other times with reckless spending, to any situation concerning a financial outlay. The key principle to this Warranty is prudence, which is totally at odds with one of my outstanding defects of character, grandiosity.

Some persons that I have talked with question the financial outlay for such G.S.O. projects as computerization and relocation of the General Service Office. Such projects enable us to better fulfill our primary purpose, and it seems that when a need is expressed for finances to carry out our primary purpose, the finances somehow appear. Thus in A.A. the roadblock of fiscal limitations seems always to be bypassed by the spiritual principle of faith. "None of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others." (Warranty Three) This principle, so aptly stated in Tradition Two, is of such importance to the Fellowship that it bears restating here. The absence of any seniority or superseding rank ensures that the voice of all may be heard and safeguards the democratic spirit of our deliberations, reminding us all that we are just trusted servants, and as such, do not govern. Every alcoholic is just one drink away from a drunk, and there is no one among us that has been able to achieve anything like perfect adherence to all our spiritual principles. There are no "bosses" in A.A., and Warranty Three is an insurance that there will never be.

Warranty Four states "That all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity." No wonder it takes so long and requires such lengthy deliberations to effect any changes in our Fellowship. All the alcoholics that I know have lots of ideas and opinions and all want their points of view expressed. Just try to get a group of alcoholics to agree on a matter of importance in a very limited time, and you'll find rebellion in the ranks. This Warranty is our guarantee that all voices will be heard, and even the minority opinion will be given audience. Even further, this principle assures that all who wish to participate are given the opportunity to do so, and decisions are made by an informed group conscience. As a guard against the hasty or impulsive feeling of an aroused majority, substantial unanimity further strengthens our unity, de-emphasizing the "I" and emphasizing the "We."

At the 41st Conference, there was discussion of possible action by the Conference that could be construed as personally punitive. "...No Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy," states Warranty Five. Again the Warranties safeguard our unity. We in Alcoholics Anonymous do not punish anyone. How then is any order and adherence to the rules achieved? First, there are no rules in A.A. Even these six Warranties may be changed by the written consent of three-quarters of all the directory-listed A.A. groups who would actually vote on any such proposals, after the considerable time of six months is allowed for careful deliberations. We find that unless we adhere to sound spiritual principles and take into account the mistakes of the past, that alcohol itself cuts us down.

Personal punishments and public controversy are as

detrimental to our society as fear and recklessness can be to our Fellowship. We strive to eliminate causes for resentment and internal divisions because we must in order to stay sober as individuals and to effectively carry the A.A. program of recovery to the alcoholic who still suffers.

Our Sixth Warranty states "That though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in action and in spirit."

This review of our General Warranties brings back to mind the words of my first sponsor, who said, "Harm no one" and "Learn to listen so that you can listen to learn." I didn't understand the import of these thoughts until I began to try to repay my debt of sobriety with service in A.A. As trusted servants, we do not govern (remember—no rules—or laws). I firmly believe that it is the General Warranties of the Conference that maintain that atmosphere to which I was so attracted when I first stumbled into A.A. I find an enormous comfort in the acceptance, the love, the unity and spirit of spiritual equality that the Warranties preserve throughout all levels of A.A. service. I need to be ever mindful of the facts that I am not an A.A. senator, that my pride and ego must be kept at bay, and that I am but a spoke in the giant wheel of our Fellowship—no more or no less important than anyone else. As a member of Alcoholics Anonymous, I am grateful for the guidance these Warranties provide for our Declaration of Unity: "This we owe to A.A.'s future: To place our common welfare first; To keep our Fellowship united. For on A.A. Unity depend our lives, and the lives of those to come."

I no longer read *The A.A. Service Manual* as a cure for insomnia, but as a blueprint for carrying the A.A. message of recovery, a kind of "how to" in my effort to give it away to keep it. Seeing how these Warranties are put into action at my assembly and through the Conference process has brought me into an understanding of and agreement with the statement on page 62 of *Twelve Concepts for World Service* that "[...the Warranties] are quite as important to A.A.'s world services as the Traditions are to A.A. as a whole."

Terry Wymer, Western New York

Wondering Through the Warranties

Like other presenters, I am grateful for the opportunity to address this Conference. In all honesty, however, like the good alcoholic I am, I did do all that I could to get out of it. One device, an embarrassingly patent one as I reflect, was trying to encourage my friend here, Terry, to take all the time. As you see, he smoothly declined. So, as somebody once said, "If you can't get out of it, get into it."

Getting started on this has been hard. I had much resistance, perhaps for good reasons. For one thing, the Warranties, as spiritual principles, speak eloquently for themselves. Also, Bill's supportive essays illuminate them quite fully. Like their soul mates, the Traditions, they may not be altered in any way without the agreement of three-quarters of the listed or known A.A. groups throughout the world. So, in all humility, what can I add?

Some background: As you know, the Warranties made their appearance in the Original Charter (1955) as Item Twelve, The General Warranties of the General Service Conference. These were developed with the help of Bernard Smith, Class A trustee and chairman of the General Service Board. Surely they were designed to reduce, if not dispel, the fear-filled opposition to the

General Service Conference that was rife in those early years. Many A.A. members felt that a Conference was a needless complication and, as such, constituted a threat to the simplicity that Dr. Bob had urged on us. It was perceived by some to be a cleverly designed but rather obvious attempt to control or govern the Fellowship. "New York was up to no good." The Six Warranties, then, were produced to neutralize the fear of "the spirit of Money, Power and Prestige." The Warranties are intended to provide assurances that the motives of the General Service Conference are benign: to serve, not rule.

The 38 intervening years, however, have largely put those issues to rest. While some pockets of resistance may still remain, the overall acceptance of the General Service Conference of Alcoholics Anonymous is wide indeed. The effectiveness of our Conference has been demonstrated by the startling growth of our Fellowship.

In 1955 we had an estimated 103,000 members in almost 5,200 groups in the U.S. and Canada. In 1992, we counted over 1,170,000 members in approximately 54,000 groups in our two Conference countries. These figures reflect a better than tenfold increase in both members and groups in those 36 years. Surely, we must be doing something right with the gifts that God has provided. And while our beloved Fellowship creaks with some "achy-breaky" problems, we will be entering our 59th year this summer, tattered maybe, but joyously whole.

This alcoholic wonders, however, just how much more effective we could be if we were to abandon ourselves still more completely to our legacy of spiritual principles. My own life speaks to the fact that, with practice, the Twelve Steps, "a group of principles, spiritual in their nature," can provide an internal environment of emotional sobriety by creating an inner place of calm which fosters a fuller connection with a Power greater than myself. I then have the tools to become more than me.

With a conscious awareness and practice, the Traditions, "by outlining the means by which A.A. maintains its unity," can help us to develop emotional sobriety within our groups. We can move toward emotional sobriety by trying to create a controversy-free, ego-free environment—an environment which promotes healing and connectedness, that maximizes effectiveness through an acknowledgement of the authority and presence of a Higher Power.

Perhaps, with a deeper understanding and a conscious practice of the Warranties, we can experience a more loving and efficient Conference, one completely free of divisive forces. For I believe that once again the conscious application of this set of spiritual principles can produce an environment of profound emotional sobriety, one in which the presence of a Higher Power is evident.

A warrantee or any other guarantee, no matter how well conceived and constructed, cannot be protective if it remains virtually unknown. Like our Steps and Traditions, the Warranties have to be used to be useful. If I am not conscious of the Steps in my life on a daily basis, surely I am less likely to be emotionally sober each day. If my group is not conscious of our Traditions, chances are good that emotional sobriety will be lacking, and unity, as reflected in a cohesive body will be diminished. So too, if as a Conference member I am largely unconscious of these Warranties, can my participation be fully effective?

At one time in my A.A. life it was not uncommon to hear some members, usually the older ones, cry, "You don't need the Steps, just don't drink and go to meetings." A cry made not infrequently in relationship to the Big Book as well. I haven't heard that kind of talk in years.

However, I do hear members disclaim the importance of the Traditions, even as evidence mounts that a group may have

temporarily lost its way as far as our primary purpose is concerned. The Traditions are too often thought of as a nice set of abstractions, rather than vital, essential tools for providing the most effective framework for collective spiritual awakenings. But things here too are "a-changin'." More and more groups are adding Tradition meetings to their schedules.

Possibly, as we become clearer on the how, when and where to apply the Twelve Concepts—particularly the Six Warranties—more comfortably and consciously to our Conference life together, they will become a fully natural component of our work. Sometimes we seem to be unsure of their application to specific concerns. Boundaries amongst the three components of the Conference—delegates, board and staff—should be more clearly defined. This seems to have happened spontaneously at last year's Conference. Concept Two clearly gives complete authority for active maintenance of our world services to the Conference. While Concept Six gives "...the final decision respecting large matters of general policy and finance..." to the General Service Conference, "...the chief initiative and active responsibility..." in most of these matters should be exercised primarily by the trustee members of the Conference. Thus, there may be honest interpretive issues to be resolved.

Clarity often results from practice, and practice is hard. I've always wanted success without conscious practice, yearning to be an instant expert in everything. The Third Warranty, which states that "None of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others," provides a context within which these issues can be resolved.

As someone once remarked, "Attitudes are caught, not taught." In reading Bill's essays on the Warranties I have caught an attitude of loving cooperation and respect. Surely Bill offers us a vision of a true convening of freres, a gathering of brothers and sisters, one in which trust enters and magic happens. Still another demonstration that God can do for us what we could not have done for ourselves.

Let's sit back and let these thoughts wash over us:

- The Conference shall never become the seat of perilous wealth or power.
- Sufficient operating funds, plus an ample Reserve should be its prudent financial principle.
- None of the Conference members shall ever be placed in a position of unqualified authority over any of the others.
- That all important decisions be reached by discussion, vote, and, whenever possible, by substantial unanimity.
- That no Conference action ever be personally punitive or an incitement to public controversy.
- That though the Conference may act for the service of Alcoholics Anonymous, it shall never perform any acts of government; and that, like the Society of Alcoholics Anonymous which it serves, the Conference itself will always remain democratic in action and in spirit.



Frank Mauser, archivist

A.A. TAKES ITS INVENTORY—GRAPEVINE

Wednesday afternoon the Grapevine staff and director of the Grapevine Corporate Board gave a multidimensional presentation, based on questionnaires from 12,000 Grapevine readers. Grapevine directors, at mikes around the room, took the role of various respondents. Graphics were supplied on a slide projector.

JAKE HAM: Welcome to the world of the Grapevine. My name is Jake Ham, and I'm an alcoholic and a Grapevine trustee-director. With me on the dais is Ann Warner, also an alcoholic, and executive editor of the Grapevine. Together, we'll be moderating a presentation that takes its cue from the magazine, with its wide reader participation, and engages a number of people in giving you a multidimensional view of the Grapevine—past, present and future.

As we considered the topic "The Grapevine Takes Its Inventory," we realized that in order to assess the present, we need a solid understanding of where we came from. For that reason, we will introduce you to our "roots" in some early documents that describe what the Grapevine was originally intended to be. With a few historical transitions, we'll move you as fast as possible to 1993, and present the results of the Grapevine Corporate Board's inventory session, then spend most of our allotted time listening to the voices of a few of the 12,000 readers who answered a questionnaire mailed with the February 1993 issue.

ANN WARNER: The first issue of the Grapevine came off press in June 1944, as a newsletter for New York City A.A.s. The magazine was also sent free to all A.A.s in the World War II armed forces, who began calling it their "meeting in print."

In 1945, the trustees asked the membership whether or not the Grapevine should become the national magazine of A.A., and when the answer came back a resounding "yes," the magazine was legally incorporated in 1946 as one of two publishing arms of what is now the General Service Board. In a letter to Royal Shepard, the lawyer who drafted the articles of incorporation, Bill W. described his vision for the magazine.

JAKE: "In trying to think the Grapevine matter through, I have asked myself what would be the ideal relationship of the paper to the A.A. groups as a whole, to the Board of Trustees of the Alcoholic Foundation, and to the general public. After consulting the Grapeviners and most of the Board of Trustees, our collective thinking about an ideal for the Grapevine has taken on a fairly definite shape:

- "The Grapevine should become the voice of A.A. as a whole.
- "The Grapevine staff should be primarily responsive to A.A. group opinion and tradition.
- "The Grapevine editor should be the ultimate judge of what is to be printed. In this respect he ought to enjoy greater freedom than the editor of a commercial newspaper whose owners commonly hire a man favorable to their own opinions and hold over him the power of the purse.

• "The Trustees...should have power to intervene in the affairs of the Grapevine should the paper go wrong from a fiscal or national policy standpoint. But the Trustees should not have, under normal conditions, any power to dictate to the Grapevine staff so long as the paper conforms to the spirit of the 12 Steps of Alcoholics Anonymous and keeps its financial house in order.... Such a relationship...would soon create a powerful A.A. tradition so that no individual or single group of individuals may ever dominate our National Organ.

• "The Grapevine should feel free to print articles expressing the widest differences of opinion on all topics of a strictly A.A. nature. But it should be traditionally, perhaps legally, prohibited from printing anything of a controversial nature on topics having nothing to do with the primary aim of A.A.....

• "To further guarantee its integrity, the Grapevine should accept no paid advertising, nor seriously lend itself to any commercial venture, however worthy.

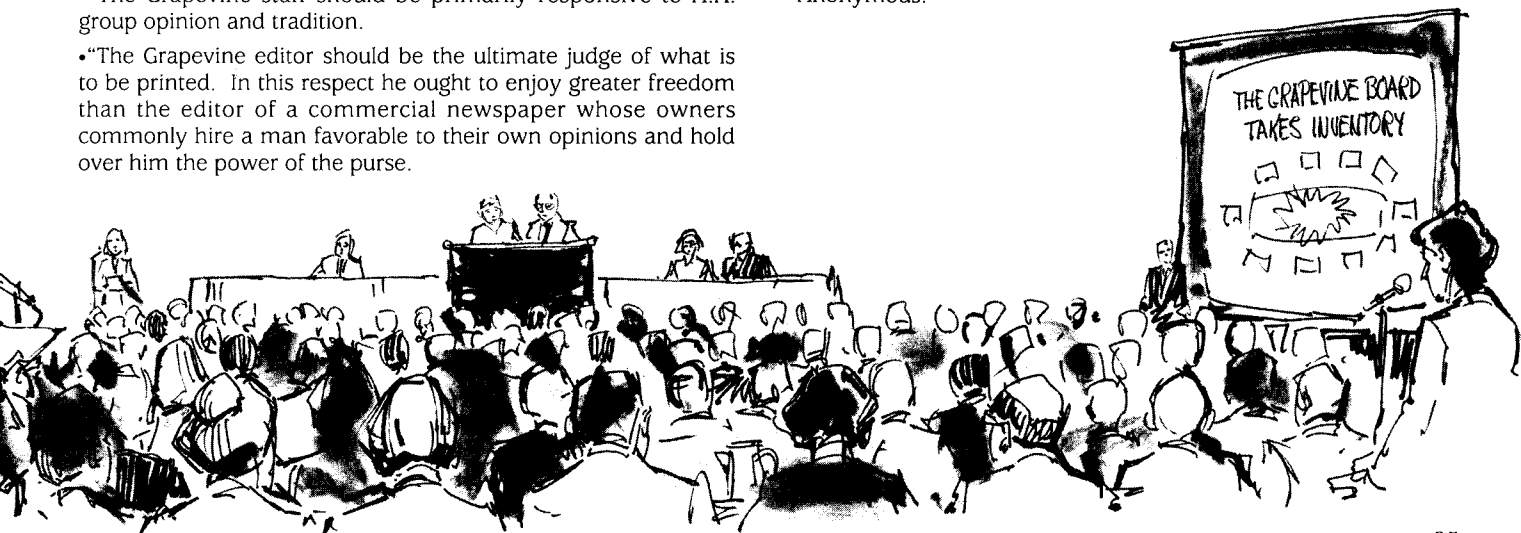
• "The Grapevine should have freedom to print news articles relative to the whole field of alcoholism, excepting, however, those which might provoke needless dissension.

• "Though never to be operated for the profit of any individual, the Grapevine ought to be financially self-supporting. To insure its own continuity the Grapevine will need to maintain an office staff and eventually a paid editor. The Grapevine ought to be so priced that these expenses can normally be met without subsidies....

• "In summary... Like the Alcoholics Anonymous movement it is to mirror, there will be but one central purpose: 'The Grapevine will try to carry the A.A. message to alcoholics and practice A.A. principles in all its affairs.'"

JOHN KING: The corporate charter itself outlined the structure of the Grapevine Board and described the Grapevine's mission. At a time when some A.A.s are asking whether the Grapevine has strayed from its intended purpose—to publish a magazine—and questions are being raised about Grapevine special items, it is interesting to take a look at some provisions that specify what the corporation could legally do, without the force of tradition to set limits:

FRANCINE WARD: The Grapevine is legally empowered (and I quote) "To prepare, edit, print, publish, bind, manufacture, circulate, distribute, buy, sell and otherwise deal in magazines, books, papers, pamphlets, brochures, leaflets and other printed or written material primarily devoted to the dissemination of information concerning the principles, practices, activities, and objectives of the Fellowship commonly known as 'Alcoholics Anonymous.'"



"...To prepare, edit, print, publish, bind, manufacture, circulate, distribute, buy, sell and otherwise deal in...written material concerning generally the subject of alcoholism and related matters and dealing with the various means, methods, techniques and procedures available or proposed for the treatment, relief, rehabilitation and recovery of persons suffering from or potentially subject to alcoholism..."

"To engage in any and all activities calculated to assist in the voluntary restoration of individuals suffering from or threatened with alcoholism...or participate in all classes of services calculated to be of help to persons suffering from or threatened with alcoholism..."

"Nothing herein contained, however, shall be deemed to give the corporation the right to solicit funds or to engage in noncharitable activities."

JOHN: At the time of incorporation, the editors were all volunteers, with a small paid office staff helping out. An Editorial Board was needed to strengthen the volunteer staff by providing day-to-day editorial help, serving as a pool of talent for potential editors, and also by writing articles when there was a shortage of contributed material—which happened all too frequently. By the early 1960s it was possible to hire a paid editor. Today, two full-time A.A. members and two part-time A.A.s edit and design the magazine, and A.A. readers write more articles than the magazine can publish. An office force of about 20 nonalcoholics provides support in the form of accounting and circulation departments, an office manager, a small shipping room, and a coordinator for the GVR program.

The Corporate Board now numbers 10 directors, and meets quarterly to transact corporate business, as well as four times a year as a planning committee of the whole. At the December 1992 meeting, the Corporate Board took its inventory.

JANE SCHULBERG and BERNIE BENZIGER:

VOICE 1: We met on a cold winter's day just before Christmas. We had an outline of suggested topics, and we decided to address each one from the perspective of our responsibilities to the Fellowship, to the Grapevine Board, and to ourselves as board members.

VOICE 2: It was a tall order, and turned out to be a wonderful discussion. So wonderful, in fact, that we decided to do an inventory and address these broader issues on a regular basis, at least once a year.

VOICE 1: We agreed that the board is responsible for overseeing the management and maintaining the integrity of the magazine: for making sure the Grapevine carries the A.A. message and that it is produced in a timely fashion. That we need to be open to the Fellowship and provide a forum for what A.A. members are actually saying out there. We are also charged with making sure that the magazine is financially responsible.

VOICE 2: Financially responsible. That's trickier than it sounds. Does that mean we have to make a profit? Break even? Can we operate at a loss? For how long? Should we expect to be bailed out by the Reserve Fund when we get in trouble?

What does decreasing circulation mean to us? What can we do about it? Many traditional tools of the magazine trade are not available to us: we can't advertise, we can't promote. Going on subscription campaigns is only a temporary cure. But what about figuring out a way to have treatment centers give a year's subscription to the Grapevine to their clients as they leave—the way they give them the Big Book? We need to rethink selling the magazine by the copy, also.

VOICE 1: And what about the Grapevine representative network? The GvR list is much smaller than the list of G.S.R.s. Often, by dealing only with GvRs we wind up cutting ourselves off from the rest of the service structure. What do we do about that? Can the computer help us solve this problem? And how far can we go to encourage GvRs to do more?

VOICE 2: We also talked at length about our personal responsibilities to the board. We have to apply our best critical thinking to the issues that are placed on the table, to be sure we are as well informed as possible. Having thought about the situation, we are then responsible to say what is on our minds—both as business people and as A.A. members. Our point of view may not prevail, but it is important we make it heard.

The decision-making process on the board is not about winning; it's about negotiating and coming to a consensus. We need to be open to new ideas and not bound by old notions of how it has "always" been done.

We decided that it probably was not possible to be completely objective, but that it was necessary to be fair.

And we also talked about needing to achieve that difficult balance of dealing with a Fellowship of the heart and at the same time running a business with employees, insurance and overhead.

VOICE 1: Then there are the larger, philosophical issues. There are now many recovery programs and lots of recovery literature out there. What is our relationship to all that? Is A.A. too "orthodox"? Are we too rigid? (The fierce resistance the Conference had to a softcover Big Book for so long served as an example for us here.)

Is it possible that A.A. could be so resistant to any change that it might go the way of the Shakers and cease to exist?

VOICE 2: The Shakers died out because they were opposed to sex, didn't they?

VOICE 1: That's right.

VOICE 2: Never happen!



VOICE 1: Well, as you can see, we covered a lot of bases. And the thing we were most clear about was the need to have this inventory be an ongoing thing.

VOICE 2: Besides that, it was a fabulous dialogue. Thanks for insisting that we have it.

ANN: As Grapevine directors were taking their inventory, back at the office the editors were preparing for a dialogue with Grapevine readers.

AMES SWEET: The Conference theme came at a good time for the Grapevine, for we have long realized that in some areas we have far more questions than we have answers. Mindful of falling circulation, and the possibility that the magazine itself might have become less useful or attractive, we went to the source, with a "Help Us Take Our Inventory" questionnaire mailed with the February issue. As replies began to come in by the mailtrainful, we seesawed between being overwhelmed by astonishment, overwhelmed by joy and gratitude, and just plain overwhelmed! In the end, more than 12,000 readers responded with a virtual barrage of answers. Many of them said thank you for being asked...

VOICE 1: "You do such a good job each month that I am glad to have this opportunity to express my appreciation for all you do. It is not often that a publication asks its readers for their comments."

VOICE 2: "I value your magazine, and in thinking through your questionnaire, I have learned why. Thank you."

ANN: Not only did readers respond, for the most part they overflowed with enthusiasm. Some attached extra pages of comments—and some even sent the questionnaire back before they had finished reading the issue.

AMES: There was some bad news as well. When we tabulated respondents' ages, we confirmed what we have long suspected: Younger A.A. members are not Grapevine readers. A dramatic 75 percent of those who responded are over the age of 40, and a barely noticeable eight out of the 12,000 responses came from teenagers. So our first real answer raises a fundamental question: How can we reach the young A.A. members who are A.A.'s future?

Armed with information from the questionnaire, we consulted the computer to see if we could discern some circulation patterns. The first fact seemed paradoxical: New subscriptions

are coming in at a healthy rate, but about 2,000 subscribers a month are not renewing their subscriptions. Obviously, even though we're doing a lot of things right, there's more to the story. A second questionnaire is now on its way, asking those who did not renew to help us take our inventory.

ANN: What we're going to do now, though, is bring you a few responses of readers new and old, just as they wrote them. In selecting these comments, we have included some opinions that are the direct opposite of others—after all, this is A.A.! And we've probably chosen to bring you a larger proportion of negative viewpoints than were actually expressed, since we wanted to be fair to those readers who had gripes. Rave reviews, however, were definitely in a large majority.

JAKE: The first question was, "Do you like the Grapevine?...As much as you used to?"

VOICE 1: "Yes, I do like the magazine more now than I did in the beginning. I am more receptive to and tolerant of others' comments, feelings, and opinions. Grapevine articles frequently give me a perspective on aspects of sobriety that is different from my own. Understanding the perspectives of others, even though I may not agree with them, is important to my continuing spiritual growth."

VOICE 2: "Yes. I like it more. As I learn more about myself, I identify at greater depth with the writers."

VOICE 1: "Sort of like one day at a time, I take one Grapevine at a time. Some I've enjoyed better than others. At first, I absolutely devoured it the minute I found it in the mailbox; now, I prefer to savor it."

VOICE 2: "No. I dislike references to any addiction or compulsion other than alcoholism. I feel it could lead nonalcoholics to believe they can be helped here."

VOICE 1: "No—its articles don't really relate any stories of the ups and downs of people who have been sober beyond five years. Maybe it's what it is meant to be, but it seems like 95% of the articles are geared to help the newcomer identify."

VOICE 2: "I find the Grapevine just as informative and provocative as I did when I first subscribed. As I have aged and my tastes have changed, so have your articles and insights."

VOICE 1: "Marvelous variety. Some make me mad as hell, then I go to laughing at myself. Great therapy."

VOICE 2: "No, because the editors are human, with certain opinions, and discard letters or stories that don't reinforce and support their views."

VOICE 1: "You have a staff of very clever, wise and skilled people. God bless."

VOICE 2: "Despite what is going on in the world, A.A., or my life, there is a timelessness about the content of the Grapevine which is particularly appropriate now."

ANN: The second question was, "In this issue, what did you like the most? What didn't you like?" Since we don't have the February issue in front of us, I'll just mention one aspect of the Grapevine that many, many readers wrote was a positive—humor. They loved Ham on Wry, and Victor E., and the other cartoons. They felt it's important to lighten up, that humor is a healing force. One even called the jokes in Ham on Wry "sophisticated"—probably a first! Victor E. had many fans, as always—though some hope he'll have a feminine counterpart one day, and a few readers are beginning to wonder if he's ever going to get away from that barroom door!



JAKE: Question number 3 was, "Do you feel that the Grapevine reflects the principles of the A.A. program?"

VOICE 1: "I particularly admire the impartial presentation of controversial views; I strongly believe that controversy and the freedom to engage in it keeps A.A. vital; I resist personality cults and the notion of 'laws' and 'A.A. gospels.'"

VOICE 2: "Most of the articles focus on Steps, Traditions, and the Big Book in one way or another. They give me a general feel for how others perceive recovery and the living problems that I face. Not yet have I found an issue that did not teach me something about myself."

VOICE 1: "We are being too liberal. The Grapevine needs to stick to the same Traditions that apply to the Fellowship. We cannot bend to every special interest idea that comes along."

VOICE 2: "I appreciate the way the Grapevine provides a forum for friendly debate, so people can express their exasperation with New Age meeting topics, or the Lord's Prayer, or anything else about A.A. meetings."

VOICE 1: "I like the way the Grapevine stays out of religious issues. It neither favors articles with religious content, nor rejects them because of religious background or content."

VOICE 2: "A.A. is changing. It must change with the times. I think of the Grapevine as an unofficial Conference of unelected reps who sound out new ideas and sometimes get a rebuttal in the P.O. Box 1980 section."

ANN or JAKE: "Is the Grapevine a meeting in print?"

VOICE 1: "Yes—but I use it to augment the meetings I attend, not as a substitute for a meeting. I find myself quoting from it to other friends in recovery."

VOICE 2: "Yes, but it is more than a meeting in print because of the wide variety of topics and the in-depth articles on Traditions and other topics. And since I am a writer, I can express myself better in writing than I can in sharing in a meeting."

VOICE 1: "Yes, for two very important reasons: First, reading the Grapevine is an exercise in listening. Second, I don't spend my time trying to think of what I will say when it's my turn to share."

VOICE 2: "It's a meeting for me because of a serious hearing loss."

VOICE 1: "When I'm on the night shift at work, I can read Grapevine during my silent time and get the boost I need."

VOICE 2: "You have the opportunity to maintain the intended purpose—a meeting for drunks, not anyone else."

VOICE 1: "Definitely. I feel connected with A.A.s all over the world—in prisons, on islands, in far off lands—like I've attended their home group meeting without leaving my chair."

ANN or JAKE: "Have there been changes in the magazine that you particularly like or dislike?"

VOICE 1: "I think it keeps getting better and better. Just like the program, there is something for everyone."

VOICE 2: "The deletion of the section 'About Alcoholism' was a big mistake. The Conference sometimes does dumb things, and this was one of them. Being a former delegate, I think I am qualified to know."

VOICE 1: "Dislike. No longer sticks with individual just getting sober. Mixed-up politically-correct social issues—gays,

blacks, etc. I see no reason why the stories cannot stick to individuals getting sober."

VOICE 2: "Keep up the balance of content. I like to hear from all diverse writers—God, anti-God, women, men, blacks, Indians, gays, heteros."

VOICE 1: "Many of the articles in the Best of the Grapevine books were specific and topical. The recent issues I have read seem overloaded with thumbnail qualifications."

VOICE 2: "I loved the Grapevines of the 1960s to 1980s. The 1990s seems to be a little slanted toward 'goodness.' I need truth. The magazine seems to be 'purified' a bit lately."

VOICE 1: "I question the Spanish article. Several Mexican-Americans attend my home group, and I've given them issues, but they are not readers - like many people nowadays."

VOICE 2: "I like the Spanish part. It helps me with my Spanish lessons."

VOICE 1: "I didn't like it when Victor E. stopped wearing his hat. He doesn't seem like the same guy."

ANN or JAKE: "Are there new and different kinds of articles or features that you would like to see in the Grapevine?"

VOICE 1: A large number of readers replied briefly: "If it ain't broke, don't fix it." And a few gave tongue-in-cheek replies like "How about some sober sex and violence?" and "If you changed the Grapevine the way I wanted, I'd change my mind, and there we'd be!"

VOICE 2: The most requested change was more emphasis on history. For example, "If an organization loses track of where it comes from, it will lose its goals. Please, please dig up those archives, put those letters, stories and oral histories in articles more than you do now."

VOICE 1: Quite a few wanted to hear more from young A.A.s—like this 64-year-old reader: "I suggest an article a month geared toward youth, which might stimulate more interest in our ever-growing young membership. I go to one of their meetings and learn from them and have come to love them. They could use what the Grapevine has to offer, and the Grapevine can benefit from what they have to offer."

VOICE 2: "Don't try to get too hip."

VOICE 1: "As far as upcoming changes, I'm looking forward to the Vine Line very much."

VOICE 2: "As long as you keep doing what you've done so well for so many years—which includes growth and change, doesn't it?—I'll be one very happy alcoholic every month when I open my mailbox and discover a new Grapevine."

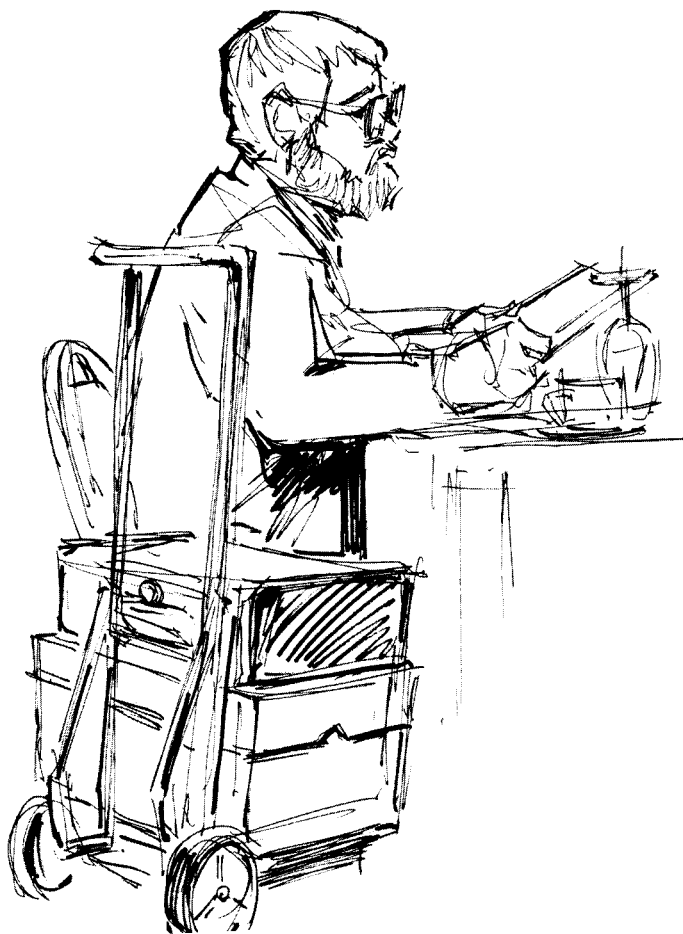
JAKE: In June 1994, the Grapevine celebrates 50 years of continuous publication. As we head into the next 50 years, we face a myriad of changes in A.A. and a continuing need to take inventory of every aspect of the magazine. Like A.A. itself, the Grapevine is a living, growing organism, and must change with the times while holding fast to the essential principles that keep each one of us alive. We hope everyone in this room will do what those 12,000 readers did, and tell us what you think about the magazine, and why. Without your help, the Grapevine will be the poorer; with your help, it can be the very best magazine possible for Alcoholics Anonymous.

*Ann Warner, Grapevine executive editor
Jacob Ham, Grapevine director
and Friends*

A.A. TAKES ITS INVENTORY — FINANCE

The Wednesday evening session began with a Finance presentation by Donald Meurer, G.S.O.'s controller. This was followed by two sharing sessions: "We Need Your Help" and "What's On Your Mind?"

My name is Don Meurer, D.M. for short. I am among the "uninitiated." The "uninitiated" is what the nonalcoholics were called way back when the Al-Anons were called the "affiliates." I picked up that phrase from the last D.M. controller Dennis



Manders, who had 35 years in the paid employ of the Fellowship. Dennis is still, in retirement, working for the Fellowship; he has a pigeon in Tennessee whom he takes to open A.A. meetings.

When I first learned that I was to lead this discussion I said, "Sure, I'm an accountant; I can talk about finance." But, as I thought about it a bit more, I said to Pat and George, "Are you sure they (whoever 'they' are) realize I'm not an alcoholic, not a Conference member, and who's inventory am I supposed to take?" I was assured it was okay, others before me had made presentations to the Conference. And here, I thought, I was only a resource!

The preface to the third edition of the Big Book tells us that, "All changes made over the years in the Big Book...have had the same purpose: to represent the current membership of Alcoholics Anonymous more accurately, and thereby to reach more alcoholics." (p. xii) Do our financial activities represent the thinking of the current membership of Alcoholics Anonymous? Who is the current membership of Alcoholics

Anonymous? Who represents it? Even this nonalcoholic knows the answer to that question. This Conference represents the A.A. membership! Or does it? I have the luxury of asking the question. You must answer it! What do we do? You know what we do. We sell books. We take contributions, and we do "stuff." What is that stuff? Who wants that stuff? Who knows what that stuff is? I know that there are many groups that don't know what that stuff is and, what's more, they don't know what G.S.O. is. Even right here in the Big Apple many members think that Intergroup is it.

Is that bad? The obvious answer is that it is terrible. How could an A.A. member, or an A.A. group for that matter, not know about G.S.O.? Then again, perhaps it doesn't matter. After all, the group got started, it did survive, it helps drunks, it's okay. What do we do for that group or member that doesn't know about us? If nothing else we print books and pamphlets, so we do help them. What else can we do for them? We won't know unless they tell us.

We have two main sources of funds which help carry the message: literature profits and contributions. I'm not here to pitch for more contributions, I'm here to pitch for financial unity. Every one has heard about the power of the purse strings. What exactly does that mean? It says in the Concepts that if the office, trustees, or Conference is going too far astray the groups can withhold support. You all know by now that contributions for the last six months have been significantly lower than anticipated. Are we doing something wrong? Who is "we"? Is everyone here "we"? If you know what it is, are we correcting it? How far up or down the structure tree does the power of the purse go? Is your General Service Office feeling the effects of other developments or issues within the service structure that manifest themselves in less support for the office?

We could raise prices to cover costs of the services but, as you all know, A.A. doesn't want to work that way! Or does it? For the record, in our view ("our" being current management of your office) a major increase in prices to support services should only come after a clear message from the Fellowship indicated that all services provided were required, wanted or needed and that contributions were insufficient to cover cost of these services.

This raises an interesting question. Who's job is it to do that unmentionable task (which I will aggressively term "attract voluntary contributions")? Who carries the message to Joe or Josephine A.A. member about the services provided at all levels of service, including G.S.O.?

Over the years the Conference Finance Committee has offered suggestions concerning contributions, ways and reasons to remind the Fellowship of A.A.'s needs. The Conferences have supported them. In my office I have a notebook which contains copies of letters, sent over the past 25 years, with each group's quarterly contributions statement. These letters have come from various people, including the general manager, treasurer, assistant treasurer, a regional trustee or two, and even me. I will now rephrase my prior question. Who's job is it to lovingly attract voluntary contributions to support services which many have never heard of? How do we spend your money? I'll bet even members of the trustees' and Conference Finance Committees would have a hard time explaining it.

We have the usual expenses related to running an office that any business operation (even A.A.) would have. Salaries, payroll taxes, insurance, rent, postage, stationery, meetings, office equipment, telephone, pensions, professional fees, etc. Then we have other expenses that are related to A.A. services. For example:

Box 4-5-9. Each group (more than 50,000) gets one free, six-times a year. It is also translated into French and Spanish.

Actually, not every group gets one free, only the groups that we know about. All registered groups receive a copy, whether they contribute or not. Our Box 4-5-9 budget for 1993 is approximately \$190,000. If contributions continue to decline should we eliminate some of the issues? Should we produce Box 4-5-9 four or five times a year instead of six?

Another A.A. line item expense is called Other Service Printing, budgeted in 1993 budget at about \$300,000. One item that comes under Other Service Printing is the *Quarterly Report*. You all know what it is, we print it three times a year to report on board weekends. Do you hear about it at your group? At a regular meeting? At a business meeting? Also in this expense account are New Group Handbooks, G.S.R. kits, the *Loners-International Meetings*, G.S.O. staff assignment sheets (so you know who to call), quarterly contribution letters, and lots of pamphlets that are distributed free of charge, e.g., "A Message to Teenagers," "Your G.S.O.," and "Problems Other Than Alcohol." Keep in mind that if we do a piece of literature in English we try to do it in French and Spanish, too. Still another item are the A.A. Directories, which cost A.A. about \$50,000 a year. Most are given away.

Then there are meetings and travel—directors meetings, trustees meetings, directors and trustees travel expenses in the regions—even to events that regions or areas may not be able to fully fund. Why is it that trustees now turn in expenses to G.S.O. that were formerly covered by the areas? Has the country's economic situation also taken a toll on the Fellowship, or have things changed so that the money just doesn't go all the way around? Are some activities now being duplicated or triplicated? Should we rethink how we provide service? Should we rethink what the service is? There are Regional Forums and—not to be forgotten—this Conference. Travel and meeting expenses, I assume, are necessary, as our primary purpose is carrying the message. This I imagine means going, seeing, speaking and sharing—all with our primary purpose in mind. I know what it costs us, I can only begin to imagine what it costs the entire Fellowship at the various levels!

We have an expense item called C.P.C., Cooperation With the Professional Community. Exhibits are sent all over the country to conferences and seminars attended by various professional groups. These exhibits are staffed by local A.A. members, and coordinated by the staff member on the C.P.C. assignment. Did you know that? Do your groups know that?

Another expense category is Public Information, which deals with such items as mailings to the media and explaining our Traditions of anonymity. The P.I. assignment and trustees' P.I. Committee also deal with the Membership Survey, radio/TV spots and other public information matters.

We even have a line item called Bad Debts. Even though ours is an honest program, each year we do have to "write off" an amount as "uncollectable." Some of these are a direct result of the economy, e.g., bankruptcies of trade purchasers outside the Fellowship. However, sometimes we do lose track of people within the Fellowship. We do try to track people down, but sometimes we loose them.

I mentioned Regional Forums, which began in the 1970s. The Regional Forum budget for 1993 is approximately \$90,000. This represents the direct costs of four regular Forums and one special Forum. Are these Forums as relevant today as they were 20 years ago? Do they serve the original purpose?

What was the original purpose?

Please do not in any way think I am in favor of doing away with the Conference. The budget for this Conference is approximately \$425,000, before deducting delegate fees and area contributions of approximately \$65,000. The net cost is in the neighborhood of \$360,000. Having said that I don't want to do away with the Conference, I will say that of the \$360,000 net Conference budget about \$90,000, or 25%, has been allocated to the production of the Box 4-5-9 Early Bird edition and the *Conference Final Report*. Did you know that the *Conference Final Report* is sent free to every registered group: English, French and Spanish? Not so many years ago this was not so. We only printed five or ten thousand of them. They were distributed to the delegates, D.C.M.s, etc., gratis, and if anyone else wanted one they were available for purchase. If the average A.A. group member reads and discusses the *Conference Final Report*, it is worth the cost?

I can ask the question. I have to rely on you to answer it.

One final thought on where your money goes—that I'm sure very few group members are aware of—foreign literature assistance. When a need is expressed for literature in a country that may or may not have a service structure, we try to help. It may take the form of checking translations, actual translations, printing or distributing literature. We hope that some day we may see some return of funds as the evolving A.A. structure strives to become self-supporting. However, we have spent a few hundred thousand dollars on this activity recently. The World Service Meeting has begun to organize a world literature fund, but at this point it is in its infancy.

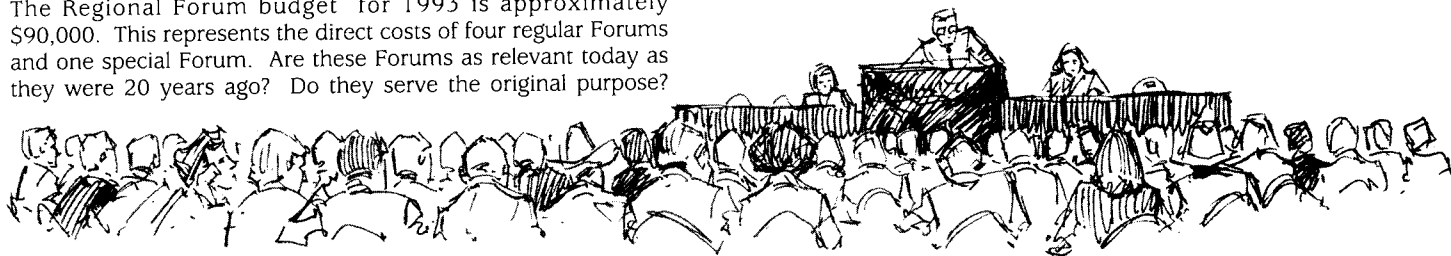
How are you spending your money? How are we spending your money? These are some of the ways. We are trying to spend it more effectively. I can say that the old standard response, "because we have always done it that way" is now the joke that makes us rethink our actions.

I am more aware than ever that we are a service organization. Sometimes service means change, sometimes it means staying the same, most of the time it just means listening, answering a question and letting people know we are available.

If I understand this process correctly, in making this presentation I was to have made a searching and fearless moral inventory of our financial affairs. I have tried to raise issues that can be dealt with by moving forward, rather than by dwelling on the past, which would have involved taking other peoples' inventories, which we do not do in A.A.

As far as I will go in taking anyone's inventory is to say that I have worked with four general managers and as many Grapevine management teams, many trustees and directors, and we all have different personalities. When we stick to principles before personalities, it works. When we don't, we go astray. When we all work as a team it works. When we don't, it doesn't. We have to trust that collectively we can mix A.A. principles with good common business sense and come out on the right track. As the Concepts tell us—money and spirituality do have to mix.

Donald Meurer, G.S.O. controller



TWELFTH WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Saturday morning, prior to the farewell talks by rotating trustees, there was a report on the recent World Service Meeting.

Two years ago I had the privilege of reporting before the 41st General Service Conference and reporting on the 11th World Service Meeting in Munich, Germany, the previous October. I am once again privileged to report on another World Service Meeting, the 12th, which was held in this very hotel last October 25-29, 1992.

For those of you who may not be entirely familiar with this World Service Meeting, let me give you a little background. In 1967, Bill saw the need for an international exchange of experiences in the areas of public relations, anonymity, self-support as well as relations with medicine, religion and professionals. He recognized that "New York could not forever provide general services to all the A.A. countries that occupy the vast regions of the world." He also recognized that our General Service Conference could not continue to be the beacon of light to the rest of the world without representation from other countries. So with the blessing of the trustees and the approval of the Conference, the World Service Meeting was born; our first meeting was held in 1969.

At the last meeting the following countries or regions were represented by 39 delegates: Argentina, Australia, Belgium, Brazil, Central America (Northern Zone), Colombia, Finland, French-speaking Europe, German-speaking Europe, Great Britain, Iceland, Ireland, Italy, Japan, Mexico, New Zealand, Norway, Poland, South Africa, Spain, Sweden, and the United States and Canada.

The format of the World Service Meeting is similar to this Conference. The meeting started on Sunday afternoon with a red ball A.A. meeting. This was followed by a wonderful rendition of the Traditions Play performed by the "not ready for prime time players" from 475 Riverside Drive. Following dinner we heard the keynote address by Roberto from Mexico, and then immediately went into the presentation of country highlights. At the conclusion of our first day, at 9:45 p.m., David [David O'Leary, trustee-at-large/Canada] and I led a large group to Howard Johnson's, a ritual which we were to follow every evening, except for the obligatory visit to Rumpelmayers.

The following days were filled with presentations, workshops and committee meetings. I urge all of you to read the presentations made during this meeting, and especially those pertaining to the Twelve Concepts. This particular World Service Meeting was not only impacted by discussions from the previous meeting in Munich, but by one of our Regional Forums as well. Those of you who are familiar with the report of the 11th World Service Meeting will recall that it was generally agreed that the cost of translating literature into other languages should not be borne solely by the U.S. and Canada.

The delegates unanimously agreed that an International Literature Fund be established for that purpose.

In June 1991, I attended the Northeast Regional Forum in Bethesda, Maryland, and gave my report about the role of the trustee-at-large and the World Service Meeting. My report also included remarks about my recent trip to Czechoslovakia and a reference to the budget for foreign literature assistance.

Later that evening a question was asked from the floor by an African member from Kenya, inquiring about efforts to carry the message to Africa. I went to the microphone and answered that at the World Service Meeting in Munich one of the delegates from South Africa reported that they had translated the Big Book into several dialects within their country. I also

said that I was not aware of any other work being done.

At the break I was approached by several African-Americans who felt that my answer was evasive, adding that Africa consisted of considerably more countries than South Africa. They thought that our efforts in Eastern Europe were at the expense of Africa. I assured them that was not the case and explained that our focus on Europe was in response to an expressed need. To my knowledge, such a need had not been expressed by or on behalf of anyone else in Africa.

On Saturday, Sarah Price and I met with the member from Kenya to discuss this matter further. Sarah explained that several years ago a translation of the Big Book in Swahili had been reviewed, but that we heard nothing further. We also explained that our recent efforts were a result of expressed needs and that until he raised the question we had not been approached about Africa for several years. He told us that he was going back to Kenya for a visit. We asked him to contact us upon his return and, with the assumption that the need was still there, we would resume our efforts to complete this translation.

Sunday morning, during the sharing session, I related this story, starting with Friday night's question and our subsequent meeting with the member from Kenya. I explained that we had reviewed a translation of the Big Book several years ago but that the project died after we had no further response. I am happy to report, that as a result of the question and subsequent discussions, that we again committed our efforts to this translation. The Big Book in Swahili has recently been published.

This experience prompted me to ask myself why we hadn't anticipated this need in Africa. Were there other situations in the world like this one where there was a need for our written message? Were we truly carrying the message if we wait for suffering alcoholics to come forward and ask for literature in their language? Should we somehow assess needs for literature assistance before the need is expressed? Are alcoholics somewhere in the world dying because the hand of A.A. isn't there yet?

It also prompted me to review the Composition, Scope and Procedures of the trustees' International Committee. It reads: "The committee has the responsibility of suggesting to the trustees' policies and actions which will result in carrying the message to alcoholics overseas, particularly in countries where there is no service structure established." It appears to me that we had been overwhelmed in responding to expressed needs and had not had the time to look in different directions. I then asked the International Committee to consider ways in which we would be more visionary, as implied in our Scope and Procedure.

The committee concurred that we had been working in a "reactive" manner and that a master plan to assess the needs for A.A. literature should be developed. A subcommittee was formed to review this question and it concluded that a more visionary approach should be taken in determining needs for literature assistance but suggested that perhaps this task be undertaken by the World Service Meeting. The International Committee then suggested that the topic "The Future of the World Service Meeting" be discussed at the next World Service Meeting.

It was my privilege to be one of the presenters on this topic, along with Charles from Great Britain and Martti from Finland. As you will read in the *Final Report*, some very visionary ideas were offered in these presentations. The Literature/Publishing Committee of the World Service Meeting also took great strides by implementing the framework whereby this visionary approach could be accomplished. This committee made the



following recommendation, which was passed by the World Service Meeting:

"The committee discussed at length ways to improve, enhance and satisfy literature needs around the world and agreed that an attempt should be made to assess the need for literature on a worldwide basis. The committee felt that the most effective way is to utilize the resources of the delegates to the World Service Meeting and the European and Ibero-American meetings. The committee recommended that the secretary of the World Service Meeting write each General Service Office and World Service delegate requesting they share what their countries are doing in carrying the message to neighboring countries; what literature translations have been done within and outside their countries; what other languages are needed within their countries and whether or not they need monetary help for the International Literature Fund to accomplish this."

The committee also agreed that the International Literature Fund should be under the purview of the World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee but that A.A.W.S. should, in effect, administer it.

The committee also recommended "...that the secretary of the Literature/Publishing Committee write all General Service Offices asking them to share their experiences in sponsoring other countries and report this information to the 1994 World Service Meeting Literature/Publishing Committee." This recommendation was also passed.

While it was evident to me two years earlier that the 12th World Service Meeting would deal further with the issue of worldwide literature assistance, who would have predicted the profound effect that one question raised in Bethesda would have had on this meeting? This example alone should encourage participation at all levels of service.

On Thursday afternoon emotions were running high as each of the second-term delegates was asked to make some closing remarks. I told my fellow delegates that if I had the choice of which type of Class B trustee I wanted to be—regional trustee, general service trustee or trustee-at-large—I would pick trustee-

at-large, just for the privilege of being a delegate to the World Service Meeting and being with them.

After the closing talk by our chairman, Michael Alexander, 15 delegates were called to the front of the room. I wish all of you could experience the feelings we had at that time. Here we were, 39 delegates from all walks of life, from different cultures, most of us having survived the living hell of alcoholism (there were two Class A trustees as delegates); all of us indebted to the Fellowship; all of us having been given the privilege of serving A.A. in our country in a very special way; all of us having expressed that the past few days were among the most spiritual of our lives. And now the meeting had come to an end. There was not a sound in the room as each of the 15 delegates, one after the other, recited the Serenity Prayer in their native language: Spanish, English, Flemish, Portuguese, French, Finnish, German, Icelandic, Irish, Italian, Japanese, Norwegian, Polish, Afrikaans, Swedish.

Can you imagine how I felt? Only a few years ago, A.A. was the last place I wanted to be and here I was with a very special group of people.

Fortunately, most of the delegates stayed for the board weekend. I continued to wear my World Service delegate badge, and each time they were asked to stand at various meetings I stood with them, proudly. Sunday morning I had some free time and took a group of them downtown to the World Trade Center and the financial district for some sightseeing. Then, inevitably Monday morning came and it was time to go home. The goodbyes were not easy, and I may never see some of them again. But I take great comfort in the fact that together we had done God's work and that maybe some day, just maybe, a life perhaps still unborn will find the doors of A.A. in some obscure part of the world because of something we did at this World Service Meeting.

John Quinn, trustee-at-large/U.S.

Monday evening, Class A trustee John Chappel, appearing on the dais in a golf shirt and cardigan, said, "The reason I moved to Nevada was so I wouldn't have to wear a necktie. Besides, you might think I was Mike Alexander."

Tuesday, Mike Alexander came back with, "I'm John Chappel with a shave and a necktie."

Reports from the General Service Board, Trustees' Committees, and G.S.O.

These annual reports are submitted to each Conference—via its committees in cases where there are counterparts to the board entities; directly, where there are no counterparts. Unless the Conference as a whole takes some action to the contrary, acceptance of the reports indicates Conference approval of the activities and recommendations included.

GENERAL SERVICE BOARD

Trustees' report: This year, as for the past several years, we invited the chairpersons of the Conference committees to the quarterly meeting of the trustees held at the end of January. The chairpersons, who attended sessions of the corresponding trustees' committees, were also free to attend other meetings of the trustees, including the meeting of the board. The presence of the chairpersons at this meeting starts the sharing process that culminates in the annual Conference in April. Having seen how useful it is to have the chairpersons present at the January meeting, we wonder why we didn't think of it sooner.

The same may be said of the informal session of delegates and trustees at Regional Forums, a practice we continued during the past year. Here, too, participation is by invitation and no one is required to attend, although most do. The sharing that goes on among delegates and trustees at these get-togethers reminds us that the Conference is in session throughout the year.

For similar reasons and with similar effect, the trustees of the General Service Board and the directors of the two service corporations, A.A.W.S. and the A.A. Grapevine, have started to convene informally on the Friday preceding the quarterly board meetings. We held three such informal meetings during the past year, each conducted without an agenda. The topics were initiated at the meeting, and typically included matters that were of interest on a broad basis to all those attending. The meetings helped us to identify issues that might require further attention and to decide who should be asked to look into these issues. We think the meetings produced much useful information that has facilitated the work of the trustees and directors.

The 12th World Service Meeting convened in New York last October, with 39 delegates from 22 countries in attendance. The week of general sessions was characterized by harmony and spirituality, and accompanied by many expressions of gratitude, humility and affection. In their deliberations, the delegates seldom strayed from their primary purpose, that is, how best to deliver the A.A. message to the still-suffering

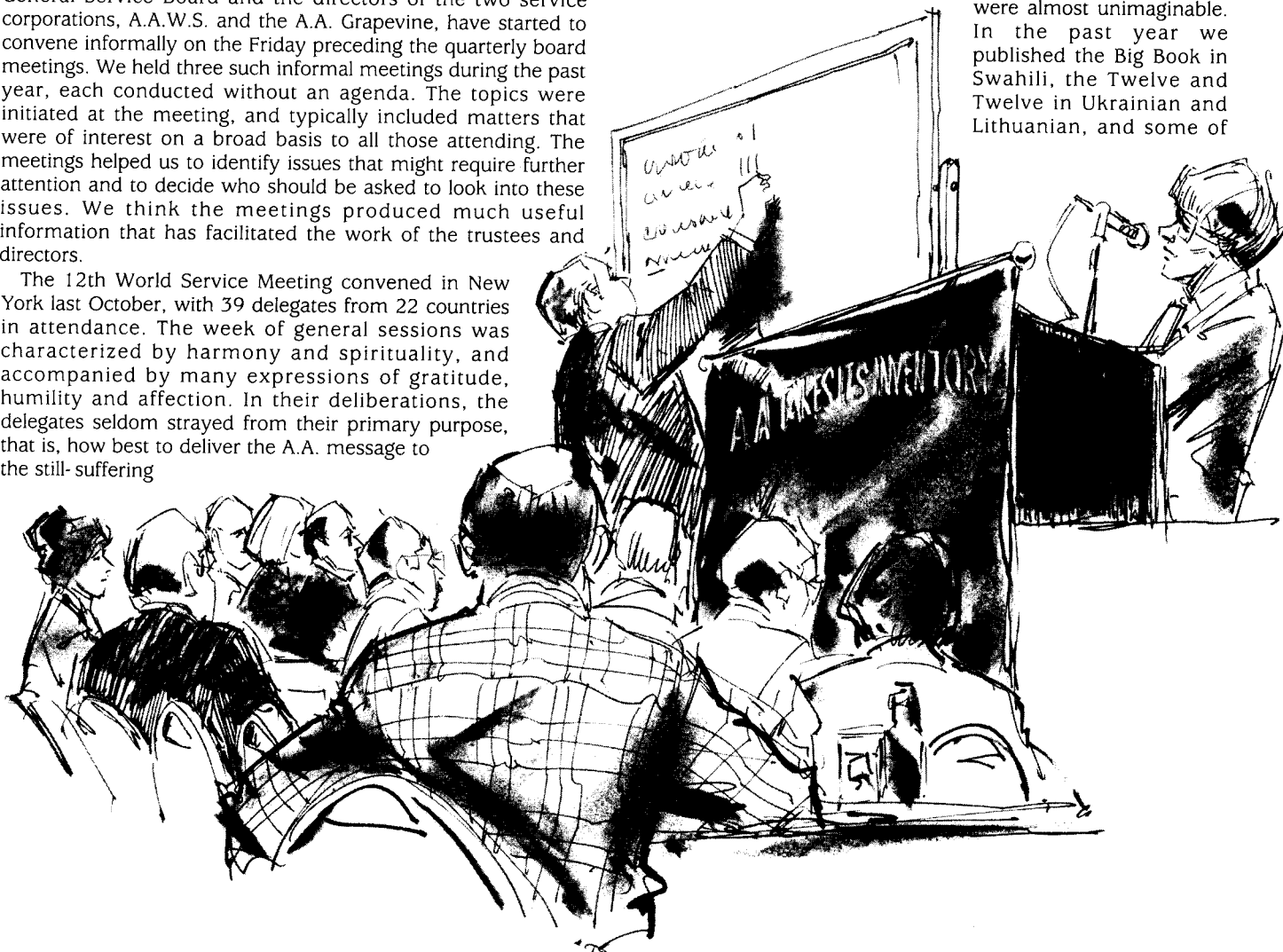
alcoholic. They did not allow themselves to be distracted by lesser concerns.

When in doubt, the delegates took a measured look at the Steps, Traditions and Concepts, and then reached a consensus without prolonged discussion. Along the way, they demonstrated an abiding faith in our Fellowship and a determination to extend the helping hand of A.A. to every alcoholic who may have need of it.

The same spirit and attitude were manifest at the last two A.A. Regional Forums—one at Whitehorse, Canada, in October, and the other at Virginia Beach, Virginia, in December. The impromptu sharing at those Forums also focused frankly and intently on how to fulfill our primary purpose—to reach the alcoholic who needs the help of A.A. At Virginia Beach, for example, early in the first sharing session, an A.A. member asked, "How do you handle a wet drunk?" The discussion generated by this apparently modest question, and surely fundamental concern, dominated all the remaining sharing sessions. Perhaps the most telling observation came from an oldtimer who said that 30 or 40 years ago wet drunks were the only kind we encountered. Throughout the sharing, most emphatically recalled was the ever-present and basic need for individual sponsorship of newcomers to A.A.

The inspiringly vigorous growth of A.A. worldwide does, of course, oblige us frequently to revise and amplify our understanding of the word "basic" as it applies to service. As the World Service Meeting so plainly disclosed, A.A. is reaching out to alcoholics in places and in ways that, only a few years ago,

were almost unimaginable. In the past year we published the Big Book in Swahili, the Twelve and Twelve in Ukrainian and Lithuanian, and some of



Romanian. All told, the Big Book is now available in 25 different languages, and a substantial part of other A.A. recovery literature has been translated into many different languages. We have also produced a video of the Big Book in American Sign Language for the hearing-impaired. A Braille edition of that basic text for the sight-impaired is also available.

While we recognize that as alcoholics we are all the same, equally powerless in our common affliction, equally transformed by spiritual experience, equally and humbly grateful and joyful in sobriety, love and service, we have learned, too, that the A.A. message is best delivered in the language and form that the individual alcoholic most readily understands. Our efforts to render the A.A. message accurately in as many languages and forms as our skills and resources permit reflect our conviction and our resolve that no alcoholic, man or woman, young or old, rich or poor, able or disabled, wherever that alcoholic may be, should be denied the A.A. message.

Alcoholism knows no boundaries, respects no class, spares no race and exempts no creed. In our response to the challenge of alcoholism, we too must recognize no boundaries, must be likewise indifferent to the chance distinctions and circumstantial obstacles of class, race and creed. To meet this challenge, to overcome these barriers, is our solemn pledge, a pledge so often expressed in the words: "I am responsible...When anyone, anywhere reaches out for help, I want the hand of A.A. always to be there. And for that: I am responsible." With grace of God, we will keep that pledge.

Michael Alexander, chairman

A.A. WORLD SERVICES, INC.

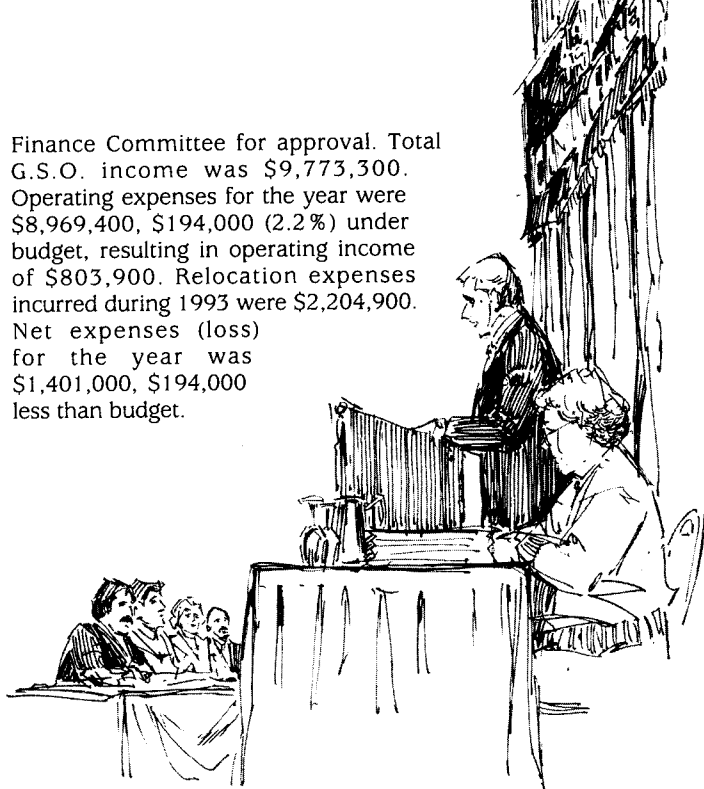
Directors' report: A.A. World Services, Inc., is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. It has the delegated responsibility to maintain oversight of group services, including printing and distribution of Conference-approved and service literature, effected by G.S.O. The board meets monthly to: hear G.S.O. management and staff reports; review group service activity and progress on compliance with Conference and board recommendations; review budgets, expenditures, and salary policy; establish price for literature and other materials; discuss publishing operations and matters of G.S.O. administration; consider requests from A.A.s and non-A.A.s for permission to reprint A.A. copyrighted literature and address other matters as they arise.

There are nine A.A.W.S. directors: currently, five are trustees, including two regional trustees; two are nontrustee directors; one is the G.S.O. general manager; one is the staff coordinator. Also attending board meetings, but not voting, are other G.S.O. staff members, the controller, assistant controller/business administrator, the services director, the publications director, director of human resources, the financial consultant (as of March 1992), and the secretary. In addition, a Grapevine staff member is usually present.

The committees of the A.A.W.S. Board are: Publishing, which addresses reprints, foreign literature and publications concerns; Finance and Administration, which addresses concerns of salary and budget, audit review, and retirement; Services, which addresses the needs of all service assignments; and Nominating. Long-range planning is done within each committee and by the board as a whole. The following items of significance are noted:

Budget: The 1992 budget was recommended to the trustees'

Finance Committee for approval. Total G.S.O. income was \$9,773,300. Operating expenses for the year were \$8,969,400, \$194,000 (2.2%) under budget, resulting in operating income of \$803,900. Relocation expenses incurred during 1993 were \$2,204,900. Net expenses (loss) for the year was \$1,401,000, \$194,000 less than budget.



The 1993 budget, as recommended to the trustees' Finance Committee, projects net sales of approximately \$9,383,000; with "gross profit" after manufacturing costs and royalties of 56.3% and contributions of approximately \$4,000,000. Total operating expenses are projected at \$9,064,000. Net operating income is projected as \$231,700. No nonrecurring items are expected.

Transfer of Funds: At the March 1992 meeting, the board authorized the transfer of \$650,000 to the Reserve Fund.

Budget Limitation: The board reviewed the A.A.W.S. Bylaw regarding the \$10,000 budget limitation which reads: "Prior to the commencement of each fiscal year of the corporation, the President of the Corporation shall prepare a budget setting forth the anticipated income and expense of the Corporation for the ensuing fiscal year and shall submit budget for approval at the First Meeting of the Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., after January 1st of such ensuing year. No additional project costing in excess of \$10,000 (ten thousand dollars) which is not included in said budget in the form approved by the meeting of the Trustees of the General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc., shall be authorized by the Board of Directors, or by the President, or any employee of the corporation, unless such expenditure is specifically approved by the Finance Committee of the General Service Board at any regular or special meeting of said committee." After reviewing this language the directors felt no increase will be needed. While there are variances exceeding \$10,000 for certain budget lines, the board will continue to work within the limits with respect to new projects. This was communicated to the trustees' Finance Committee.

Salary: The A.A.W.S. Board accepted the recommendation of its Finance and Administration Committee that budgeted exempt salary increases be implemented effective as of July 1, 1992. Raises were deferred at the request of the treasurer of the General Service Board, pending the meeting of the trustees' Finance and Budgetary Committee.

Merit Pay: The board continued addressing the Conference Action regarding an equitable pay system for staff and at our

March, 1993 meeting authorized the general manager to implement a plan incorporating the principle of parity.

Litigation: A.A.W.S. settled the real estate brokerage litigation immediately after the August board meeting.

Contract Dispute: The contract dispute with the writer of the A.A. History Book, which arose following the 1992 Conference, was settled.

Book Distribution: In 1992, we sold 245,400 (or 10.1 %) fewer units than 1991. Total book sales to A.A. purchasers were 166,720 (or 12 %) fewer books than the previous year.

Foreign Literature Assistance: The board approved the cost of approximately \$10,780 to typeset, proofread and print 1,000 copies each of pamphlets in Bulgarian, Hungarian, Latvian and Romanian. The Foreign Literature Assistance Budget included \$10,000 for "unanticipated expenses." The board approved \$25,000 to edit, typeset, proofread and manufacture 1,000 copies of the Swahili Big Book. As the Twelve and Twelve was not done in 1992, there were sufficient funds to apply to the production of this translation. The board agreed to publish the Ukrainian translation of the Twelve and Twelve, and the Farsi translation of the Big Book. The central office in Oahu, Hawaii, has offered to bring a mimeographed translation of the Tagalog Big Book up to standard, and will send the translation here to be checked.

The committee appointed a subcommittee to propose a policy and recommendations regarding foreign literature assistance.

Pricing: Hungarian pamphlets ("Is A.A. for You?", "44 Questions," and "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic") were priced at \$.75, \$2.35, and \$1.90. "The A.A. Group" in Hungarian, and "Letter to a Woman Alcoholic" in Bulgarian were priced at \$2.80 and \$1.75 respectively. Four pamphlets in Romanian ("Is A.A. for You?", "This is A.A.," "Understanding Anonymity" and "If You are a Professional") were priced at \$1.45, \$1.95, \$1.65 and \$1.55, and "44 Questions" in Latvian at \$2.35.

The new P.I. video, "A.A.—Rap With Us," was priced at \$15.00 and the TV P.S.A.s at \$10.75. The cassette version of "A.A. in Prison: Inmate to Inmate" was priced at \$2.25. Posters in Spanish of the Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions were each priced at \$6.55. The Big Book in Danish (in two volumes) priced at \$26.25; Spanish hardcover Big Book was priced at \$5.00; the Swahili Big Book at \$14.00; and the Ukrainian Twelve and Twelve at \$7.95; Spanish "Pass It On" at \$14.15; and Lithuanian Twelve and Twelve at \$5.25. Spanish "Markings on the Journey" video-cassette was priced at \$16.00. The 20 % discount applies to all these materials.

Also priced were Spanish VHS cassettes of "Bill's Own Story" and "Bill Discusses the Twelve Traditions," each at a weekly rental of \$35.00 and long-term lease of \$80.00.

The American Sign Language video: The ASL Big Book video was priced at \$38.00. The 20 % discount applies.

Spanish Literature: Service pieces continue to be translated into Spanish.

Fulfillment Time: The Publications Department analyzed a selected sample of literature orders and found that orders are shipped within 3-4 days of receipt and received within 6-8 days.

Prices on Miscellaneous and Foreign Items: The board approved the recommendation of the committee to raise prices on miscellaneous items such as: literature racks, cassette albums, Steps and Traditions shades, and books published by foreign G.S.O.s. We were selling some of these items below our cost. This increase was effective in mid-March.

Fourth Edition of the Big Book: The committee will discuss producing a Fourth Edition of the Big Book, an issue which is also being addressed by the trustees' Literature Committee.

Foreign Literature Assistance: The committee appointed a subcommittee to propose a policy and recommendations regarding foreign literature assistance.

Director Candidates: The committee interviewed four candidates for A.A.W.S. director. Two were recommended to the A.A.W.S. Board which, in turn, approved the recommendations and forwarded the names to the trustees' Nominating Committee.

World Service Meeting: This meeting was held in New York City, October 26-28. In attendance were 39 delegates from 22 countries, the trustees-at-large from the U.S. and Canada, and five representatives from G.S.O. It was a wonderful, sharing, spiritual experience. The next meeting is scheduled to be held in Cartagena, Colombia, October 1994.

Directors: As of May 1992, Ann Bruning replaced Jan Whitney as trustee-director, and Peter Brock replaced Hugh Freyer as director. The board accepted the resignation of Everett Smethurst, and John Quinn was elected to fill this vacancy.

Consultant: Gary Glynn was invited to serve as a consultant on the A.A.W.S. Board, and to have an active role on the Salary and Budget Committee, for a period of one year, which commenced with the March 1992 meeting.

Individual Birthday Plan: This computer-monitored plan, which was instituted in 1991, was discontinued per 1992 Conference Action.

Highlights: The board approved sending a monthly communications piece, summarizing its board meeting, to all Conference members. The piece is entitled "A.A.W.S. Highlights."

Little Big Book: A private organization, which calls itself Intergroup World Services, Inc., has been selling an abridged version of the Big Book. We have written to the delegates, central offices and World Service Meeting delegates explaining that this is not a G.S.O. publication. The publisher has been contacted explaining the board's concerns, and we are waiting to hear from them.

A.A.W.S. Inventory: The board met for the purpose of taking its inventory. The questions were grouped into two parts: 1) The A.A.W.S. Board as a service provider, and 2) the A.A.W.S. board member. At the conclusion, the board as a whole, and as individual members, felt renewed and recommitted to be the best it can be. It will work even harder to provide responsible service with humility, reliant on help from a Higher Power in conducting all its affairs.

Medallions: Per Conference Action, the office conducted and prepared a feasibility study exploring all the issues related to possible methods by which medallions may be made available to the Fellowship. The results were provided to the General Service Board.

Open House: Since such a function would primarily attract members from the Northeast, it was felt that A.A.W.S. should ask for input from the General Service Board or Conference before going forward.

Regional Forums: A.A.W.S. directors and G.S.O. staff members coordinated and attended five Regional Forums in 1992: Western Canada, in Vancouver, B.C.; Pacific, in Santa Clara, CA; Eastern Canada, in Hull, Ottawa; Special Forum, in Whitehorse,

Estimates of Groups and Members as of January 1, 1993

	Groups	Members
United States	50,325	1,135,395
Canada	5,275	94,986
Correctional facilities	1,915	47,701 ¹
Internationalists		252
Lone members		435
Total	57,515	1,278,769
Outside U.S. & Canada	31,700	770,185 ²
Total	89,215	2,048,954

1. U.S. and Canada only.

2. We attempted to contact all groups and general service offices outside the U.S. and Canada which were listed in our records. Twenty-two general service offices responded with updated membership. In the past, an attempt was made to estimate membership figures for the countries not responding. The estimated figures were calculated with the reported figures to obtain international membership. Since we could not substantiate the international figures, we are now reporting only actual figures as they were reported to us. G.S.O. has records for A.A. groups in 141 countries including the U.S. and Canada. We can accurately state that we have reported members from 129 countries.

The estimated group counts in the U.S. and Canada include only those that ask to be listed at G.S.O.; thousands do not.

Among listed groups in the U.S. and Canada, many do not report membership figures. For each nonreporting group, an estimate of membership is arrived at by taking an average among reporting groups within the Conference area concerned. Even among reporting groups, membership figures include only those now active and attending meetings; there is no way to count sober members who no longer have a home group.

Yukon; and Southeastern, in Virginia Beach, VA.

Group Information: Management formed a task force to review and find ways to improve our records-keeping procedures. As of August 1st, group information has been available on disks, along with group contribution information, for areas that keep records on computer.

G.S.O. Inventory: G.S.O. staff, general manager and the services director met in December for the purpose of taking the G.S.O. inventory. There was lengthy discussion concerning the attitudes and procedures of the staff with respect to the General Service Board, the Conference, and the Fellowship as a whole. This process will continue; among areas to be addressed is one where each staff member will evaluate his/her assignment from the standpoint of relevance of each task and function to the service needs of the Fellowship.

Flex-time: In June, G.S.O. implemented a flex-time work week for G.S.O. employees on a trial basis for three months. Overall, it has been a success, and has been renewed for a six-month period.

Computer: The General Ledger chart of accounts has been simplified. The financial statements have been redesigned and we expect to be able to utilize the computer for financial reporting in 1993.

The Central Office/Intergroup/A.A.W.S. Seminar: This Seminar was held in Mesa, AZ, September 17-20, and was the first to be coordinated by a selected intergroup. There were approximately

180 in attendance, including trustee and director participation, as well as G.S.O. staff. The general sharing on common intergroup problems was outstanding. The next Seminar will be held in Baltimore, MD, September 16-19, 1993.

Convention Site: Four members of the office staff visited San Diego, the host city for the 1995 International Convention. In addition to visiting all the major facilities and meetings with Hotel and Convention Bureau personnel, George Dorsey and Eileen Gatzka attended the San Diego/Imperial Assembly. Their reports on the facilities were very enthusiastic. The Convention facility, stadium and all of the surrounding support facilities are very adequate, and San Diego is delighted to have us.

Jean Smith, chairperson

ARCHIVES

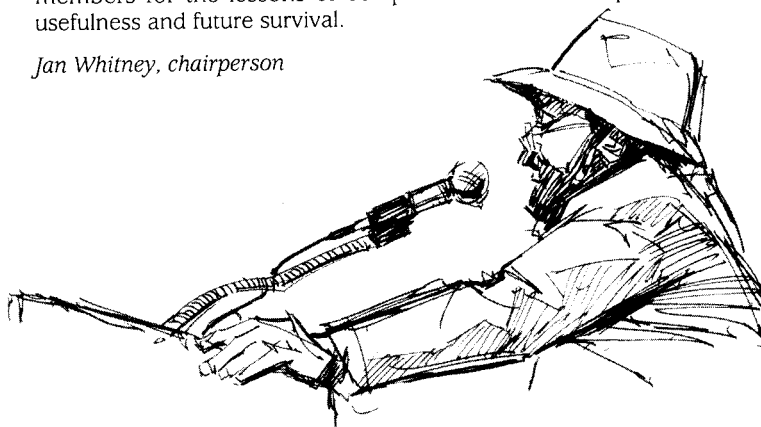
Trustees' committee: Our committee met three times since the 42nd General Service Conference, and a wide range of concerns were addressed. Much planning was required in facilitating the move to our new home at 475 Riverside Drive, and assuring that our historical documents were packed, shipped and reassembled in a most careful way. The result was a fully satisfactory transition; not a document was lost.

Another item involved fashioning a plan to include a "group start-up date" on the information sheet that is supplied to groups annually. While these are the dates that G.S.O. first learned of the group, they can be further refined to reflect the actual birth date with the assistance of area archivists and/or the groups themselves. When gathered and arranged in chronological order, a clear indication of how A.A. spread in each area would be seen. A group would then know "their place in line" within the A.A. community.

This year we embarked on a project to gather background on past Conference Advisory Actions and related matters from surviving past members of the General Service Conference. Some 52 people from the first ten Conferences (1951 through 1960) were contacted. Nine have responded with additional written memories and five of these will provide an oral history as well. The result will be a "fleshed-out" look at the thinking behind important Conference Actions. It is planned to have this effort move on to the second ten-year grouping of General Service Conferences.

A list of local archivists and members interested in things archival, who are agreeable to having their names available to others of their kind, has been prepared. The growing involvement in the historical aspects of our Fellowship has built up quite a communication network. Our committee will continue to provide for and foster this interest among our members for the lessons of our past are relevant to present usefulness and future survival.

Jan Whitney, chairperson



Archivist's report: Since our last report to the Fellowship, the Archives has moved to an expanded space within the new General Service Office. Substantially more exhibit area has been made available, including a large display case, 18'x7', with special glass to prevent damage to the enclosed documents. We have also gained increased storage capacity. This, however, is rapidly being filled, as 1992 was a stellar year for contributions of historical material.

In no small measure, our dreams have been realized. Just as our co-founders yearned for a large, well-regarded, spiritual community of sober members, the early archivally-minded A.A.s ached for their fellow members to display an interest in our roots. Judging from the evidence of our mail, phone calls, and now faxes, serious study is indeed being made of our history, which may in turn provide necessary and relevant guidance to today's experiences.

Our prayers have been answered then. The relation of our Fellowship's spectacular growth to a real need to look back at who we are and where we came from is marked to many of our member/historians. Are we looking to rediscover ourselves? If so, that would explain the growth in our archival correspondence.

Markings, our archival newsletter, had two mailings during the past year. The content consisted mainly of presentations by area archivists on local experiences.

We'd love to have more of that kind of quality sharing on the opportunity of bringing our past forward into our todays.

Frank Mauser, archivist

CONFERENCE

Trustees' committee: The committee met three times since the 1992 General Service Conference. Over that period we reviewed the 1992 Advisory Actions pertaining to the General Service Conference and approved that the theme for the 43rd General Service Conference be: "A.A. Takes Its Inventory—The General Service Conference Structure."

The committee also recommended that the Conference presentation/discussion topics focus on A.A. taking its inventory, using six of the articles of the Conference Charter for presentations. It was also recommended that the Conference Workshops be titled: "A Vision for Us—Where Are We and Where Are We Going?" and that one workshop be on the Conference theme with the focus on the six articles of the Conference Charter not covered in the presentation/discussion topics.

Conference members who wish to will have the option of visiting the General Service Office early Monday morning before the Conference session starts. This will allow more time for questions and sharing during Conference time. The committee reviewed all items submitted for the 1993 Conference consideration and referred each item, as appropriate, to the standing Conference Committee, sharing session, workshop or trustees' Committee. All items were addressed and responded to, including those not placed on the agenda because of recent Conference discussion, or those that were appropriately referred to local autonomy.

The committee reviewed and finalized the Conference agenda, assigning participants for the various presentations.

Ann Bruning, chairperson

Staff report: The Conference coordinator is the contact for General Service Conference members. The coordinator's desk also serves all of the area committee members of the 91 areas



throughout the United States and Canada.

The General Service Conference, created in 1951 by our co-founders Dr. Bob S. and Bill W. became, in July of 1955, the "guardian of the Traditions of Alcoholics Anonymous, the perpetrators of the world services of our Society, the voice of the group conscience of our entire Fellowship, and the sole successors of its co-founders, Dr. Bob and Bill."

The General Service Conference is a year-long process and the Conference coordinator is actively involved with Conference members in a cooperative effort to make the annual meeting of the Conference all that the Fellowship needs for it to be.

All A.A. members are asked, through the area committees, to submit items for the Conference to address. These are brought to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for consideration and referral to the appropriate committee or back to the area, if it is more appropriate for local autonomy to deal with the concern. The Conference coordinator assumes responsibility for:

- Assembling suggestions for the Conference theme, presentation/ discussion and workshop topics, which are then reviewed for selection by the Conference Agenda Committee and recommended to the trustees' Committee on the Conference for approval.
- Serving as secretary of the Conference Agenda Committee and the trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference.
- Corresponding regularly with delegates, alternate delegates and all area committee members throughout the year.
- Working with the general manager and G.S.O. staff in planning and coordinating each phase of the Conference.
- Scheduling and assembling reports and all material for the Conference Manual, Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9* and the Conference *Final Report*.
- Reviewing all area and district correspondence, as well as minutes and reports received from area and district committees.

Pat Rosenstiel

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

Trustees' committee: The trustees' Committee on Cooperation With the Professional Community met three times since the last Conference. The recommendations and suggestions of the 1992 Conference C.P.C. Committee were reviewed. The revised pamphlet "A.A. as a Resource for the Health Care Professional" will include information for all health care professionals. The words "self-help" have been removed from all C.P.C. literature.

The Preamble, Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions and a standard paragraph giving information about presentations and the availability of A.A. will be added to all C.P.C. pamphlets when reprinted.

A C.P.C. literature review subcommittee also met twice since the last Conference and prepared a revised text and title for the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate With Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" which will be referred to the 1993 Conference C.P.C. Committee for their consideration. The Conference committee has also been asked to consider revising the title to "How A.A. Members Cooperate—'Cooperation but not Affiliation.'"

This subcommittee also suggested revision of the language in the pamphlet "Alcoholics Anonymous in Your Community." It was suggested that the committee consider changing the headings "A.A.'s Position in the Field of Alcoholism" and "How A.A. Views Alcoholism." The literature review subcommittee is currently reviewing the C.P.C. Workbook.

Another subcommittee met to establish criteria for attending and evaluating national and local professional conferences. It was agreed that the presence of Alcoholics Anonymous at professional conferences is an important way of communicating what A.A. is and is not to professionals. The committee will continue to scrutinize A.A.'s participation at all conferences.

A new subcommittee has been formed to evaluate the effectiveness of the visual content of the C.P.C. professional exhibit.

Professional Exhibit Schedule 1993: To date, the C.P.C. Committee has committed to exhibit at 25 national and three local professional conferences or meetings in 1993. The selection of these conferences was based in part on past evaluation questionnaires submitted by local C.P.C. committees. These questionnaires include information about attendance at our exhibit, interest in A.A. literature, interest in being added to the *About A.A.* mailing list and typical questions asked of the A.A. volunteers.

To date, the C.P.C. staff member has forwarded 45 additional requests for A.A. participation in national and local conferences and professional meetings during 1993. Each area's C.P.C. committee will determine whether or not they wish to participate in these events. In addition, the C.P.C. staff member forwards copies of all conference notifications/invitations to area delegates. Area C.P.C. committees have been encouraged to research local or state professional meetings.

The C.P.C. staff member has submitted 23 presentation requests to various 1993 conferences. We are being considered for inclusion in programs at the following 1993 conferences: President's Committee on Employment of People With Disabilities, American Correctional Association, National Association of Social Workers, American School Counseling Association, American Deafness and Rehabilitation Association.

Members of the committee and a former trustee made C.P.C. presentations at the following professional meetings in 1992: National Catholic Educational Association, National Council on the Aging Convention, 1992 Institute on Drug Abuse Prevention With Deaf Students, Rutgers Summer School of Alcohol Studies, Conference Focusing on Substance Abuse With Deaf and Hard of Hearing People, Texas Commission on Alcoholism and Drug Addiction Summer Institute, 36th International Congress on Alcohol and Drug Dependence and Lawyers Assistance Program of Illinois.

At the November meeting we were privileged to welcome several World Service Meeting delegates. As a result of that meeting, the General Service Office of Japan will exhibit at the 1993 World Congress of the World Federation for Mental Health to be held in Japan in August 1993.

A letter emphasizing primary purpose, nonaffiliation, self-support and anonymity was included with the Fall issue of *About A.A.* The 1992 titles of *About A.A.* were "How Do We Communicate the Experience of A.A. to Nonalcoholic Professionals?," "Myths and Misconceptions About Alcoholics Anonymous—An Alcoholism Counselor's View" and "A.A. and the Clergy: Faces of a Lasting Friendship."

In keeping with this year's Conference theme the committee has prepared 26 inventory questions. A report on this inventory is to be shared with the 1993 Conference Committee at our joint meeting.

This committee continues to discuss how to improve our service and support of area, local and intergroup C.P.C. committees. The committee also continues to discuss cooperating with a wide range of professionals while preserving our Traditions. This committee reviews C.P.C. literature to provide consistent and accurate information to all segments of the professional community interested in Alcoholics Anonymous on a national, regional and local level.

Marc Pineau, chairperson

Staff report: On page 173 of *The Language of the Heart* Bill W. talks about two psychiatrists visiting an early A.A. meeting. "Ever since that time the psychiatric profession has continued to hold up AA's hands. And I venture to say that it is often their understanding and tolerance, rather than ours, which has brought about this happy state of affairs." From those early days, A.A. has continued to owe a debt of gratitude to ever-increasing numbers of professionals. The C.P.C. staff person provides information about Alcoholics Anonymous and complimentary profession-specific literature to any professional who contacts the General Service Office.

In the last three months of 1992, inquiries have come from isolated communities, Indian reservations, inner-city schools and programs, police and probation departments, lawyers' assistance programs, medical schools, schools of social work, nursing schools, teachers' conferences and training meetings, community outreach programs, school athletic programs, public defenders, mental health programs, family programs, military personnel, geriatric professionals, marriage and family therapists, public health professionals, perinatal professionals, school counselors, judges, victim support services professionals, professionals who work with the deaf and hard of hearing, correctional facilities personnel, clergy and employee assistance professionals.

The C.P.C. staff person corresponds regularly with area C.P.C. chairpersons. In addition to letters which include news about the General Service Office and the trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees, each area C.P.C. chairperson receives a copy of all letters sent from professionals in their area. As a result nonalcoholic professionals receive two responses from Alcoholics Anonymous: one from the General Service Office with complimentary literature and a second response from a local C.P.C. committee member offering local A.A. information, service and support. In this way, nonalcoholic professionals have the opportunity of experiencing personally the hand of A.A. extended at all times to those who wish information about our Fellowship.

The C.P.C. staff person is also responsible for responding to questions and providing shared experience to C.P.C. committees in the United States and Canada. Currently there are over 400 area, district and intergroup C.P.C. committees and local C.P.C. contacts listed at the General Service Office. All areas are encouraged to forward minutes of C.P.C. committee meetings to the General Service Office as a basis for sharing with other C.P.C. committees through articles in *Box 4-5-9* and

About A.A. Each area C.P.C. committee has been given information about the Big Book videocassettes in American Sign Language to share with professionals who work with the deaf and hard of hearing.

In 1992, the C.P.C. staff person forwarded information about approximately 175 different professional conferences to area C.P.C. chairpersons for participation at a local level.

The trustees' C.P.C. Committee budget provided funding for attendance at 35 national professional conferences and nine local professional conferences in 1992. In addition to the shipping of the C.P.C. exhibit, the General Service Office also provided complimentary literature for these conferences. We received 1,800 requests for literature from conference participants and increased our mailing list by 4,500. The C.P.C. exhibit was sent to 16 A.A. events to provide information about C.P.C. Twelfth Step work to A.A. members.

As an alternative to exhibiting, the C.P.C. staff person and local C.P.C. committees contact exhibit organizers to offer to participate in conference programs providing C.P.C. presentations about Alcoholics Anonymous. We also offer "open" A.A. meetings for participants or complimentary literature for participants. The C.P.C. staff person also serves as secretary to both trustees' and Conference C.P.C. Committees.

C.P.C. committees continue the spiritual commitment from the Fellowship to carry the message of A.A. to all professionals who work with "drunks" long before they reach the doors of A.A. Cooperating with professionals is an ongoing challenge to provide basic information about what Alcoholics Anonymous does and does not do, singleness of purpose, self-support, nonaffiliation and anonymity.

Valerie O'Neill

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

Trustees' committee: Since the 1992 Conference, our committee has met three times and its purpose, of course, is to recommend ever-improving ways to help carry the message to alcoholics in correctional facilities.

The committee was informed at the February 1993 meeting that Amos Reed was taking an early rotation from the board for health reasons.

The committee welcomed three newly appointed nontrustee, nondirector committee members who bring a wealth of experience in carrying the A.A. message into correctional facilities.

In reviewing the sales analysis report of literature sent by the Correctional Facilities assignment for 1992, the committee discussed ways in which individuals, groups, districts, etc., can support supplying literature to inmates. The committee reviewed past articles on this topic from *Box 4-5-9* and suggested that a service piece be prepared by staff which shares all of this information. After reviewing a draft of this material, the committee suggested it be included in the Correctional Facilities Workbook and used for a future article in *Box 4-5-9*.

The committee reviewed an outline for a presentation on A.A. that could be given by correctional facilities committees to inmates and corrections personnel. The committee felt this should be two presentations rather than one and formed a subcommittee to review and revise this piece. When the revision is completed, the committee will refer this to the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for their consideration for inclusion in the Correctional Facilities Workbook.

The committee also discussed the status of voting privileges of

G.S.R.s of correctional facility groups vis-a-vis outside A.A. groups and felt that this should be up to the discretion of the district or area. This item was referred for further discussion and shared experience to the Conference Correctional Facilities Committee.

This committee continues to welcome all suggestions from the Fellowship to help better communicate the A.A. message to those on the "inside."

David O'Leary, acting chairperson

Staff report: The Correctional Facilities assignment extends the hand of Alcoholics Anonymous to those who are unable to walk to a meeting, call a sponsor or otherwise participate in the Fellowship of Alcoholics Anonymous which we on the "outside" take for granted. At the present time there are over 2,490 correctional facilities groups listed at G.S.O.

In addition to serving as secretary to the Conference and trustees' Correctional Facilities Committees, this assignment received over 7,500 letters this year. In addition to responding to inquiries from correctional personnel, correspondence with inmates falls into three main categories: providing information about the Fellowship through complimentary literature; providing information about the Corrections Correspondence Service; answering requests to set up a support network prior to an inmate's release.

Other correspondence responds to all aspects of correctional facilities service. The staff member writes directly to local correctional facilities committees when an inmate has contacted the General Service Office with release dates and information. The intent is for correspondence to begin with A.A.s in the inmate's home community so he or she leaves the facility with personal experience of the "outside" Fellowship prior to and immediately upon release.

The Corrections Correspondence Service is one in which an "outside" A.A. member shares the message of recovery during the inmate's term of confinement. Of ongoing concern is the fact that there are never enough "outside" A.A.s to correspond with the increasing number of inmates who wish to participate in this service. This is an area that will be discussed over the year to obtain sharing on how this service could be improved.

There seems to be a misconception in some areas that G.S.O. has free books to send to any inmate who writes requesting them. In attempting to get a handle on some of these requests, more contact has been made with correctional facilities committees alerting them to this and asking them to establish contact with the inmate, the A.A. group or the corrections authorities. For 1992, the Correctional Facilities assignment distributed over 8,700 pieces of literature at a cost of over \$8,000.

This assignment contributes articles to sharing experiences of local committees which help assist communication of this type of service work to the widest possible A.A. membership.

As the prison population is expanding rapidly and the rate of alcohol-related crimes is increasing, the work of the trustees' and Conference Correctional Facilities Committees, as well as local committees, truly is on the front line of carrying the A.A. message.

Helen Turnquest

FINANCE AND BUDGETARY

Trustees' committee: Although very satisfactory results were obtained in 1992, there were developing trends that cause us concern for 1993 and beyond.



The 1992 operating income for the General Service Office (overall loss minus extraordinary items—Relocation/Construction of \$2,204,900) was \$803,900. This compares with a net operating income for 1991 of \$710,100.

Sales for the year totaled \$9,805,000, a decline of approximately \$500,000 from 1991, but remarkably close to budget.

For the third year in a row we are reporting declines in unit volumes of A.A. book sales. Last year the decline in sales to those outside the Fellowship (treatment centers, etc.) was noted. This year, in addition to outside sales, sales to A.A. entities (intergroups, groups, etc.) are also declining.

Contributions, for the second consecutive year, declined from the previous year. The 1991 contributions were approximately \$260,000 less than those received during 1990. Contributions received during 1992 were approximately \$22,000 less than those received during 1991. While \$22,000 is not a large dollar amount, it is significant in that this may be becoming a trend. A year to year decline had not happened in the past twenty years, and perhaps further back than that.

Operating expenses (total expenses without relocation/construction) for the year were \$8,969,400; approximately \$194,000 less than budgeted. More important though, total expenses for the year were almost \$380,000 (4.1%) less than the prior year. The largest part of the reduction, approximately \$175,000 (46%), can be attributed to the lower rent of the new office. Office service and expenses also declined significantly (\$60,800) due to the move. Items such as office maintenance, previously a separate charge, now are included in the total rental.

The 1993 G.S.O. Budget was prepared with a watchful eye toward lower sales volume as well as lower contributions. Net sales have been budgeted at \$9,383,000, 4.3% lower than 1992 sales. This budget reflects price adjustments to certain miscellaneous items that, for one reason or another, we have been selling for less than our cost. Gross profit after cost of products has been budgeted at \$5,300,000, approximately 6.0% less than the 1992 actual. Contributions have been budgeted at \$4,000,000, a decline of 3.2% from 1992. We are watching the trends very carefully and reviewing areas to further reduce expenditures should the decline in contributions accelerate. Total G.S.O. income is projected at \$9,295,000, \$480,000 (5%) less than the 1992 actual. Total expenses for the year are budgeted at \$9,064,000, 1% below the revised 1992 budget and 1.2% over 1992 actual.

During 1992 the Reserve Fund earned approximately \$474,000. During the year the Fund received transfers of \$136,200 from the Grapevine and \$650,000 from A.A.W.S. Transfers of \$1,851,000 were made from the Reserve Fund to cover costs of the Relocation/Construction project. The two-year cost of the project was \$3,351,000, of which \$2,951,000 was funded by the Reserve Fund and the balance of \$400,000 was funded out of A.A.W.S. operating cash.

The Grapevine had a reasonably good year in spite of declining circulation trends. Net income for the year of \$116,000 was approximately \$12,000 higher than 1991. Declining circulation was offset by higher average selling price and lower cost of product. Gross profit on other items increased by \$15,000. All other expenses (office-type expenses) increased by only \$3,000.

The Grapevine Budget for 1993 forecasts an operating loss of \$7,400, offset by interest income of \$86,000, resulting in a budgeted income of \$78,600. This is comprised of revenue estimated at \$2,042,800, cost of product estimated at \$763,800 and other expenses of \$1,286,400. Other expenses are projected to increase approximately 3.2 percent.

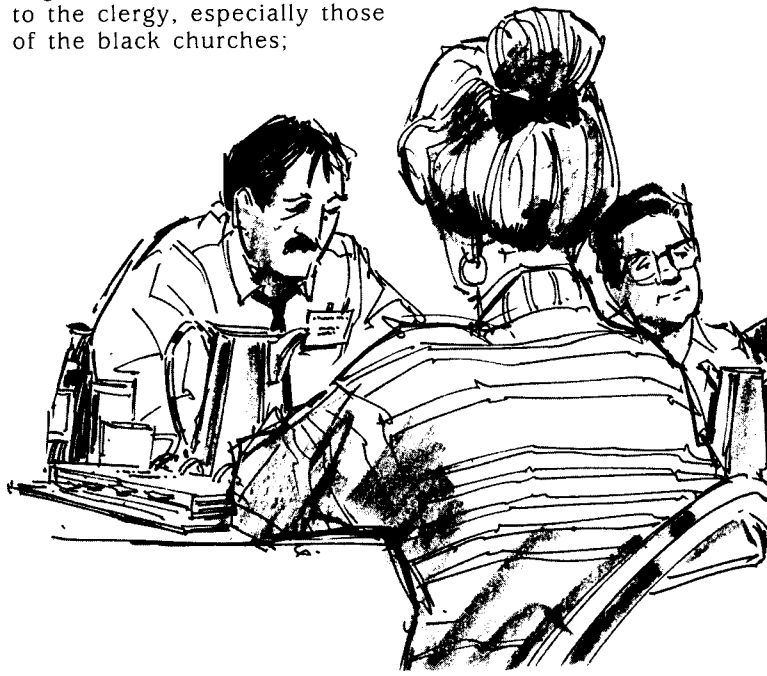
The General Service Board Reserve Fund had a fund balance of \$6,724,400 at December 31, 1992, a reduction of \$590,000 from December 31, 1991. As of December 31, 1992, the Fund was yielding approximately 7%, representing about nine months of coverage of combined operating expenses (G.S.O. and Grapevine).

Robert P. Morse, chairperson

GENERAL SHARING SESSION

Trustees' report: The three General Sharing Sessions since the last General Service Conference discussed issues of specific interest to the board and the Fellowship.

At the August 1992 session there were two presentations on "Ways to Reach Professionals." Following a review of our A.A. history on cooperating with professionals who work with the population at large, discussion focused on how C.P.C. workers need to further their efforts to reach lawyers, corrections personnel, teachers, engineers, healthcare professionals, psychologists and more—through speaking at conferences, setting up display booths, holding information meetings, distributing literature and encouraging the inclusion of A.A. information in professional curricula. Ways to better reach professionals who work with the linguistic minority in Montreal were also discussed. The A.A. message has been carried there by translating the literature, setting up C.P.C. exhibits and, at an annual A.A. Bilingual Convention, having C.P.C. committee members explain what A.A. is and is not to invited professional people. Participants added other shared experience, which included checking convention center information to approach organizations coming to town—sometimes even being invited to give an A.A. information talk; reaching out more vigorously to the clergy, especially those of the black churches;



encouraging the growth in awareness for special needs committees; approaching hospital emergency room personnel, as well as immigration officials, faculty members and students. The desirability of producing special population literature was thoroughly discussed—some believing it much needed; some others concerned that our single purpose might become weakened; and still others conflicted on an approach.

The topic in October 1992 was on "Self-Support: A Universal Concern," with presentations given by World Service Meeting delegates from Argentina and Ireland, and by the Pacific Regional trustee. The Irish service structure budget is met through 60% from the group contributions, 25% through literature sales, and the remainder through A.A. conventions. Also, Ireland continues to be an active participant in, and a financial contributor to, A.A. service development worldwide. A.A. self-support in Argentina was termed by the World Service Meeting delegate a "delicate and important matter." Only three out of six of Argentina's regions are in good condition with regard to self-support, so there is still much work to be done. It was also pointed out that neighboring countries can often benefit from being sponsored in the area of self-support.

In the U.S./Canada structure, even with the widespread growth of A.A., the cost of providing services has been maintained at a low level, although self-support has not fared as well. Presently, only about 52% of groups contribute to G.S.O. We need to keep educating ourselves and other A.A.s on the importance of the Seventh Tradition. Both as individual A.A.s and at the group and other service levels, we must renew our efforts and set a good example for the newcomer. A strong ongoing commitment to self-support, coupled with a willingness to extend help to emerging A.A. structures in all parts of the world, is of paramount importance.

The January sharing session focused on "Anonymity: The Spiritual Foundation of Our Tradition," through two wonderful presentations. The first speaker recalled how, as a newcomer, her gratitude for A.A. seemed to make it natural to let people know she was in A.A. Only later on in sobriety did she realize more fully the importance of the anonymity Traditions, both personally and for A.A. as a whole. Despite early struggles about anonymity in A.A., it came to be very important—what our co-founders termed "our shield." This shield continues to be a powerful tool, not because of individual legacies, but rather through the collective spiritual power of the hundreds of nameless A.A.s from groups who share experience, strength and hope with the newcomer day after day.

Stressing the need to continue work on applying these Traditions to our own personal lives and those of other A.A. members, the second presenter referred to the work of the trustees' Public Information Committee, both in regard to anonymity breaks at the public level, and posthumous anonymity. In 1971, the General Service Conference reaffirmed that although A.A. members think it unwise to break another's

anonymity following death, the final decision must rest with the family. And, are we, today, the speaker wondered, placing too much attention on our co-founders? Certainly, their photographs are ubiquitous—and until recently distributed by A.A. And, are their homes becoming shrines? When Bill visited Dr. Bob's grave, noting that the headstone made no mention of A.A., he considered it "a great and final example of self-effacement," and that Dr. Bob's "real monument is visible throughout A.A."

In the discussion that followed, many shared their personal experiences with anonymity, and how, as sobriety progressed, they came to realize the importance of anonymity at the public level, and how the spirit of the anonymity Tradition at a personal level is vital to our ongoing community journey toward humility. How we apply the anonymity Traditions in our lives produced varied opinions. These included believing that being too anonymous at the personal level could impede our efforts to reach out; believing that "specialized" A.A. pamphlets can make one feel apart, and asking that we reflect on the conviction that "my presence makes a difference, but I am not of individual importance."

Harold Greene, chairperson

GROUP SERVICES

Staff report: The chief responsibility of group services is to serve the groups. We provide service material to the Fellowship in order to communicate with each other and with over 55,000 groups in the United States and Canada. There is a variety of service material available to A.A. members upon request. A descriptive three-page service sheet describes these service items in detail. Service material is different from Conference-approved literature in that it has not come about through the Conference process but results because of an expressed need on a particular subject. Service material reflects A.A. experience and information that is shared through us here at G.S.O.; it is subject to change.

Current service projects completed under Group Services:

- The five-volume video cassettes of the Big Book, *Alcoholics Anonymous*, in American Sign Language (A.S.L.), was completed January 1993.
- Completion of service piece "Forming Accessibilities/Special Needs Committees," available upon request.

Current ongoing service projects under Group Services:

- Communication with central/intergroup office managers and involvement with the Policy and Site Committees of the Intergroup Seminar. The next Intergroup Seminar will be held in Baltimore, Maryland, September 16-19, 1993.
- Coordination and production of four A.A. Directories: Eastern U.S., Western U.S., Canadian and International. The staff member on Group Services works closely with the special projects manager regarding group printouts to areas and central/intergroup offices records, so that new directories can be printed on time.
- Supervision of G.S.O. service files. There is a variety of service material available to A.A. members, and for service workshops. We have cut back on much service material and indexed the files for cross reference.
- Supervision/production of service material which includes A.A. Guidelines, Group Handbooks, G.S.R. kits, D.C.M. kits. (We plan



to eliminate some guidelines where there no longer seems a need for them, i.e. "Armed Forces" and "Usage of A.A. Directories," when supplies are depleted.)

• Correspondence with the Northeast Region is another aspect of the Group Services assignment. Current group concerns in 1993 seem to be: Traditions questions, group concerns about disruptive members, questions about medallions and tokens, questions about incorporating and filling out group bank accounts, and communication about group apathy. Many A.A.s visit G.S.O. from the Northeast Region and the staff member talks with group members in person and on the telephone.

The staff member on Group Services serves as secretary for the trustees' Nominating Committee and the Conference Committee on Trustees. The trustees' Nominating Committee has reviewed and revised many of its policies and procedures. Both trustees' and Conference committees have been in communication throughout the year.

Service meetings are coordinated by the Group Services coordinator. We welcome suggestions from the Fellowship regarding group services and ways to improve our service to groups.

Susan Ulseth

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION/ A.A. REGIONAL FORUMS

Trustees' committee:

International Convention—The committee reviewed various suggestions for the Saturday evening program at the 1995 International Convention, and recommended an oldtimers meeting format in lieu of professional entertainment.

The committee reviewed audiotaping and photo sales bidding processes, and agreed that both are satisfactory.

The committee considered a Convention theme from the many suggestions sent in by the Fellowship. At the November meeting, we reviewed a list of nine themes and recommended that "A.A. Everywhere—Anywhere" be the theme for the 1995 International Convention. An overview of 1995 International Convention projected expenses was also accepted.

The committee reviewed its procedures and the time frame regarding inviting a local Host Committee Chair candidate to attend a committee meeting. An invitation will likely be extended by late 1993.

We recommended that a souvenir booklet, similar to that produced for the 1985 International Convention, be the souvenir item of the 1995 International Convention, and that it be similar in content, style and size to the 1985 booklet, appropriately edited and updated to reflect A.A. around the world. It was proposed that the 1995 souvenir booklet be produced at G.S.O., through the auspices of the trustees' International Convention Committee, with the concurrence of the Conference International Convention Committee.

The broad program categories for the 1995 International Convention program were received and accepted.

The committee recommended a sailboat design for the 1995 International Convention logo, pending determination that it infringes no other marks. If the sailboat design cannot be used, then a sunburst design will be used instead. (Since the sailboat design could be an infringement, the sunburst design will be the International Convention 1995 logo.)

The committee discussed favorably inviting twenty-one non-A.A. speakers to participate in the 1995 International Convention Program, at A.A.'s expense, and will seek approval

from the 1993 General Service Conference to continue this custom.

Regional Forums—Five Regional Forums were held during 1992: Western Canada, Pacific, Eastern Canada, Southeast and a special Western Canada Forum at Whitehorse, Yukon. Although the numbers were often somewhat smaller than in previous years, all five 1992 Forum weekends had incredible energy and dedicated A.A. sharing.

While all Forums are based on similar formats, they each have their own flavor. Reports from each of the Forums are available for any member who would like to take a look at such a weekend in capsulated form, and may be ordered through the General Service Office.

Dr. Jack Norris, late trustee emeritus of the General Service Board (Class A trustee), in his recognition of the need for continuing dialogue between the board and A.A. members in all regions, had the vision to describe and initiate Regional Forums. This vision is being fulfilled as A.A. service people in the United States and Canada share directly with the trustees of the General Service Board, the directors of the two service corporations, A.A.W.S. and the Grapevine, as well as G.S.O. and Grapevine staff members and employees. There have been 73 Regional Forums since they began in 1975, five of which were held in 1992.



Each Regional Forum has an agenda which includes workshops, presentations, sharing sessions, reports and Ask-It-Baskets. Topics for presentations and workshops are suggested by the region's delegates and other A.A. service people.

During 1992, the trustees' Committee on International Conventions/Regional Forums established a subcommittee to continue considering special Forums and to make recommendations on how to improve the regular Forums and their reports. The committee considered and approved plans for a special Forum to be held in September 1993 in Charlottetown, Prince Edward Island. The committee is also currently studying a request for a special Forum in Hawaii that was submitted to the committee in January by the area delegate.

The schedule for 1993 Regional Forums is as follows:

1993		
May 14-16	East Central	Ft. Wayne, Indiana
June 4-6	Northeast	Burlington, Vermont
August 6-8	West Central	St. Cloud, Minnesota
September 24-26	Eastern Canada	Charlottetown, PEI
December 3-5	Southwest	St. Louis, Missouri

Jacqueline Martin, chairperson

Staff reports: International Convention—The International Convention assignment involves coordinating every aspect of the many processes and plans that go to make up our A.A. anniversary International Conventions. Working with four committees—Trustees, Conference, G.S.O. Planning and Host—the International Convention coordinator is responsible for making sure that the Convention comes together as a celebration of A.A. sharing and thanksgiving.

Planning has begun already for the 1995 International Convention, which will be held in San Diego, California, June 29-July 2, 1995. The Convention theme will be “A.A. Everywhere-Anywhere.” As at previous International Conventions, there will be big meetings, workshops, panels, regional meetings, topic meetings and marathons, which include a total of about 1,000 speakers and moderators.

The magnificent San Diego Convention Center will be the main hive of activity, and, of course, the Jack Murphy Stadium will be the site of the big meetings. San Diego A.A.s will serve as members of the local Host Committee; the excitement is growing about this wonderful birthday event.

Eileen Gatz

Regional Forums—The Regional Forums assignment involves the coordination and follow-through for all arrangements necessary for holding Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These weekends of sharing help to foster better communication and deeper understanding between A.A. service workers, the General Service Board, the A.A. World Services and Grapevine Boards, and the General Service Office, with A.A.s in all of the regions. Regional Forums are held at the region's invitation every two years and there are usually four Regional Forums annually.

The Regional Forums coordinator requests topics for presentations and ideas for workshop themes from the area delegates. Invitations are mailed to G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s, area committee officers, central offices and intergroups, past delegates and past trustees. The staff member prepares the agenda for the Forum weekend, using the ideas for presentation and workshop topics that have come in from the areas within the region for which the Forum is being planned. The Forum coordinator works hand-in-hand with the hotel to make sure that all of the requirements for the meetings, workshops, sharing sessions, as well as coffee and other details, are covered. He or she is also responsible for seeing that there are displays of A.A. Conference-approved literature and other service literature, as well as Archives material, at each Forum. Interpreters and simultaneous translations, when needed, are also arranged by the Forum coordinator. The work for a Regional Forum often begins three or four years in advance. Every effort is made to ensure that a climate of open sharing and communication can take place in a comfortable setting.

When the weekend of sharing is finished, all of the presentations report-backs, Ask-It-Basket questions and sharing sessions are condensed into a report by the coordinator and sent to all A.A. members who registered for the Forum.

Under the present structure of G.S.O., the staff member on the Regional Forums assignment also serves as editor of *Box 4-5-9*, secretary to the Conference Committee on Report and Charter, and correspondent to groups in the Southeast Region.

Richard Bush

INTERNATIONAL/WORLD SERVICE MEETING

Trustees' report: The committee serves as a focal point for

information around the world and is also a link between the World Service Meeting and the General Service Board. It has the responsibility of suggesting to the trustees policies and actions which will result in carrying the message to alcoholics overseas, particularly in countries where there is no service structure.

World Service Meeting—In an effort to be visionary rather than reactive, the committee recommended that a presentation/discussion session on “The Future of the World Service Meeting” be scheduled at the Twelfth World Service Meeting, which took place October 25-29, 1992.

The committee also recommended that the Literature/Publishing Committee of the Twelfth W.S.M. discuss ways of improving, enhancing and satisfying literature needs around the world and, with regard to the International Literature Monetary Fund, develop a mechanism to prioritize literature needs.

Since the delegates to the Twelfth World Service Meeting were invited to attend the quarterly meeting of the General Service Board October 31 - November 2, 1992, the committee planned a General Sharing Session on “Self-support—A Universal Concern” and invited participation from other countries.

Foreign Literature Assistance—The 1993 projected budget for foreign literature was reviewed. Translations of the Big Book in Thai, Tagalog, Persian, Ukrainian and Chinese are anticipated. It was noted that the Big Book in Swahili came off press in January and several hundred copies were sent to the translator, an A.A. member in Kenya, for distribution. In addition, work continues on translations of pamphlets and the *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* in a variety of languages.

Following the Twelfth World Service Meeting, members of the committee had an opportunity to exchange ideas and experience with the delegates. Better communication was emphasized and the possibility of an international newsletter was mentioned. The importance of service literature was stressed, with one delegate sharing that until service literature was translated, members in her country had no understanding of A.A. principles.

In discussing opportunities to carry the message, it was noted that many African countries were once territories of European countries. In many instances, there are still links between the former colonies and Europe. It was suggested that the A.A. message might better be carried to African countries through the European countries once associated with them. This will be considered at the European Service Meeting in October 1993.

The committee heard my report on the celebration of the 20th Anniversary of A.A. in Italy, attended by 5,000 members in Rimini. I had an opportunity to talk about A.A.'s beginnings and the importance of involving the membership in important issues in order to have an informed group conscience. In a meeting with members of the Italian Service Board, I shared information about our service structure.

The committee reviewed the Public Information Survey from Great Britain and suggested that surveys would be an interesting topic for consideration at the next World Service Meeting.

In addition to the visit by World Service Meeting delegates, the committee was happy to welcome the chairperson of the Central Service Committee of Malta when he visited New York on business in January.

John Quinn, chairperson

Staff report: Correspondence from groups, individual A.A.s and professionals interested in obtaining information in countries without a service center or office is answered by the staff member on this assignment. Additionally, the staff member

corresponds with 39 general service offices and literature distribution centers outside the U.S. and Canada. Since the last General Service Conference, Bolivia and Peru have opened G.S.O.s.

World Service Meeting—Coordinating the biennial World Service Meeting is an absorbing aspect of this assignment. The primary purpose of the World Service Meeting is the same as that of all A.A. activity—to carry the message to the alcoholic who still suffers, wherever in the world he or she may be, whatever the language spoken. The World Service Meeting seeks ways and means of accomplishing this goal by serving as a forum for sharing the experience, strength and hope of delegates who come together every two years from all parts of the world. Thirty-nine delegates from twenty-two countries attended the Twelfth World Service Meeting, October 25-29, 1992, in New York City. The theme was "Service: Everyone's Privilege." "Back to Basics" will be the theme of the next World Service Meeting, scheduled to take place October 9-13, 1994 in Cartagena, Colombia.

Interim Service Meeting—The European and Ibero-American Service Meetings are also held biennially, alternating with World Service Meetings. These meetings provide an opportunity to share experience for countries not yet able to participate in World Service Meetings. The staff member on this assignment is often invited to participate in these meetings.

A.A. Literature Translations—To ensure the integrity and authenticity of A.A.'s message, careful consideration is given prior to granting overseas boards, service groups or literature committees permission to print A.A. literature in various languages. The translation is reviewed and, if found to be satisfactory, the means of financing are explored. The request for permission to print or reprint is then presented to the A.A.W.S. Board. The staff member on this assignment serves as the intermediary for translations of A.A. literature.

Where A.A. is in the formative stage and no service structure exists, or in countries that are unable to publish their own A.A. literature because of economic conditions, A.A. World Services prints foreign literature based on indicated needs from A.A.s in other countries.

Since the last General Service Conference, *Alcoholics Anonymous* has been published in Swahili. *Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions* has been published in Ukrainian and Lithuanian.

International Directory—The staff member also oversees the updating of the International A.A. Directory used by traveling members and for Twelfth Step purposes.

Lois Fisher

LITERATURE

Trustees' committee: Projects Completed—The story of "John" (a young person who entered A.A. while in prison) was added to the "Young People and A.A." pamphlet; The six-point definition of an A.A. group has been deleted from all literature and has been replaced by the long form of Tradition Three and a section of Warranty Six, Concept XII; An updated and accurate version of the pamphlet "Your G.S.O. Today" has been published.

Projects in Progress—The Twelve Concepts (short form) will be included in all appropriate service pamphlets as they come up for reprint; The trustees' Literature Review Subcommittee will continue to review all literature to a) Discourage unnecessary duplication, b) Encourage that our singleness of purpose is foremost, c) Encourage simplification wherever possible.

Projects forwarded to the Conference Literature Committee—(1) The A.A. History Book: complete draft of manuscript is forwarded; (2) "Anonymity Card": suggested draft from trustees' subcommittee forwarded for consideration; (3) "Twelve Traditions Illustrated": for review of a proposal for changes in paragraphs two and three under Third Tradition; (4) Suggestions for changes in "The A.A. Group" pamphlet, i.e., page 17, "Why Is A Meeting Not A Group"; (5) the committee will review a report on the use of the term "minorities" as used in the 1992 trustees' Report to the Conference Literature Committee; (6) Literature Review: The committee will review a report compiled by the trustees' Literature Review Subcommittee.

Jake Ham, chairperson

Staff report: The literature coordinator serves as secretary to the trustees' and Conference Literature Committees and works closely with the editor, writers and illustrators on preparing all new recovery pamphlets, books, displays and audiovisuals, in accordance with recommendations from the General Service Conference. The coordinator, along with the editor, follows the progress of writers and illustrators on the updating and revising of all recovery pamphlets. Final design and production of all this material is under the auspices of the A.A. World Services' Publications Department.

The literature desk receives and responds to correspondence from A.A. members and groups about literature. We maintain contact with all current area, district, intergroup and A.A. group literature chairpersons. Each newly elected literature chairperson receives a welcoming letter and material to assist them in this vital responsibility. Additionally, the literature coordinator is the liaison with the French Literature Service in Montreal, Quebec, Canada.

John Grant

LONERS, INTERNATIONALS, HOMERS

Staff report: Loners are A.A.s who are unable to attend meetings because there are no groups nearby. There are about 433 Loners in 141 countries, including the U.S. and Canada. Seagoing A.A.s are known as Internationalists. There are about 252 Internationalists and 38 Port Contacts. Sixty-one Internationalist Groups meet aboard ships or in ports. Homers are A.A.s who are housebound due to long-term illness or physical disability. We now have 158 Homers in the Loners/Internationalists Group.

Loners, Homers and Internationalists stay sober reading A.A. literature and sharing A.A. experience, strength and hope with other A.A.s around the world through letters and tapes.

A literature package is sent to each new Loner, Homer or Internationalist. Additionally, each receives directories of Loners, Homers and Internationalists, and complimentary subscriptions to *Box 4-5-9* and *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* (LIM), a bimonthly discussion meeting in print, sharing excerpts of letters received at the General Service Office from LIM members.

About 1,067 A.A.s serve as Loner Sponsors, sharing group activities and personal experience with Loners, Homers and Internationalists. With approximately 2,150 A.A.s (including Loner Sponsors) participating in the *Loners-Internationalists Meeting* by mail, we might call it the largest A.A. group in the world. A.A.'s phenomenal worldwide growth can be attributed

largely to Loners in distant lands and Internationalists sailing the Seven Seas who carry the A.A. message wherever they may be.

The mail received on the Loners Desk often makes you feel the same as you would sitting in the front row of an A.A. meeting. The openness and earnestness and how it's working in our lives is the same. Following are letters received from Lone members:

From Tigray, Ethiopia: "I am working here in a small rural clinic where we see between 200-300 patients every day, many of them suffering from malnutrition, T.B., malaria, leprosy, etc. The poverty is terrible, especially after so many years of war and famine. I am staying sober a day at a time by listening to tapes and reading my A.A. literature. What I normally do is have a mini-meeting in my room. First, I introduce myself and the meeting; 'My name is Simon, I am an alcoholic. Welcome to Makelle Monday Night A.A.' Then I read the Preamble and How It Works, and listen to a tape as a share. I write a letter to an A.A. member as part of my sharing and then close the meeting with the Promises and Serenity Prayer. It sounds crazy, but it works! I am learning Tigrinya, and in time hope to start up a meeting here. The locals get into all kinds of trouble drinking the home brew called 'talla,' and so I don't think there will be a shortage of candidates."

From Manigod, France: "I had been unable to attend regular meetings for a long time when I finally got around to becoming a Loner. Thank God I did. A week after writing you I became homeless. My husband was unable to work in France, my company went bankrupt, and we have a ten-month-old son. After two months of staying with friends and subletting, we found a cheap apartment in a remote part of the Alps and my husband got a job. I thought things were going to get better even though we had seriously overdrawn our bank account and didn't have any money for food or firewood. Then our car broke down, caught fire, and was completely destroyed."

"So things aren't getting better in some ways and I don't know how we go on. Except that suddenly I have started receiving these wonderful letters from sober alcoholics all over the world. They share their experience, strength and hope with me and they sound so joyful, so happy just to be alive and sober today. I am happy to be sober today, too. I have had some bad luck, but material things are replaceable. What isn't replaceable is the wonderful life full of people who love me—gifts that I have received through the grace of God in A.A., by staying sober, one day at a time. Thanks to everyone who has written; I promise I will respond as soon as I can get some stamps!"

From Reykjavik, Iceland: "I am so grateful that my Higher Power, God, loves me so much to make me an alcoholic first, so I can accept my illness and learn to live without alcohol. I have learned to live my life to the fullest as best as I can, and I am a grateful alcoholic today. I would like to thank the people of LIM that wrote to me; I really feel special when I get my mail."

Sarah Price

NOMINATING

Trustees' report: Since the 1992 General Service Conference, the trustees' Nominating Committee has met three times. At each meeting, the committee's work was guided by the principles of love, responsibility, mutual respect and substantial unanimity. The following committee recommendations have been approved by the General Service Board:

- After reviewing its Composition, Scope and Procedure, the committee recommended adding an additional item to the "Procedure" section to read as follows:

"Resumes of potential Class A trustees, Class B trustees, directors of corporate boards and appointed committee members be sent to the Conference Committee on Trustees prior to the annual Conference."

- In regard to the upcoming vacancy for chairperson of the General Service Board, the committee reviewed the resumes of past and present Class A trustees who had indicated their availability to serve as chairperson, General Service Board, replacing Mike Alexander after the April 1993 Conference. The committee recommended that these friends of A.A. be invited to attend the January 1993 board weekend so that members of the full General Service Board could become acquainted with them.

- The committee reviewed and approved as eligible for election all candidates for regional trustees from the Southeast and East Central Regions, and all candidates for trustee-at-large/U.S.

- The committee reviewed applicants for Class A trustee and recommended Gary A. Glynn to serve as Class A trustee, replacing Robert Morse.

- The committee recommended the following nominations: *A.A. World Services Board:* Michael McPherson, general service trustee, replacing Harold Greene; Jacques Filteau and Richard Roughton, A.A.W.S. directors, replacing Michael McPherson and John J. Quinn; Gerry Flegel, Western Canada regional trustee, replacing Greg Muth. *A.A. Grapevine Board:* Jane Murphy Schulberg, general service trustee, replacing Stanley Silverman; Charles Crist and Tom Maguire, Grapevine directors, replacing Bernard Benziger and Jane Murphy Schulberg; Les Leuthaeuser, West Central regional trustee, replacing Marc Pineau.

- The proposed slate of General Service Board members, officers of the board, A.A.W.S. and A.A. Grapevine directors was forwarded to the 1993 Conference Committee on Trustees for disapproval, if any.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of trustees at the annual meeting of the members of the General Service Board in April, following presentation at the 1993 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Class A

John N. Chappel, M.D.	Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D.
W. J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.	John E. King
Gary A. Glynn	John Hartley Smith, M.D.

(One additional vacancy for a Class A trustee will exist after the early rotation of Amos Reed in April 1993.)

Class B

Ann Bruning	David F. O'Leary
Gerry Flegel	Marc Pineau
Jacob B. Ham	Fran Polek
Les Leuthaeuser	Jane Murphy Schulberg
Michael McPherson	Jean Smith
Greg Muth	

(Two Class B regional trustees and one Class B trustee-at-large to be elected at the General Service Conference in April 1993.)

The committee recommended the following slate of officers of the General Service Board:

Chairperson

W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.



<i>First vice-chairperson</i>	John Hartley Smith, M.D.
<i>Second vice-chairperson</i>	John E. King
<i>Secretary</i>	Greg Muth
<i>Treasurer</i>	Gary A. Glynn
<i>Assistant Treasurer</i>	Donald Meurer
<i>Assistant Secretary</i>	Eileen Gatza*

*To be replaced at rotation, September 1993.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. World Services, Inc., to be presented to the 1993 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Peter Brock	Eileen Gatza*
Ann Bruning	Michael McPherson
George Dorsey	Richard Roughton
Jacques Filteau	Jean Smith
Gerry Flegel	

*To be replaced at rotation, September 1993.

The committee reviewed and recommended the following slate of directors of A.A. Grapevine, Inc., to be presented to the 1993 General Service Conference for disapproval, if any:

Charles Crist	Fran Polek
Jacob B. Ham	Jane Murphy Schulberg
John E. King	Ames Sweet
Les Leuthaeuser	Francine Ward
Tom Maguire	Ann Warner

Four subcommittees of the Nominating Committee have continued their work over the year:

Long-Range Planning Subcommittee: The subcommittee reviewed [inventory] past and present policies, actions and structures of the board and its committees as well as possible future needs of the board. The subcommittee will continue its visionary work and a copy of their report was sent to the Conference Committee on Trustees.

Rotation Subcommittee: It was recommended that (subject to the Bylaws of the General Service Board) incoming Class A trustee terms be two successive three (3) year terms. An additional successive three (3) year term (for a Class A trustee) may be requested by the chairperson of the General Service Board.

It was recommended that it shall be the policy of the General Service Board that (subject to the Bylaws of the General Service Board) the chairperson of each trustees' committee not serve more than two (2) years in that capacity. The chairperson of the board will determine when exceptions are necessary.

It was recommended that (subject to the Bylaws of the

General Service Board) the chairperson of the General Service Board serve no more than four (4) consecutive years.

The subcommittee suggested that four years of "area committee service experience" not be added as a requirement for applicants for appointed committee members. The subcommittee believed that service experience could also be obtained in A.A. groups, districts, intergroups and other subcommittees. Why say area? This report will be forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for their information.

The committee forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees—for further discussion—the subject of appointed committee members, as well as nontrustee directors. Should appointed committee members and nontrustee directors be subject to the same rule as delegates in the one year rotation policy currently in practice? This needs further review and input. (This agenda item will continue to be discussed at the July trustees' Nominating Committee meeting.)

Procedures of the Nominating Committee and "Scope" of the Conference Committee on Trustees Subcommittee: The subcommittee recommended approval of Nominating Procedures #1, 2, 3, and 4 (add "A.A. service experience" to resume), #6 and 9 (completely revised to include two subcommittee deliberations), #11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 16 and 17. Nominating Procedures #5, 7, 8 and 10 were tabled for further discussion and action in the ongoing subcommittee work on Nominating Procedures. It was noted that the "Scope" of the Conference Committee on Trustees was satisfactory.

Note: The General Service Board deferred this recommendation until its July 1993 meeting.

Makeup of the General Service Board and Its Committees Subcommittee: The subcommittee work was implemented in a complete revision of Nominating Procedure #9. A letter from a delegate who submitted a matrix on the makeup of board committees was discussed. It was suggested that this matrix be developed yearly as an informational piece and sent to all Conference members.

New Business: The trustees' Nominating Committee discussed an additional vacancy for a Class A trustee, due to Amos Reed's wish to rotate early (April 1993). A letter has been sent to trustees, delegates, directors and staff regarding this opening at rotation in 1993. The nominee will be presented to the 1994 General Service Conference.

The Nominating Committee wishes to thank Amos Reed for his years of service on the General Service Board.

A letter from a delegate requesting "guidelines for new regions" was discussed. A subcommittee of the Nominating Committee on "Regions" will be formed in the summer but—in the meantime—background material on the subject has been forwarded to the Conference Committee on Trustees for further deliberation.

At the close of the January 1993 meeting of the trustees' Nominating Committee, the chairperson reported to the General Service Board the unanimous decision to request that Michael Alexander be named a trustee emeritus.

I would like to express my heartfelt gratitude to all who served the Nominating Committee during this past year. I also want to say how much I have appreciated the open communication with the Conference Committee on Trustees. The loving interaction of both committees has helped to unify our dual role in serving the Fellowship. The dedication of both committees to give service freely has been a joy to behold.

Greg Muth, chairperson

PUBLIC INFORMATION

Trustees' committee: The responsibilities of the trustees' Public Information Committee include: (1) creating a greater understanding of the A.A. Fellowship through carrying our message to the alcoholic who still suffers by providing information for the public, by responding to invitations from community groups to speak about A.A. and by offering information to the media; (2) developing public information material for use by local P.I. committees; and (3) implementing Conference Advisory Actions.

The committee meets at least three times during the year. Responding to actions of the General Service Conference, they provide A.A. radio and television public service announcements, as well as some A.A. videos, and assist in updating the P.I. Workbook.

Through the triennial Membership Survey we try to maintain an awareness of the composition and growth of A.A. as a whole. The Survey helps us to see where we may need to do more to assure that the A.A. message is available to alcoholics who seek help. We also know that the Survey is helpful to professionals interested in A.A. information. In the past year, the committee forwarded to the Conference Public Information Committee:

- A final draft of the 1992 A.A. Membership Survey pamphlet, along with a request to consider initiating a study of all aspects of the Survey.
- A report of "Posthumous Anonymity and Distribution of Portrait Photographs of Bill W., Lois W., and Dr. Bob S.," and a recommendation that a discussion begin in all Canadian and U.S. groups on implementing the Anonymity Traditions in all areas, including photography, publications and posthumous Anonymity.

- Background information on a recommendation to discontinue distribution of radio public service announcement R-06.

The committee also:

- Approved a 1993 budget of \$30,200.
- Distributed the Anonymity Letter to over 3,900 media outlets.
- Established two subcommittees to review 1) TV and Radio Public Service Announcements, and 2) Press Releases and the P.I. Workbook.
- Approved discontinuing obsolete formats of our public service spots.
- Referred the pamphlet "Understanding Anonymity" to the trustees' Literature Committee with a suggestion for rewrite to emphasize the principles of Tradition Twelve.

- Approved the addition of two nontrustee appointed committee persons.

- Revised their Composition, Scope and Procedure to clarify their Scope and to simplify the description of their meetings in the Procedure section.

Stanley Silverman, chairperson

Staff report: The purpose of the Public Information assignment is to assist A.A. members who carry our message to the suffering alcoholic through the public—schools, businesses, and others, including the media. The majority of this service is



actually performed by local P.I. committee members, who understand how to communicate at the public level while observing A.A.'s Twelve Traditions.

From G.S.O., this assignment responds to an average of 460 letters and 250 phone calls each month. Requests for A.A. participation locally are passed along to P.I. committees, who follow up accordingly. An example of this service is A.A.'s presence at 25 health fairs each month. Our work would be of little use without the willingness of local members to staff these booths and share A.A. literature.

When we learn of a new public information committee chairperson, we send a "welcome" letter, along with some basic information and guidelines based on shared experience. The new chairperson is put on the Box 4-5-9 mailing list and included in future communications about new P.I. material for the term of their service.

The staff person on this assignment serves as secretary to the Conference and trustees' Public Information Committees, and assists with the distribution of the annual Anonymity Letter, which went to 3,900 media contacts early this year. Anonymity breaks that come to us are sent to area delegates, who determine how best to handle each situation.

Radio and television public service informational spots, often referred to as "P.S.A.s," are produced in response to Conference

Action. A few area assemblies have successfully produced television or radio spots that convey the A.A. message to the public locally. For the future, the trustees' P.I. Committee may consider developing guidelines for area assemblies interested in producing A.A. public service spots.

The 1992 Membership Survey was approved by the General Service Conference, and then coordinated at G.S.O. All follow-up on Survey responses was handled within the office at a significant savings.

We receive an average of 20 calls each month from the media and entertainment fields. Often their requests turn into a sharing session on what A.A. is and can do. Our responses have



the objective of explaining A.A.'s primary purpose and Traditions. Over the past year, requests have come from PBS, NBC, ABC, the *New York Times*, the *Boston Globe*, Hearst Entertainment, Multi-Media Productions and several health care journals. We also participated, anonymously, in a Radio Free Europe interview.

The success of any public information work at G.S.O. is measured the same way as any other service: are we doing what we can to see that the A.A. message is available to all, and do we strive to see that the information conveyed is accurate and easy to understand?

Joanie Moncrief

SPANISH SERVICES

Staff report: Since the late 1930s, when our co-founder Bill W. had a small office in Newark, N.J., one of his concerns was "...if A.A. could ever communicate so it could transcend the barriers of the languages." With the passing of the years this G.S.O. has always provided services in several languages. One of these has been Spanish, but it was not until 1984 that the assignment of Spanish Services was formally initiated.

In our general service structure there are more than 30,000 Spanish-speaking A.A. members who don't speak English. They meet in 1,000 groups in the U.S., Puerto Rico and Canada. The Spanish Services staff, which does not rotate, coordinates and revises Spanish translations of material from the other ten staff assignments and assists other staff members in providing services to the Spanish-speaking community which are as equal as possible to the services provided to English-speaking A.A. groups. All Spanish-speaking groups receive *Box 4-5-9* in Spanish.

As more bilingual people come into A.A., communication between the Spanish- and English-speaking groups is improving; the groups are represented by G.S.R.s at district meetings, where they elect bilingual D.C.M.s who represent the districts at area assemblies. Many Spanish-speaking districts have been added recently to the areas in our service structure. Service material is translated into Spanish and kept up-to-date. More and more Conference-approved literature is published in Spanish by our Publications Department. Spanish Services helps answer the correspondence received in Spanish by most other assignments and especially by the Overseas assignment.

The staff member on this assignment represents G.S.O. at the Ibero-American Commission for Translation and Adaptation of A.A. Literature and attends conventions, Hispanic intergroup meetings, Regional Forums, the World Service Meeting and the International Convention, as well as greeting Spanish-speaking visitors to G.S.O.

Danny Mooney

STAFF COORDINATOR

Staff report: Services to A.A. groups and members are provided at present through 11 staff assignments. In addition to assuming a functional responsibility, for example, Treatment Facilities or Public Information, staff members correspond with groups and members in a specific region of the U.S. and Canada, as well as with A.A.s in overseas countries. Staff members rotate assignments every two years. These staff assignments are monitored by the staff coordinator. Currently, the assignment work is divided up as undernoted:

Conference: Secretary, trustees' Committee on the General Service Conference and Conference Agenda Committee; Early Bird *Box 4-5-9*; *Final Conference Report*.

Cooperation With the Professional Community: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Cooperation With the Professional Community; *About A.A.*; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant to C.P.C. page).

Correctional Facilities: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Correctional Facilities; (editorial consultant on Correctional Facilities page).

Group Services Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' Nominating Committee and Conference Committee on Trustees; supervision of service material, Guidelines, and A.A. directories; liaison with intergroups/central offices.

International: Secretary, trustees' International Committee; coordinator of World Service Meeting; World Service Meeting Report.

Literature Coordinator: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Literature Committees; preparation and updating of pamphlets, books, and audiovisual material; liaison French Literature Committee.

Public Information: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Public Information Committees; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for P.I. page).

Regional Forums/Box 4-5-9: Co-secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on International Convention/A.A. Regional Forums; secretary, Conference Report and Charter Committee; editor *Box 4-5-9*.

Spanish Services: Consultant on any committee providing services to the Spanish-speaking community; Spanish language correspondence; editor, *Spanish Box 4-5-9*.

Treatment Facilities/Loners-Internationalists: Secretary, trustees' and Conference Committees on Treatment Facilities; *Box 4-5-9* (editorial consultant for Treatment Facilities page); editor, "Treatment Facilities Newsletter"; editor, *Loners/Internationalists Meeting*.

The staff work is divided into three units so that G.S.O. mail is processed and responded to expeditiously. Unit A consists of Public Information, Cooperation with the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, and Treatment Facilities. Unit B includes coordinators of staff, Conference, Regional Forums and Group Services. Unit C includes Overseas, Literature and Spanish Services.

During a typical year, G.S.O. staff receive approximately 20,000 pieces of mail, and the staff coordinator ensures that mail is handled when staff members are involved with large projects, and in times of sickness and vacation. Weekly staff meetings are chaired by the staff coordinator; at these, discussion centers on problems that require direction from the group conscience, and more and better ways of providing service to A.A. groups and members are sought.

The staff coordinator maintains a calendar of required staff trips to area assemblies/conventions, making sure that the office is adequately covered at all times. She also serves as a liaison between staff members and other G.S.O. departments. The staff coordinator also supervises the Support Services (secretarial/clerical) department, ensuring that the paper work is done accurately and expeditiously.

Whenever there is a staff opening, a letter is sent to trustees and directors announcing the opening and briefly describing the requirements for the job. This information is also posted in *Box 4-5-9*. Six years of sobriety is a requirement for a G.S.O. staff member; business experience, excellent communication skills, A.A. service experience and geographic considerations are among the criteria used in the selection process. The staff coordinator trains new staff members.

During 1991, staff attended a total of 80 conventions, assemblies, roundups and Regional Forums in the U.S. and Canada. These provide staff with an opportunity to communicate about G.S.O. services, to meet A.A.s throughout the U.S. and Canada and to gain local information that can be shared with other groups.

In the past year, approximately 1,035 visitors from around the world came to G.S.O. Each visitor has the opportunity to tour the G.S.O. and Grapevine offices, learning about the

services to the Fellowship. Often visiting members and guests attend the weekly A.A. meeting held at G.S.O. at 11:00 a.m. on most Fridays.

As assistant secretary of the General Service Board, the staff coordinator is responsible for scheduling committee meetings, distributing advance materials, and preparing the minutes of the General Service Board meetings; she also serves as editor of the *Quarterly Report*, the summary of the boards' activities.

The staff coordinator also produces the summaries of General Sharing Sessions, held during board weekends. At these sessions, trustees, members of all board committees, G.S.O. and Grapevine directors, and G.S.O. staff members share on a wide range of topics.

The staff coordinator is a voting member of the General Service Conference, and serves as secretary of the trustees' Conference Committee on Policy/Admissions. In accordance with Concept IV, the staff coordinator is also a director of A.A. World Services, Inc.

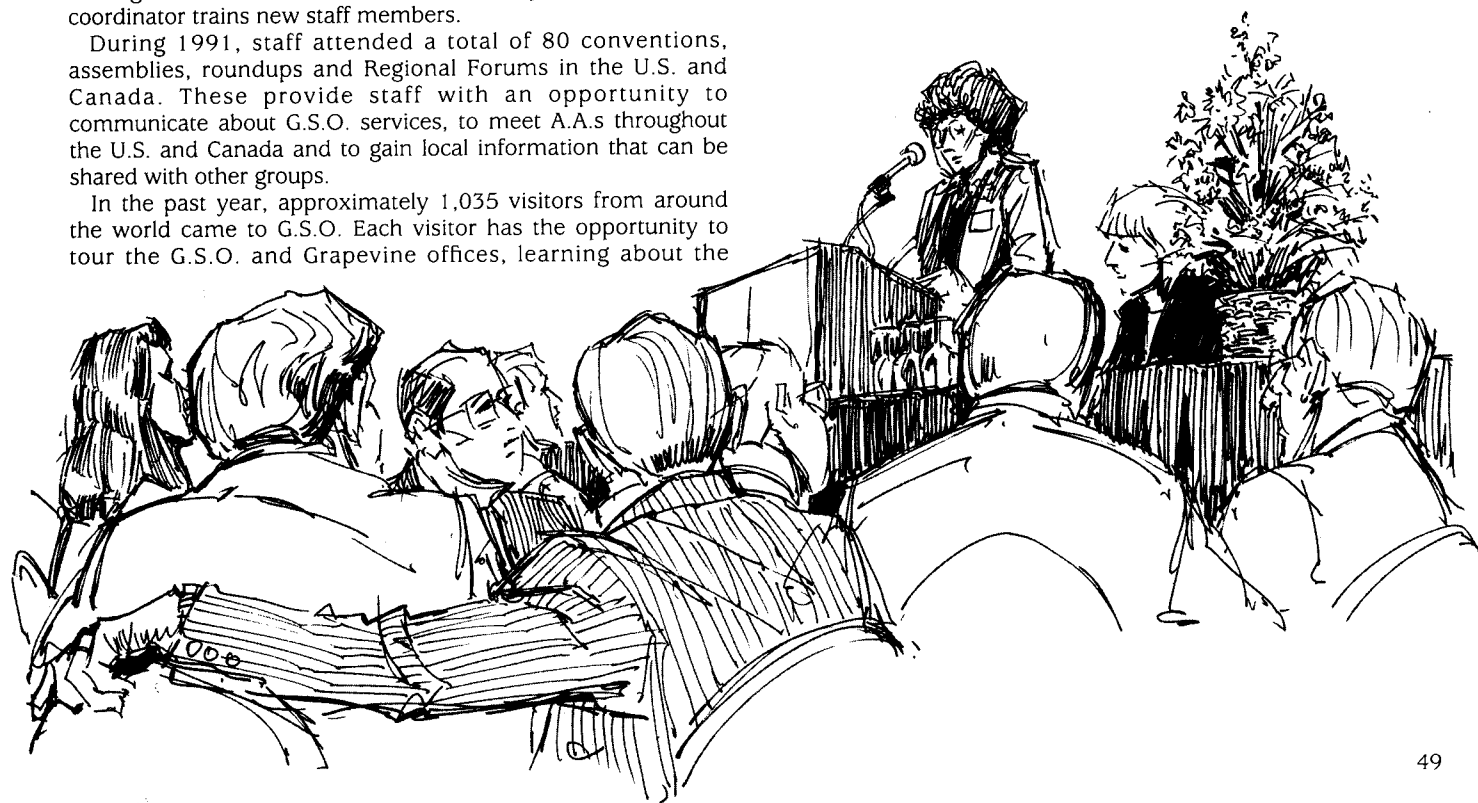
Additionally, the current staff coordinator is serving as Coordinator of the 1995 International Convention.

Eileen Gatzka

TREATMENT FACILITIES

Trustees' report: Last August, the committee discussed ways of obtaining items for the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" and requested that the secretary write to area treatment facilities chairpersons throughout the United States and Canada requesting one or more of their committee members to submit a news article about how their committees are organized, problems encountered, how problems were resolved, and general sharing of experience at least once during the year for the newsletter (separate from their committee minutes). Although there wasn't an avalanche of response, good articles have trickled in ever since.

We asked the A.A. Grapevine if they had manuscripts in their files that would be of interest to treatment facility service workers. They did not. However, in response to our inquiry, they asked the Fellowship for sharing, and have since published





Positive experiences from two members will be included in a future *Box 4-5-9* article on treatment facilities, and we will ask our readers to share any positive experiences they have had with A.A. films, and if they are used on a continuing basis.

John N. Chappel, M.D., chairperson

two issues, one in March, the other in April, which contain sections entitled "A.A. in Treatment Facilities."

The Grapevine has also suggested that our committee consider ways of using their magazine as an integral part of treatment facilities service work. We will ask our newsletter readers to share their experiences in using the Grapevine to carry the message to treatment centers, and also publish an article, from an A.A. member in New York, about groups donating old A.A. Grapevines to be taken into treatment facilities.

In accordance with a 1992 Conference Advisory Action, the trustees' Literature Committee has been conducting an in-depth review of all Conference-approved material and service pieces. A member of our committee has been serving as a representative on the subcommittee, and we have since completed a review of the "Bridging the Gap" pamphlet; our suggestions for revision have been forwarded to the Conference Treatment Facilities Committee for consideration. We will complete our review of the "A.A. in Treatment Facilities" pamphlet for the 1994 Conference.

In addition to those two pamphlets, we have been reviewing the service piece, "Presentation for Alcoholism Program for Professionals and/or Clients." The consensus was to divide it into two separate presentations, one for the professionals and one for the clients. The trustees' Corrections Committee has drafted an adaptation of this service piece for their use. A subcommittee of members from the trustees' Correctional, C.P.C. and Treatment Facilities Committees are reviewing this draft, and it will be discussed further at the July board meeting.

A letter was sent to directors of treatment facilities to provide information about the Fellowship's primary purpose, nonaffiliation and anonymity. The mailing lists were compiled from the directory of the National Association of Addiction Treatment Providers, and agencies in the Dart Directory and Alcohol Registry of Treatment.

In response to an area request, the committee discussed ways to remind the Fellowship of the usefulness of A.A. films in presentations to treatment facilities administrators and clients.

Staff report: The goal of the Treatment Facilities assignment is to help A.A. members carry the A.A. message to the suffering alcoholic in treatment. A major staff activity entails serving as secretary to both the trustees' and Conference Treatment Facilities Committees. Responsibilities in this area include responding to mail from the committees, helping set up agendas for committee meetings, and preparing background material. The Treatment Facilities staff member works with area treatment facilities chairpersons, directing them to helpful sources of information and A.A. literature, and with other A.A. members involved in treatment facilities work. The staff member also corresponds with potential members currently in treatment facilities, sending pamphlets, phone numbers of intergroups, and, occasionally, an encouraging pat on the back. When requests are received at the office from treatment facilities or their clients asking for books or literature in quantity, we sometimes send a supply of material to the facilities' library and/or notify the area treatment facilities chairperson of the need.

Today we have over 420 A.A. treatment facilities committees on our mailing list. Each committee chairperson receives a complimentary Treatment Facilities Workbook, subscription to *Box 4-5-9* and the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" and *About A.A.* In addition, to better serve treatment facilities committees and improve their communications with each other, as new area treatment facilities chairpersons list themselves at G.S.O., a roster of other area treatment facilities chairpersons will be sent to them. Updated lists are distributed to chairpersons each year. All who serve on treatment facilities and bridging the gap committees receive *Box 4-5-9* and the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter."

Articles about treatment facilities service work from the Fellowship appear regularly in *Box 4-5-9* and in the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter." The newsletter is mailed twice a year and seems to be well received.

A notice was included in the Winter issue of the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter" about the March and April issues of the Grapevine containing a variety of articles on A.A.'s relationship with treatment facilities, a flyer outlining "Twelve Ways to Use the Grapevine" and an order form.

Sarah Price

Reports from the A.A. Grapevine

Directors' report: The A.A. Grapevine, Inc. is a wholly-owned subsidiary of the General Service Board. Its primary purpose is to publish a monthly magazine; the corporation also produces a number of special items associated with the magazine. The corporation is self-supporting through sales of the magazine and special items, and accepts no contributions toward operating expenses. The Grapevine can accept only contributions expressly designated for the purpose of providing subscriptions for A.A. members who are unable to pay for them (often those in correctional facilities).

There are ten voting directors. Five are trustees (two general service, two regional, and one Class A); three are nontrustee directors; and two are paid employees, the executive editor and the managing editor. Also attending board meetings but not voting are the controller/business administrator and the assistant secretary; a member of the General Service Office staff is usually present. The chair rotates annually between a general service trustee and a regional trustee.

The board has four quarterly meetings as well as four meetings in which it convenes as a planning committee of the whole, to engage in ongoing strategic planning for the future health of the corporation and the magazine, without pressure to take specific actions.

Finances: Year-end results for 1992 were positive, with a net income of \$116,000, of which \$26,880 was income from operations (compared to a budgeted \$67,600 net income and a budgeted operating loss of \$35,400). Sales of special items overall were higher than 1991, with *The Language of the Heart* doing better than anticipated, sales of cassette tapes lower than expected, and sales of Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners coming in very slightly below budget. At the January meeting, the board approved a 1993 budget calling for a net income of \$78,590, with a loss from operations of \$7,410. This is based on an average circulation of 123,000 and sales of special items somewhat below the 1992 level.

Circulation: Much of the board's time has been spent in analyzing the reasons for the continuing downward trend

provide expanded space for highlights of upcoming issues and other information of interest. Further, the timing of the first renewal notice was changed; it is now sent a month later, in deference to subscribers who felt it came far too early in the term of the subscription.

Special Items: A set of two tapes on the topic of sponsorship was made available in July. The booklet on the home group, which the Conference Grapevine Committee suggested in 1992, will be available in the very near future.

Credit Card Orders: Since March, the Grapevine has been able to accept orders by credit card. This has been on the board's "wish list" for quite some time, since it makes both the magazine and special items far more readily accessible to those who need and want to use them.

Corporate Board Inventory: The December 18th planning committee meeting was devoted entirely to the board's self-inventory, and it raised a number of fundamental questions about the place and purpose of the Grapevine as well as the proper functioning of the board. Directors discussed the Grapevine's relationship to the Fellowship, and an underlying issue surfaced: What is "The Fellowship"? The Grapevine Board is responsible to A.A. as a whole, yet the magazine has always been essentially and uniquely a forum for the individual member. We may respond differently to different segments of A.A., and are not solely responsible to any one part of the Fellowship. Can the Conference tell us what to do in the magazine? Should we listen even more carefully to the voice of the members?

We examined the responsibilities of the board to A.A. members, A.A. groups, and the Conference, then moved on to look at the characteristics and composition of the board as a whole, and the duties and responsibilities of directors. We took a close look at the circulation picture, and considered whether we are doing everything we can to ensure that the magazine reaches the alcoholic, wherever he or she may be located. As part of that discussion, we talked about the GvR program, and asked ourselves if we are providing the right resources for GvRs and whether the board should itself be more active in seeking out people to serve as GvRs.

And finally, we considered the Corporate Board's relationship to the editorial staff, Editorial Board, and in general to the content of the magazine. All these issues will continue to be explored.

Editorial: Three expanded special issues ("Anonymity" in December 1992, "What We Used to Be Like, What Happened, and What We Are Like Now" in February, and "Recovery, Unity, and Service" in May) have been published since the 1992 Conference, and a Traditions series running throughout 1992 featured articles from an early series by Bill W., along with two or more articles by present-day members. The annual "classic" issue of reprints featured articles by nonalcoholic friends of A.A. on our threefold disease as well as a section of articles on the Eleventh Tradition; other special sections were "A.A. and Prison," the "Family Afterward," and a two-part section on "A.A. and Treatment Facilities."

January 1993 kicked off a new series on the Steps, and the editors will continue to feature Steps and Traditions series in alternate years. The high point of the year will be reached with the June issue, 64 exciting pages celebrating Canada's 50th A.A. Anniversary, which everyone here will receive at the end of the week.

Grapevine's 50th Anniversary: The excitement is already building for the Grapevine's celebration in June 1994. Plans are underway for a special double issue, featuring several articles on Grapevine history along with a generous selection of articles

(a close-to-impossible task) and planning ways to reverse it (more difficult than expected, but not impossible). Circulation ended the year at an average of 126,000, compared to the budgeted average of 127,000. It reached a low of 122,220 for the December issue, which was followed by a modest upturn in early 1993. A pilot project to work through the service structure and "saturate" areas with information about the Grapevine was implemented in four areas in February, and was met with great support from the delegates concerned and enthusiasm in the areas; a second pilot project is budgeted. A mailing to all registered groups in November was disappointing overall, but did result in a significant increase in by-the-month orders. The option of ordering by the month (prepaid, a month at a time) is one the board has long hoped will catch on more widely. It is designed especially for A.A. groups and entities that need the Grapevine but have trouble putting together a lump sum to prepay a yearly subscription.

Renewal notices were redesigned to be more attractive and to



sharing A.A. experience. The budget provides for development of a poster, keyed to the anniversary but designed for continuing use.

Magazine Inventory: As part of the Grapevine Takes Its Inventory process, an editorial questionnaire was inserted in the February issue, and reader response was prompt, positive, and prolific—mail began coming in literally by the basketful, even before all the respondents had read the issue. Of the thousands of readers who took the time to reply, negative reactions to the magazine as a whole, or to specific issues, were the rare exception. Many readers expressed their viewpoints about the inclusion of the Spanish article and the removal of the About Alcoholism section, which will provide valuable input for the Grapevine Conference Committee's discussions this week. In reply to two key questions—"Does the Grapevine reflect A.A. principles?" and "Is the Grapevine a meeting in print?"—readers said yes with substantial unanimity. On the issue of A.A. principles, the most frequently cited reason was the openness and variety of the selection of articles. Readers expressed a desire for more A.A. history and more articles for young people, and the cartoon and humor features not unexpectedly came in for a good share of praise. The editors tell us that the prolific response has made their lives unmanageable—for which they are deeply grateful.

As individual A.A. members, we have acknowledged the necessity of a searching and fearless moral inventory, and we have experienced the satisfaction and peace that follows such an honest appraisal. So it has been with the Grapevine Corporate Board.

As a result of taking our inventory, we feel ready to serve the Fellowship with renewed strength and vigor, with enthusiasm for new projects and with firm resolve to hold fast to our Traditions.

As you delegates return to your areas, you take our gratitude for your service to the Fellowship and our pledge to you that Grapevine will remain true to its mission to be—24 hours a day—the best possible meeting in print!

Fran Polek, chairperson

Staff report: The Grapevine office staff consists of 20 people: two A.A. staff members and a freelance designer, who are responsible for content and appearance of the magazine, and 17 nonalcoholics who make sure the financial state of the Grapevine is in order, that subscriptions are entered, and that



special item orders go out on time. Team management through the joint efforts of the executive editor, managing editor, and controller/business administrator ensures a healthy operation and good overall communication.

Editorial: The executive editor, Ann Warner, has oversight responsibility as chief executive for the Grapevine operation, and reports directly to the Grapevine Board. Ames Sweet, the managing editor, is responsible for all aspects of magazine editorial and production and oversees the Grapevine representative program. Together, the two editors evaluate all material for publication, select the content of each issue, and stay in touch with everyone who writes for the magazine. To bolster these efforts, the Grapevine Editorial Advisory Board (made up of volunteer A.A. members who are professionals in the fields of publishing and communications) meets nine times a year to discuss the format, content and direction of the magazine, and to consider from a creative angle the development of future special items or determine a particular emphasis for the magazine.

The Editorial Department is also responsible for publishing the quarterly "GvR News," and with the help of the GvR coordinator tries to keep GvRs at all levels informed about what's going on in the office and what's happening with other GvRs around the world.

Unlike A.A. staff positions at the General Service Office, Grapevine staff positions do not rotate, and the executive editor and managing editor share the responsibility of representing the Grapevine at Regional Forums and, when invited, other events. Both also currently serve on the Corporate Board and are voting members of the General Service Conference. These two A.A.s are assisted by a nonalcoholic editorial secretary.

Financial: Controller/business administrator Bob Scherer manages all business aspects of the corporation and heads up the bookkeeping-accounting department, assisted by a bookkeeper who supervises four accounting clerks and the shipping operation. The bookkeeping department keeps track of all incoming and outflowing funds, and prepares the financial analyses and reports required by the Corporate Board, the General Service Board, and the Grapevine's outside auditor. While the magazine and the bulk of the Grapevine's special item orders are packaged and mailed by outside mailers in Pennsylvania, the in-house shipping department is kept busy mailing a variety of small orders, back issues, letters, books, tapes, and complimentary materials for conferences and conventions throughout the U.S. and Canada.

Office Management: Office manager and corporate secretary Naomi Strassberg's multifaceted job includes ensuring the general efficiency of the office as a whole, administering the health insurance program, supervising the day-to-day work of the GvR coordinator, and handling all copyrights and permission requests.

Circulation: Circulation supervisor Zola Bodden oversees three data entry clerks who enter all subscriptions and address changes into the computer, and customer service clerk, who handles special requests and any problems that may occur.

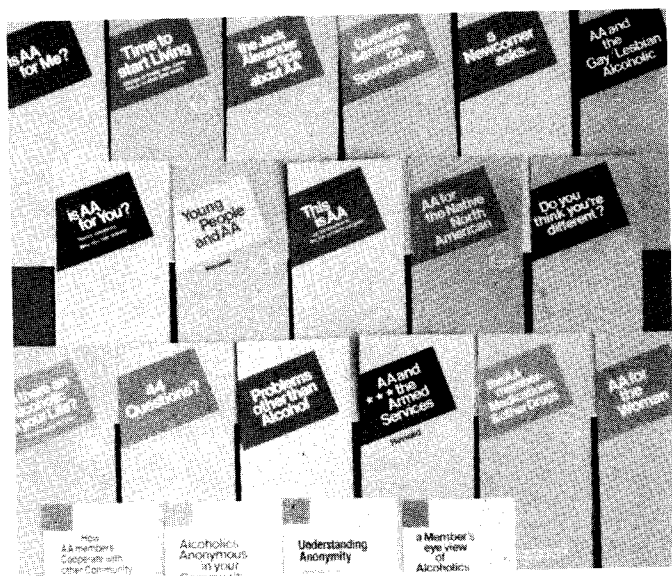
Like any other professional operation, we have our ups and downs—our good days and our bad days. Some days are filled with nothing but complaints and gripes—aimed at or coming from each one of the different departments. Yet, overall, if the early "ink-stained wretches" who founded the Grapevine with Bill W.'s blessings were to return to our modern-day office, through all that is familiar and unfamiliar, they would certainly recognize the spirit of Alcoholics Anonymous which flows throughout the entire operation.

Ames Sweet, managing editor

GRAPEVINE CIRCULATION – GEOGRAPHIC BREAKDOWN

	CIRCULATION		INCREASE/ DECREASE
	APRIL 1993	APRIL 1992	
UNITED STATES			
Alabama	1,447	1,458	- 11
Alaska	533	544	- 11
Arizona	1,555	1,559	- 4
Arkansas	668	789	- 121
California	11,796	11,277	519
Colorado	1,539	1,564	- 25
Connecticut	1,965	2,152	- 187
Delaware	432	392	40
District of Columbia	301	282	19
Florida	5,551	5,972	- 421
Georgia	2,784	2,770	14
Hawaii	423	476	- 53
Idaho	521	561	- 40
Illinois	5,406	5,386	20
Indiana	1,810	1,832	- 22
Iowa	1,576	1,598	- 22
Kansas	1,586	1,583	3
Kentucky	1,010	1,012	- 2
Louisiana	1,198	1,295	- 97
Maine	777	737	40
Maryland	1,976	2,387	- 411
Massachusetts	4,026	4,524	- 498
Michigan	3,427	3,512	- 85
Minnesota	3,176	3,282	- 106
Mississippi	709	657	52
Missouri	2,269	2,387	- 118
Montana	687	773	- 86
Nebraska	1,494	1,530	- 36
Nevada	609	616	- 7
New Hampshire	679	683	- 4
New Jersey	3,619	3,780	- 161
New Mexico	667	647	20
New York	8,040	8,393	- 353
North Carolina	2,836	2,979	- 143
North Dakota	463	568	- 105
Ohio	3,733	3,833	- 100
Oklahoma	1,379	1,437	- 58
Oregon	1,311	1,288	23
Pennsylvania	4,778	4,825	- 47
Rhode Island	552	611	- 59
South Carolina	1,239	1,342	- 103
South Dakota	475	522	- 47
Tennessee	1,521	1,511	10
Texas	5,162	5,377	- 215
Utah	518	542	- 24
Vermont	420	444	- 24
Virginia	2,606	2,707	- 101
Washington	3,370	3,443	- 73
West Virginia	549	535	14
Wisconsin	2,744	2,813	- 69
Wyoming	369	371	- 2
Puerto Rico	92	102	- 10
U.S. Possessions	38	29	9
Total	108,411	111,689	-3,278
CANADA			
Alberta	1,160	1,233	- 73
British Columbia/Yukon	1,709	1,781	- 72
Manitoba	586	640	- 54
New Brunswick/ Prince Edward Island	512	531	- 19
Nova Scotia/ Newfoundland/Labrador	779	830	- 51
Ontario	3,913	4,153	- 240
Quebec	432	477	- 45
Saskatchewan	795	817	- 22
Total	9,886	10,462	- 576
FOREIGN			
	1,492	1,491	1
Grand Total	119,789	123,642	-3,853

Literature Distributed – 1992



ENGLISH

Books

Alcoholics Anonymous	563,863
Alcoholics Anonymous (soft cover)	442,466
Alcoholics Anonymous (large print)	7,198
Daily Reflections	154,387
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (reg. edition)	316,147
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (gift edition)	48,420
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (soft cover)	183,024
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (large print)	5,256
A.A. Comes of Age	15,330
As Bill Sees It	75,576
Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers	13,973
"Pass It On"	14,601
Total	1,840,241

Booklets

Living Sober	218,899
Came to Believe	99,726
A.A. in Prisons	23,638
Total	342,263

Pamphlets

A.A. and Employee Assistance Programs	20,853
A.A. and the Armed Services	12,620
A.A. and the Gay/Lesbian Alcoholic	36,339
A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession	23,213
A.A. for the Native North American	24,903
A.A. for the Woman	142,462
The A.A. Group	78,737
A.A. in Your Community	50,961
A.A. in Correctional Facilities	21,260
A.A. in Treatment Facilities	29,099
The A.A. Membership Survey	38,304
The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs	105,439
The A.A. Service Manual/	
Twelve Concepts for World Service	25,586

A.A. Tradition - How It Developed	34,303
A.A.'s Legacy of Service	12,216
A Brief Guide to Alcoholics Anonymous	131,696
Circles of Love and Service	23,076
Bridging the Gap	52,395
The Clergy Ask About A.A.	20,396
The Co-Founders of Alcoholics Anonymous	24,567
Do You Think You're Different?	171,267
44 Questions	262,382
G.S.R.	30,016
How A.A. Members Cooperate	17,586
How It Works	77,618
If You Are a Professional	37,516
Inside A.A.	47,757
Is A.A. For You?	330,536
Is A.A. for Me?	127,041
Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?	119,670
It Happened to Alice	61,270
It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell	56,517
The Jack Alexander Article	34,895
Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends	16,203
Letter to a Woman Alcoholic	94,440
A Member's-Eye View of A.A.	73,745
Memo to an Inmate Who May Be an Alcoholic	55,600
A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators	10,236
A Newcomer Asks	321,683
Problems Other Than Alcohol	121,424
Questions and Answers on Sponsorship	281,557
Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings	18,227
The Twelve Concepts for World Service Illustrated	24,942
The Twelve Steps Illustrated	77,684
The Twelve Traditions Illustrated	51,927
The Twelve Traditions of A.A.	12,063
This Is A.A.	310,406
Three Talks to Medical Societies by Bill W.	21,732
Time to Start Living	74,101
Time to Start Living (large print)	11,932
Too Young?	109,470
Understanding Anonymity	76,058
What Happened to Joe	69,417
Young People and A.A.	154,700
Total	4,270,043

Miscellaneous

Wallet cards - two-fold	825,277
Wallet cards - I Am Responsible	125,794
Wallet cards - Anonymity	81,891
Parchment - scrolls	6,676
Placards	866
C.P.C. Workbook	941
Correctional Facilities Workbook	648
P.I. Workbook	1,049
Treatment Facilities Workbook	732
A.A. Guidelines	55,401
Group Handbook	2,316
Wire Racks	3,032
Cassettes (tape cassettes)	4,215
Alcoholics Anonymous (cassette album)	4,943
Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions (cassette album)	2,367
A.A. Comes of Age (cassette album)	360
TV Spots (video cassette)	134
Public Service Announcements (cassettes, tapes, records)	504
Twelve Steps Shade displays	2,673
Twelve Traditions Shade displays	2,425

Fact Files	2,327
Total	1,124,571
Grand Total	7,577,118

SPANISH

Books

Alcoholicos Anonimos (Alcoholics Anonymous)	28,506
Como Lo Ve Bill (As Bill Sees It)	7,023
A.A. Llega a su Mayoria de Edad (A.A. Comes of Age)	3,532
El Dr. Bob y los Buenos Veteranos (Dr. Bob and the Good Oldtimers).	3,011
Reflexiones Diarias (Daily Reflections) (new)	7,353
Total	49,425

Booklets

Viviendo Sobrio (Living Sober)	12,602
El Manual de Servicios de A.A./Doce Conceptos para el Servicio Mundial (A.A. Service Manual/Twelve Concepts)	1,885
Doce Pasos y Doce Tradiciones (Twelve Steps and Twelve Traditions)	22,823
Llegamos a Creer (Came to Believe)	5,224
A.A. en Prisiones de Preso a Preso (Inmate to Inmate)	2,232
Total	44,766

Pamphlets

A.A. en Su Comunidad (A.A. in Your Community)	4,900
44 Preguntas (44 Questions)	23,698
Esto es A.A. (This is A.A.)	32,853
Es A.A. para Usted? (Is A.A. for You?)	53,329
Carta a una Mujer Alcohólica	6,255
Hay un Alcohólico en su Vida? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	8,541
Carta a un Preso que Puede Ser Un Alcohólico (Memo to an Inmate)	6,354
El Punto de Vista de un Miembro de A.A. (A Member's-Eye View)	3,008
Alcoholicos Anonimos por Jack Alexander (Jack Alexander Article)	5,781
Tres Charlas a Sociedades Medicas por Bill W. (Three Talks to Medical Societies)	3,875
A.A. y el Empleado Alcohólico (A.A. and the Alcoholic Employee)	300
Un Principiante Pregunta (A Newcomer Asks)	9,886
Como Trabaja el Programa (How It Works)	11,219
Lo que le Sucedió a Jose (What Happened to Joe)	10,898
Comprendiendo el Anonimato (Understanding Anonymity)	4,061
El Grupo de A.A. (The A.A. Group)	8,359
Preguntas y Respuestas sobre el Apadrinamiento (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	9,886
El Miembro de A.A. - Los Medicamentos y Otros Drogas (The A.A. Member - Medications and Other Drugs)	4,695
Las Doce Tradiciones Ilustradas (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	4,014
A.A. en Centros de Tratamiento (A.A. in Treatment Centers)	2,644
Los Jovenes y A.A. (Young People and A.A.)	8,212
La Tradicion de A.A. - Como se Desarrollo (A.A. Tradition - How it Developed)	4,378
Una Breve Guia a A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	7,009

A.A. en Prisiones (A.A. in Prisons)	3,369
Problemas Diferentes del Alcohol (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	7,055
Es Mejor que Estar Sentado en una Celda (It Sure Beats Sitting In a Cell)	6,073
Como Cooperan los Miembros de A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	1,919
Dentro de A.A. (Inside A.A.)	3,104
A.A. como Recurso para la Profesion Medica (A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession)	2,706
Un Ministro Religioso Pregunta Acerca de A.A. (The Clergy Asks)	2,560
R.S.G. (G.S.R.)	2,070
Se Cree Usted Diferente? (Do You Think Your Different?)	10,020
A.A. Para la Mujer (A.A. for the Woman)	7,973
Encuesta Sobre los Miembros de A.A. (A.A. Membership Survey)	1,779
A.A. y los Programas de Alcoholismo Empresariales	1,696
Es A.A. Para Mi? (Is A.A. for Me?) (new)	5,861
Tiempo Para Empezar a Vivir (Time to Start Living) (new)	3,209
Los Doce Pasos Ilustrados (The Twelve Steps Illustrated) (new)	8,214
Total	301,763

Miscellaneous

Guías (Guidelines)	8,449
Parchments, Spanish	1,070
Tarjetas Tamano Billetera (Wallet cards)	16,179
Alcoholicos Anonimos (cassette album) (Big Book on Cassette)	351
Los Doce Pasos (cassette album) (Twelve Steps on Cassette)	595
Total	26,644
Grand Total	422,598

FRENCH

Books

Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format relie)	6,679
Les Alcooliques Anonymes (Alcoholics Anonymous - format poche)	5,589
Le Mouvement des A.A. devient Adulte (A.A. Comes of Age)	2,148
Reflexions de Bill (As Bill Sees It)	4,769
Reflexions Quotidiennes (Daily Reflections)	8,465
Total	27,650

Plaquettes (Booklets)

Nous en sommes venus a croire (Came to Believe)	2,950
Vivre ... sans alcool! (Living Sober)	4,676
Les Douze Etapes et les Douze Traditions (Twelve & Twelve)	6,491
Le Manuel du Service et les Douze Concepts	1,522
Total	15,639

Brochures (Pamphlets)

Voici les A.A. (This is A.A.)	14,228
Les A.A.: 44 Questions (44 Questions)	1,659

Les A.A.: sont-ils pour vous? (Is A.A. for You?)	32,275
Les A.A. pour la femme (A.A. for the Woman)	1,053
Cooperation des membres des A.A. (How A.A. Members Cooperate)	603
Les A.A. et les programmes d'aide aux employes (A.A. & Employee Assistance Programs)	1,291
Le membre des A.A. face aux medicaments et a la drogue (The A.A. Member - Medications & Other Drugs)	1,199
Les A.A. - Article du Saturday Evening Post (The Jack Alexander Article)	355
Collaborons avec nos amis (Let's Be Friendly With Our Friends)	419
Questions et reponses sur le parrainage (Questions and Answers on Sponsorship)	2,777
Les A.A.: Une ressource pour les medecins (A.A. as a Resource for the Medical Profession)	1,957
Les A.A. dans les centres de traitement (A.A. in Treatment Facilities)	423
La Tradition des A.A. et son developpement (A.A. Tradition/How It Developed)	1,103
Vous vous occupez prof. d'alcoolisme? (If You Are a Professional)	870
L'Histoire de Nicole (It Happened to Alice)	530
Jean face a son probleme d'alcool (What Happened to Joe)	509
Les A.A. dans votre milieu (A.A. in Your Community)	2,253
Problemes autres que l'alcoolisme (Problems Other Than Alcohol)	1,302
Point de vue d'un membre sur A.A. (A Member's-Eye View of A.A.)	954
Les Douze Traditions illustrees (The Twelve Traditions Illustrated)	1,362
Les A.A. dans les etablissemments correctionnels (A.A. in Correctional Facilities)	738
Ca vaut mieux que de poireauter en prison (It Sure Beats Sitting in a Cell)	664
Petit guide pratique sur les A.A. (A Brief Guide to A.A.)	10,226
Un ecclesiastique s'interroge (The Clergy Ask About A.A.)	760
Les deux fondateurs d'A.A. (The Co-Founders of A.A.)	869
Message a l'intention des detenues (Memo to an Inmate)	1,328
Message aux Dir. d'Etabl. Correctionnels (Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators)	218
Le groupe des A.A. (The A.A. Group)	1,333
Les Douze Concepts illustres (Twelve Concepts Illustrated)	662
Le sens de l'anonymat (Understanding Anonymity)	1,636
Trois causeries a des societes medicales (Three Talks to Med. Soc.)	458
Y-a-t-il un alcoolique dans votre vie? (Is There an Alcoholic in Your Life?)	1,186
Le R.S.G. (The G.S.R.)	656
Causeries a l'exterieur des A.A. (Speaking at Non-A.A. Meetings)	1,289
Trop jeune? (Too Young?)	1,097
La Structure de l'Association des A.A. (Inside A.A.)	527
L'Heritage des Services des A.A. (A.A.'s Legacy of Service)	505
Cercles d'amour et de service (Circles of Love & Service)	775
Vous croyez-vous different? (Do You Think You're Different?)	986
Lettre a une femme alcoolique (Letter to a Woman Alcoholic)	873
Sondage de 1989 membres des A.A. (The A.A. Membership Survey)	2,508

Les jeunes et les A.A. (Young People & A.A.)	2,233
Votre B.S.G. (Your G.S.O.)	47
Il est encore temps de vivre (Time to Start Living)	1,093
Un nouveau veut savoir (A Newcomer Asks)	7,099
Les A.A. sont-ils pour moi? (Is A.A. for Me?)	1,564
Favoriser de rapprochement	1,237
Les Douze Etapes Illustrees (Twelve Steps Illustrated)	4,824
Total	114,513

Lignes de conduite A.A. (Guidelines)	Total	3,913
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Divers (Miscellaneous)

Le Gros Livre (cassettes)	100
Carte 12 Etapes/12 Traditions (Wallet card 12 Steps & 12 Traditions)	3,891
Carte anonymat (Francais/anglais) (Anonymity Wallet card)	365
Cassettes	48
Notre Methode (How It Works)	20,997
Les Meilleurs Articles de Bill	5,244
Manuel de Groupe	93
Manuel de l'Information Publique	42
Manuel des Centres de Detention	7
Manuel de la CMP	10
Messages d'Interet Publique (Radio P.S.A.)	6
Priere Serenite (Carte) (Serenity Prayer wallet card)	41,196
Slogans (serie de 5) (Five A.A. Slogans)	363
Suggestions Reunions Debutants (Guide for Leading Beginners Meetings)	363
Manuel des Centres de Traitement	11
Total	72,736
Grand Total	234,451



Reports on Area Service Highlights

Alabama: Our area encompasses all of Alabama and N.W. Florida, with 22 districts meeting quarterly with an average attendance of 375. The predominant quality of our area is the communication between our G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s. Since 1988 we have had a G.S.R. workshop. Rotation through the districts each quarter gives the D.C.M.s the chair, and affords the opportunity for most of our area to be an active participant in the assembly. We also have a D.C.M. meeting with the delegate chairing and alternate delegate co-chairing. This serves to give the D.C.M.s, alternate delegate and delegate a strong link from our G.S.R.s to G.S.O. Most of our districts have monthly meetings. Our standing committees include P.I., Convention, Archives, Correctional Facilities, Hospital & Treatment and Grapevine. The enthusiasm and unity shown among our committees, D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s are the very core of our true success as a healthy and thriving area.—*Julie Newton*

Arkansas: Our area has over 250 groups in 12 districts. Only our largest metropolitan district has L.C.M.s, but at least half the districts rely on the alternate D.C.M. to cover the groups. The C.F. committee is trying to keep up with the expanding number of federal and state institutions; court classes are being tried as the outgrowth of four mini-correctional conferences held this year. Our archivist has traveled to several other areas putting on preservation/conservation workshops; Treatment is pursuing a Bridge the Gap program. P.I. has been active in schools from the third grade through high school, and the C.P.C. committee put on a workshop for treatment center providers and counselors. Grapevine has a traveling display that has made the state and district conventions. Our quarterly area assemblies in Little Rock start with a Traditions and Concepts meeting. Currently the alternate delegate and the area chair are doing a series of structure workshops throughout the districts.—*Conley Byrd*

British Columbia/Yukon: Our area has 720 groups in 46 districts, with a strong area committee that travels to area service functions. Our area took its inventory in January, the outcome being: How to have better communications between the G.S.R.s, their groups, the D.C.M.s and area to the General Service Conference? To enhance communication we have a program, "A Journey Through the Third Legacy," to take out into the area for one-day workshops. Each year we have three quarterlies and a Fall assembly, and have suggested that districts group together and have mini-assemblies between quarterlies to improve communication. The Bridging the Gap program for treatment and correctional facilities is building momentum. The area committee has just published a G.S.R. information booklet for new G.S.R.s to introduce them to the area and general service structure, and to help them serve this great Fellowship of ours.—*Larry Schlosser*

California (Northern Coastal): Each of our 20 districts has a D.C.M. chair and D.C.M.s serving as many subdistricts as necessary; two at-large districts serve Spanish-language groups. The delegate and seven area officers rotate visiting the monthly district meetings. The area has a thriving young Bridging the Gap committee, a newly energized archives committee, a monthly sharing session for district P.I./C.P.C. committees, and a monthly newsletter. We cooperate with 16 local intergroup offices and an autonomous committee which takes meetings and literature to treatment and correctional facilities. All of our activities are entirely supported by group contributions. Credited with around 2,000 registered groups (though we're not sure we have that many), we are one of the largest areas in the Conference, and are engaged in a lively discussion

about splitting the area.—*Diane Watson*

California (Southern): Our area represents over 65,000 A.A. members in 2,000 groups and 57 districts; included are seven active Spanish-speaking districts with about 150 groups. Our assembly meets six times each year and provides a G.S.R. orientation meeting and a D.C.M. sharing session. Our ten area standing committees usually meet monthly, as do our districts. We have 14 central offices, each of which was invited to send a representative, with voting privileges, to our assemblies. This year we added a Bridging the Gap ad hoc committee. For the last year and a half an ad hoc committee has been studying ways to reorganize our area and improve our committee system; periodically, we have met with other California area committees. In particular, we enjoy our annual California D.C.M. Sharing Session (with Mid-Southern, San Diego-Imperial, and Baja-California) as well as attending PRAASA (Pacific Region Service Assembly) and our Pacific Regional Forum.—*Mary Ellen Davis*

Colorado: In Area 10 we have 28 districts (including one Spanish-speaking district) and over 600 groups. We conduct quarterly area assemblies, which are rotated around the state, and hold an annual State Convention. The area has seven central offices and/or intergroup service offices. A records coordinator maintains group and district records. The P.I. committee has been working with schools and has put Big Books into many libraries. The C.P.C. committee has participated in Colorado Department of Health conferences, the State Judicial Conference and has been working in the hearing-impaired community. The Grapevine committee is "recycling" old issues to prisons and treatment centers. The Treatment Facilities committee assists 85 weekly meetings held by 40 groups. The Corrections committee placed \$22,000 worth of literature in prisons during 1992 through the "Pink Can" program, and has been active in Corresponding Contact and Release Contact programs. The Archives committee has prepared new displays and continues to catalog information submitted from around the state. The *High Country News*, our area newsletter, is circulated to over 600 committee members and G.S.R.s each quarter.—*Gary Kluksdahl*

Connecticut: We have over 1,400 meetings a week, with 1,101 registered groups. Area 11 is divided into ten districts, including one Spanish-speaking district. The nine districts are divided into three subdistricts, with 55 D.C.M.s and 28 alternates. Our Spanish-speaking district is extremely active and had their first annual roundup in March. We have 15 standing service committees, with possibly a new literature committee in the spring. We have two annual assemblies; an area roundup; a Soberfest, which is a three-day get-together held at an outdoor resort on the last weekend of June; and a three-day convention in September. Our P.I. committee hosts an on-air open meeting once a month on a public radio station which reaches the whole area. Our area newsletter, *The Alkiline*, is printed six times a year, and an area service directory once a year. Our special service committees and all of our trusted servants in Area 11 are working hard to stay sober and carry the message to the still-suffering alcoholic and all those yet to come.—*Bob Taylor*

District of Columbia: On the map Area 13 may appear to be the smallest area, but in terms of A.A. spirit and fellowship we are large by any standard. Our assembly meets three times a year and is supported by 470 active groups; the area committee meets 11 times a year. The assembly carries its message of service to the groups by holding an annual mini-conference

and a gratitude breakfast. In addition, we are sponsoring several group officer workshops during 1993. The Washington Area has one intergroup that is supported by 250 groups, with more than 1,900 meetings a week. The area assembly and intergroup cooperate in supporting the C.P.C., P.I. and H&I committees. During 1992 the C.P.C. committee staffed the A.A. booth at 15 major conventions. Our H&I committee is responsible for 320 meetings per month. During 1993 we will redistrict the assembly and cooperate with the intergroup on a self-support project.—*Mark Langsam*

Florida (North): Our area has four two-day assemblies annually. We have 570 groups in 32 districts, some of which are divided into subdistricts with an L.C.M. who reports to the D.C.M. at regular intervals. The districts meet monthly with the G.S.R.s. We have, in the last two years, instituted three new subcommittees—Finance, Growth and Site. The Finance committee prepares the annual budget and aids the treasurer. The Growth committee works with the districts in managing their growth problems. The Site committee, chaired by the alternate chairman, locates hotel sites for the assemblies for the upcoming two-year period. We have eight very active committees; Treatment Facilities, Corrections, Grapevine, Archives, Accessibilities, Intergroup Liaison, C.P.C. and P.I. Our theme for the assembly for the past year has been "Unity Through Communication" and we are carrying it over into 1993, as we strive for better communications from the area to the groups and back to the area.—*Tom Dougherty*

Florida (South)/Bahamas/Virgin Islands: Fellowship growth and healing are the key highlights of service in Area 15. With membership currently increasing 9% annually, the area committees/district committee member structure is vital for effective and efficient service. We have grown to well over 1,600 groups in 15 districts, with meetings in English, Spanish, French, and one in Finnish. We look to this Conference for service experience, as what works for this body will probably work for us. The "us" and "they" atmosphere has pretty well evaporated and today—as one—we practice our Fifth Tradition. October is P.I.'s "Big Book Month" when monies are raised to provide our basic text—standard edition, large print, Braille—to schools and libraries. Many Gratitude Dinners in November raise funds to help carry A.A.'s message worldwide via G.S.O. Grapevine Round-ups hype Fellowship awareness of these spiritual tools while Correction committees benefit from new and old issues of our magazine. C.P.C.'s Adopt-a-Doctor and Treatment's Bridging the Gap programs have been slow, but both committees are enthusiastic and persevering. Archives keeps growing. In addition to carrying the message, Finance, Quarterly Conference Coordinator, and ad hoc committees aid us in running our business.—*Pat Dawson*

Hawaii: Our area has added three new districts, making a total of 17, with over 250 registered groups and over 400 meetings. Area committee meetings and assemblies are rotated throughout the four larger islands. The annual Hawaii Area Convention is a major event, attended last year by over 2,000, over half from the mainland and foreign countries. Much of the Island of Kauai was wiped out by Hurricane Iniki in September. Many A.A. meeting rooms were destroyed along with literature, coffee pots, supplies, etc. The Kauai D.C.M. reported it was awesome to watch the spiritual principles of the program work. Meetings were held on steps where buildings had stood; many meetings were held with flashlight and candlelight for months. What an inspiration to hear people share about love, neighbors and God when they didn't have a bed or a home, or were un-

certain as to where their next meal was coming from. The spiritual principles and love of Kauai A.A. members are an inspiration to us all.—*Anne Mabery*

Illinois (Chicago): Our area has 2,600 groups, meetings in 23 districts. Our annual All Chicago Open Meeting is attended by 12,000 plus. Our central office, an intricate part of our service structure, has seven full-time staff and many volunteers. They relay Twelfth Step calls and information to our Fellowship, along with requests and information to our five other standing committees; C.P.C., P.I., Treatment and Correctional Facilities, and Grapevine. Our area is rich in A.A. history, and our Archives committee is sorting and filing boxes of material. They also display material in our office, at conferences, and upon request. An ad hoc committee was formed to supply signers at meetings for the hearing impaired, and has now become our Special Needs Committee. Some of our other ad hoc committees are Budget, Structure, Policy, Sharing Session, and Committee on Conferences. We also have the G.S.R. Experience, to explain the service structure to new G.S.R.s and anyone interested. This year we had our first Area Forum, to share and inform the delegate of the feelings and needs of the Fellowship, prior to the General Service Conference.—*Walter Zoller*

Illinois (Southern): Area 21 covers over 70% of Illinois, mostly small towns and rural communities, and continues to grow in the number of active groups. We have added the new position of Group Information Secretary to our area committee, which maintains current data on all the groups in the area. We have modified the Group Registration form to fit our area needs and they are supplied to the D.C.M.s. We have added four new districts recently and have a redistricting committee. We look forward to expanding the use of workshops at our area assemblies with the goal of exciting more members into service work.—*Bill Baker*

Indiana (Northern): After redistricting, we went from 16 to 49 districts, approximately 655 groups. The smaller districts have allowed the D.C.M.s to be more active and therefore more efficient in carrying the A.A. message. Since we decreased the number of groups in each district the D.C.M.s are more willing to take on responsibility. Communication in Area 22 is getting better. The Third D.C.M. Conference is coming up in March. It has allowed the D.C.M.s to be more informed on what is going on in New York and in our area. Our area assembly meetings are getting larger each year. The G.S.R.s, D.C.M.s and committee chairpersons are participating more and getting more active in the area. Literature and Grapevine chairpersons have a large inventory and a great display for our area functions; our Archives chairman has started to get a display for our area.—*Cathy Ferrante*

Iowa: Area 24 has 650 groups in 20 districts. The Area Committee meets three times a year along with two assemblies; seven of the last ten meetings have had 100% attendance of the committee. Archives has rented office space in Des Moines and there is much activity in P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, Bridge the Gap, and Treatment Facilities. We have updated our Area Actions for informing new committee members of past actions. The newsletter is sent to all G.S.R.s in an attempt to keep the groups informed and interested in area activity. A new Financial committee has set some guidelines for officers' expenses. Our area structure is serving us well at present.—*Hugh Vaughan*

Louisiana: In addition to our quarterly area assembly meetings, we have at least nine major conventions in our state every year, including our upcoming 35th Annual State Convention. Our area is made up of 23 districts with over 500 groups. Our service committees are constantly increasing the level of service they provide in carrying the message in our area: the assembly publishes a quarterly newsletter; our Grapevine committee was the only area in the Southeast Region to increase the number of GV representatives and Grapevine subscriptions; our Corrections committee has meetings in practically all institutions in our metropolitan cities and many rural towns; we now have an Archives office; the Treatment committee has meetings in both private and public treatment and detox facilities; Archives and Grapevine committees have portable displays. All of this has been accomplished due to the hard work, dedication and commitment of our assembly members.

—Michael O'Connor

Massachusetts (Eastern): Our area comprises over 2,200 groups and/or meetings that are served by our area committee and 26 districts, as well as two Hispanic districts. G.S.R.s and D.C.M.s attend five rotating one-day assemblies each year. The area has active committees for Archives, C.F., C.P.C., Grapevine, P.I., and T.F., as well as an area registrar, literature committee and a structure study committee which is looking into the possibility of redistricting. Two district treatment facilities committees hosted seminars. In September 1992 our area reached a financial crisis which we responded to by doing a mailing to all groups. Thus we became aware that it is not apathy but lack of communication and information which affected participation by our groups. In February 1992 our area hosted the first NERAASA. In cooperation with Area 31, Western Mass., we will be hosting our 30th State Convention this year. In keeping with the theme our primary focus for 1993 is a Fifth Tradition emphasis on our singleness of purpose.—Robert McElroy

Michigan (Central): Again this year the East Central Region will host the Regional Forum, and again this year we will send 20–22 people at the expense of our area. In 1985 we started a fund of \$150 a month from intra-area monies, and since that time we have sent approximately 80 people to Forums. We have found this to be a very successful tool in keeping people interested in service. We have also, in the past year, started a State Corrections prerelease program for inmates leaving our state correctional facilities (both male and female). The three delegate areas in Michigan are all involved in this project and we meet quarterly. These meetings are held in a central location and are attended by our three area Correction chairpersons, state Corrections chair and many interested persons and volunteers from all over the state. We exchange information and ideas and are always trying to improve on ways to help our inmates leave prison and become useful members of society and to help them stay sober so they can carry the message to someone else.—Al George

Michigan (Southeast): Our area is grateful to have well-qualified chairpersons for each of our standing committees, plus two coordinators, and liaisons to intergroup offices and Young People in A.A. We have a Film committee with two projection crews; a Traditions Skit, a Grapevine Play, and a lot of activity with our Corrections committee—local and statewide. Our archivist has a growing permanent display near downtown Detroit. All of these folks, along with our D.C.M.s and some of our 540 G.S.R.s, get together once a month for committee and district reports and an assembly meeting. Our 24 districts

also meet monthly, and sponsor picnics, alkathons, and workshops. Three area workshops are held annually. We continue to promote cooperation between our area services and our intergroup offices in an effort to eliminate duplication of service work. All of our efforts are enhanced by our recent nonprofit status and use of our area-owned computer. We have cut our costs, while increasing our ability to communicate. We have several weekend conventions each year, sponsored by Area 33 general services or by intergroup offices. This gets a lot of people involved, and it's a great way to carry the message.

—Sam Reams

Minnesota (Southern): We have over 1,000 registered groups and 21 districts, with 11 committees. They meet four times a year before the area committee meeting. We have three assemblies and one service conference yearly, and our officers meet monthly. Our alternate delegate serves as chair of the Structure Committee, which is responsible for how we function and communicate. Our alternate area chair is chair of the Finance Committee, custodians of our financial policy and regularly reminding our membership of their responsibility to the Seventh Tradition. Our service conference is devoted to the General Service Conference agenda items and topics with full participation from the Fellowship. A delegate's workshop brings the area conscience to the delegate prior to the Conference. As a result of these efforts we find our Fellowship more informed and committed to how we can better function and participate in A.A. as a whole.—Esther Hall

Missouri (Eastern): Our area has 20 districts (17 are active) and 550 registered groups. Less than 50% of these groups participate in supporting our Third Legacy structure through donations. We have completed the second year of maintaining an area office with paid help. There is much potential in this office, but it is a success now in every way but one—it is not being supported by the Fellowship. This is a problem, as our prudent reserve is being eroded. We hold three one-day assemblies per year and one two-day assembly. The two-day assembly is held in the fall to coincide with elections. Attendance averages around 200 which is just more than double what it was in 1985. Encouraging signs abound in our area, participation is growing. Outstate districts are more active and demonstrate strong leadership. On the downside are the inactive districts. While these districts are rural, with limited number of meetings, we intend to make sure they are aware of the Third Legacy structure and invite their participation.

—John Verdon

Missouri (Western): Our area has 17 districts, 210 groups, and a membership of about 3,900. Area business is conducted at quarterly two-day assemblies. We are currently self-supporting, with an increase in birthday donations to the area this past year. Service is stressed at assemblies and we strongly urge attendance at the Southwest Regional A.A. Service Assembly. Three committees are self-supporting—Treatment and Corrections Facilities, and Grapevine. Treatment and Corrections committees derive funds from a yearly Institution Weekend, and the Grapevine committee has Grapevine articles available for sale at various area functions, thus generating funds for that committee. One important area activity of the past year was to amend the area guidelines to clarify voting. In keeping with the current theme, our area is doing some inventory taking and looking at budgetary issues, ways of improving communication, and making better use of our time at assemblies.—Gene Hughey

Nevada: Our area includes the state of Nevada and parts of California, with approximately 345 registered groups. The area is 800 miles, with Reno and Las Vegas being the metropolitan areas. The area is split north and south, and these two bodies meet six times a year. The communication between north and south is great and the area is well informed. We just finished an area geographical map with all twenty districts boundaries noted. We have also just added an area archivist and an area records secretary. There are four annual area newsletters and the intergroups print monthly newsletters. All of the committee chairs attend the general service meetings with the liaison attending intergroup meetings. Northern general service sponsors a gratitude dinner and most of the area committee is self-supporting in attending PRASSA's. Our H&I committee has just started a conference and we have recently started a Special Needs committee. Our C.P.C. committee has a medical student program, and also works with judges at a local college in a one-day program. Area 42 is strong on self-support at the group, district and area levels.—*Pete Litano*

New Jersey (Northern): In the last year our area has gone from 30 to 35 districts. We now serve about 1,200 groups and 26,000 members. We have one intergroup office with two paid employees. All our service committees, P.I., C.P.C., C.F., T.F., Grapevine and Literature are functioning very well. The Grapevine and other GV items have become very visible because of the committee's work. Our Literature committee stocks about \$15,000 worth of literature in our area office. We display and sell A.A. literature at all area, district and intergroup functions. All in all our area is very committed to carrying the A.A. message to the still-suffering alcoholic through our service committees.—*John Hughes*

New York (Central): We currently have over 600 groups registered with our area. The area recently redistricted from six districts to more than thirty. We just finished an Area Handbook which describes the things that are unique to our area. For a number of years, we have had very active standing committees for Grapevine, Literature, Corrections, Treatment, Archives, C.P.C. and P.I. We have been involved with informational and cooperational meetings with professionals from treatment and correctional facilities. We feel some of the challenges to be faced are new types of special interest groups, meeting the needs of new and older members that are physically challenged in any way. Area assemblies are held eleven times a year with the twelfth as the delegate's report given at an area convention each May.—*Charles Burns*

New York (Southeast): Our area has over 2,000 registered groups served by thirteen counties, with six Spanish-speaking districts. Highlights from our area newsletter, *THE LINK*, are translated into Spanish. We have five assemblies and ten committee meetings a year. The committee on Special Needs is a permanent standing committee, and we have active P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, and Treatment Facilities committees. Our Intergroup Liaison meets quarterly with Area 49's intergroups and answering services. We will host the 1993 Northeast Regional Convention and will bid for the 1995 Northeast Regional Forum and the 1995 NERD. S.E.N.Y.'s officers and committee chairs conduct service workshops in our counties. We hope our service workshops will help A.A. members to grow in all three Legacies of Recovery, Unity, and Service.—*Denise Bell*

North Carolina: Our area has 34 districts, 789 registered groups and some 11,260 members, representing an overall growth of approximately 9 percent. All area officers are elected

by Third Legacy Procedure. Our committees include Grapevine, C.P.C./P.I., Literature, Budget/Finance, Site Investigation, Archive, and, only recently, the Correctional Facilities committee. This new committee has already hit the ground running, to assist the service districts and groups with correspondence, and plans for workshops and other activities. The area is moving its two annual committee meetings, two annual area assemblies and an annual convention to a new location, the first such move to result from efforts of a Site Investigation committee. While our bid to host the 1994 Southeastern Regional Forum was not selected, we look forward to bidding for and subsequently hosting the Forum in 1996, that our area members might experience the tremendous opportunity in service it offers.—*Ron Sharpe*

Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador: Our area has 282 groups with approximately 3,300 members, and covers a large geographical area spanning two provinces that are divided into 16 districts. Because travel is both difficult and expensive, we have one assembly in the fall, which is rotated among the four major cities. We hold provincial service weekends in May to hear reports from the D.C.M.s, area officers and the delegate's Conference report. Each province maintains an archives, and intergroup services are offered in the capital cities. The districts play the most important role in our structure, especially at the committee level. Most have very active P.I., C.P.C. and, where applicable, Treatment and Correctional Facilities committees. Much of our communication is by mail and telephone and the exchange of district meeting minutes helps produce a sharing of ideas and a sense of unity throughout our area.

—*Janice French*

Ohio (Central & Southeast): Area 53 is a progressively active area; our quarterly assembly meetings have grown in the last four years to over 150 participants. Our standing committees are all active. We have a G.S.R. school for any group or district requesting help and a quarterly meeting with the area committee, the standing committees and D.C.M.s. The area's goals this year are to have 44 active districts, to provide a Grapevine representative school, to continually improve communications between the area committee and the districts, to make sure all standing committees have the funds necessary to do an effective job, and to stress both the primary purpose of Alcoholics Anonymous and the Seventh Tradition. The Ohio State Conference will be hosted by Area 53 July 9–11, in Columbus. The theme is "What Shape Is Your Triangle?"

—*Shaaron Johnson*

Ohio (Northeast): Northeast Ohio has more than 1,200 groups spread out over 54 districts in 20 counties. We are working on the formation of G.S.R. and D.C.M. training to help those G.S.R.s become active in the general service process. We are very proud to have sent three committee chairs to the Bridge the Gap Seminar in Iowa this past summer. We have an active Bridge the Gap Program, as part of Treatment and Correctional committees activities. Area contributions are growing and have been sufficient to support most of the area's projects. One of the goals of this area is to expand a growing relationship between our districts and their respective groups and group representatives.—*Al Johnson*

Oklahoma: A.A. is growing in Oklahoma; we have eight districts, with six D.C.M.s each and 5,880 members in 375 groups. Besides Oklahoma City Intergroup Office and Tulsa Central Service Office two more intergroup offices have been added. Contributing groups to G.S.O. is 62 percent. In keeping with

the Seventh Tradition we have a Gratitude Plan where it is suggested members donate \$1 per year of sobriety up to \$10. Our service committees are Archives, Bridging the Gap, Corrections, C.P.C., Grapevine, Policy and Procedure, P.I., Treatment Facilities, and Oklahoma Gratitude Plan. Every prison, correctional center and state hospital in Oklahoma has an A.A. meeting, and Bridge the Gap is expanding the A.A. message into many more treatment facilities. Our quarterly area committees and annual general assembly meetings are well attended and growing in numbers as well as in knowledge of service to A.A. We have many great A.A. workers in Oklahoma, but like my Daddy used to say, "We still have a long row to hoe."—*Gene Benson*

Ontario (Eastern): 1993 is a momentous year for the Eastern Ontario Area 83 and for Canada. The first A.A. meeting started January 13, 1943 in Toronto, and rapidly expanded across the country. The celebration of the 50th Anniversary will be the Canadian and American July holiday weekend. We hope you and your friends, both Canadian and American, will join us at the Metro Convention Centre in Toronto that weekend. Our area continues to experience growth with 585 groups and 25 districts. We hold two assemblies and three area committee meetings yearly. In 1993 an Ad Hoc Finance Committee was formed to do a complete review of expenditures and suggest guidelines for the most effective use of our Seventh Tradition funds. In 1991 the area added Intergroup liaison to the alternate delegates duties; the first joint sharing between the two entities was at our Fall assembly. Our area was proud to have taken part in the First Eastern Canada Regional Delegates meeting during the Regional Forum in Hull, PQ, last September. We continue to hold successful Ontario Delegates Committee meetings twice yearly. A.A. in Eastern Ontario is alive, well and looking forward to the challenges of the 1990s.
—*Don Swallow*

Ontario (Northeast): Our area extends as far north as Albany on the James Bay Coast to as far south as Parry Sound, Ontario, to Sault Ste Marie in the west to North Bay, Ontario in the east. We have approximately 170 groups and eight districts. We hold three committee meetings a year and an area assembly once a year. Six years ago our area talked about becoming self-supporting and when Ontario Provincial Committee closed last year we were able to do so without any conflict. Our area operates on a budget of approximately \$15,000 per year. Our recent contribution to New York was \$5,000 and we feel that this is just the start of something good. In the past year we have started an area newsletter and area directory. With enthusiasm and foresight we have never relinquished our quest in fulfilling our primary purpose of carrying the message to the alcoholic who still suffers.—*Harold Dredhart*

Ontario (Northwest): Although our area is small in numbers, with only eight districts and 1,500 members, we are large in area; 750 miles by 500 miles. A little over two years ago our area became fully self-supporting and we are meeting our area financial needs as well as contributing to G.S.O. We hold two assemblies a year, in the fall and the spring. In March we hosted a weekend meeting of the Ontario Delegates Committee, where many of the province's four areas' concerns were shared and discussed. A committee is in progress to make the necessary arrangements for our area's hosting of the Eastern Canada Regional Forum in the fall of 1994. One of the objectives that I hope can be achieved during my term as delegate is that we continue to help and carry the message to the Native alcoholics in our area; many more need to be reached.
—*Norman Litwin*

Pennsylvania (Eastern): We have districts in 45 of the 67 counties in Pennsylvania, with 1,315 registered groups and 323 meetings; 48 groups are in correctional facilities and 25 are in treatment facilities. Nine active subcommittees enable us to have a strong area structure; groups are well informed through active D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s. Four annual mini-assemblies provide an opportunity for panel and roundtable discussions on specific topics and for the delegate to give the Conference report. We also will hold an all Eastern Pa. Area Forum. Many groups and members are making more and more Twelfth Step calls because many treatment centers are closing or cutting back. We are alive and well and continue to be guided by a spiritual force and moral powers.
—*Hugo McKissic*

Pennsylvania (Western): Area 60 encompasses some 700 A.A. groups of close to 11,000 members in 45 districts. Our six elected officers are working as a team to carry the message of service and help our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s do their jobs. Special D.C.M. sharing sessions are scheduled prior to quarterly area committee meetings. In March we hold our Getaway Weekend and Pre-Conference Assembly, focusing on the General Service Conference. Our alternate area chairperson serves as area Grapevine representative. We also have a recording secretary, alternate treasurer, literature coordinator, newsletter editor and area registrar. Our area-wide services include Archives, C.P.C., P.I., Correctional, and Treatment Facilities. To our knowledge, Area 60 has never had a budget; we're working on one now. Nor had we, in recent memory, ever hosted a regional event. But now we have! In October of 1992 Area 60 was pleased to host the 22nd annual Northeast Regional Convention. We are presently working with Eastern Pennsylvania Area 59 on another first for the future—a Pennsylvania State Convention.—*Lois Concelman*

Quebec (Northeast): Our area has 21 districts and 380 groups, with approximately 6,800 members and 408 meetings a week. We have a central office for the six districts located in and around Quebec City and also have an area office for our 21 districts in their entirety. We have nine area committees: Archives, Finance, Correctional Facilities, Treatment Facilities, C.P.C., Literature, Grapevine and Area Bulletin. We hold a monthly meeting with the members of our area executive committee. We hold two general meetings a year with the D.C.M.s, G.S.R.s and area coordinators and four or five meetings a year with the R.D.R.s and the area coordinators. One of the most important things in our area is to be in permanent contact with our D.C.M.s and G.S.R.s by an exchange of correspondence or by visiting them regularly in their district meetings. It has been our principal challenge for a few years and it works.—*René Desharnais*

Quebec (Southeast): Our area has 4,000 members, 230 G.S.R.s and 20 D.C.M.s, and together we strive to carry the A.A. message, to share our recovery and to serve. Guided by the Third Legacy, we have set up services suggested by A.A. P.I. has gotten "a fair wind in the sails." Our presence in correctional centers has been improved too. Now, C.P.C. and treatment facilities are our concern. Our literature needs are served by the capital work of Service des Publications Françaises. Moreover, each member can write and share in *La Vigne*, a local equivalent to Grapevine. In short, we try to follow the way of the language of the heart and, even if our language is French, our hearts beat with love and share in A.A. If you come to visit us, you're welcome, and will be received like I have been received myself. Merci d'être là!—*Régis Chénard*

Texas (Northeast): Our area is made up of a diversified and large land area: the Piney Woods of East Texas, the open spaces of the west, and parts of the Hill Country to the south. The Metro-plex (Dallas, Fort Worth) lies near the center. We have 29 districts, 446 groups, and lots of drunks who still suffer. We hold four assemblies a year; all the conference committees are in place to serve those who still suffer as well as meeting the needs of districts and groups. We have Spanish-speaking groups, and our area committee is always looking for ways to assist any district or group in ways to better carry our message. There is good communication flowing from the group level throughout our structure and back. Workshops on our Conference theme as well as other topics are held throughout our area. Participation is always good and improving. The spiritual health of our area is like personal recovery. It's not perfect, but always progressing.—*Davis Tolleson*

Texas (Southeast): Our 31st area conference was held in January, with 1,800 attending. We currently have 16 districts in our area and all D.C.M. positions are active. Constructive district meetings and workshops are being conducted. Our area committees are functioning well and participation is increasing. The archives committee had their material on display at our area conference. The correctional committee has increased the amount of literature being passed on to inmates at all units. We have two Hispanic districts with active D.C.M.s and participation at the area assembly is growing. We are pursuing the cost of translation equipment for our assembly and other A.A. related functions. A.A. is alive and growing in Southeast Texas and enthusiasm is very noticeable in all levels of service.—*Russell Cook*

Utah: Area 69 serves the entire state of Utah and we are growing fast. We have three central offices and 10 districts that hold monthly meetings with fair attendance, 240 groups and many meetings. Our area newsletter has had a difficult time, but the future looks positive. We hold three yearly assemblies, pre-Conference, post-Conference, and fall election assemblies. The area committee meets five times yearly. Our area is working on its inventories, the home group, the districts, area committee, and the area assembly. Our standing committees are functioning well, with special attention for the hearing impaired and minorities, where the need is increasing with our growth. The need for Spanish-speaking meetings is increasing and our Northern Central Office is stocking a full supply of Spanish literature. Our C.P.C. committee cooperates with many outside organizations to provide more information about A.A. Utah will be celebrating our 50-year Birthday in 1994 and our active area archives has a book on the state history planned. Recently, we held the second workshop on the Concepts and Traditions, hoping to become more informed, as an area, on these all important principals. Better communication is the goal of our service structure for the coming year.—*Gay Walters*

Virginia and Cuba: And Cuba? At our Regional Forum last December, I was told that the two meetings in Guantanamo Bay were part of the Virginia Area. A.A. is alive and well in Virginia. The last two years we've worked on an inventory, which grew out of thoughts about splitting the area. Our assets are many. Our strong committee system, with ten active committees, supports the work of A.A. throughout Virginia. Attendance at our assemblies is increasing. We have many new G.S.R.s at each assembly. Unfortunately, we have some deficits. Communication is a problem, along with apathy and

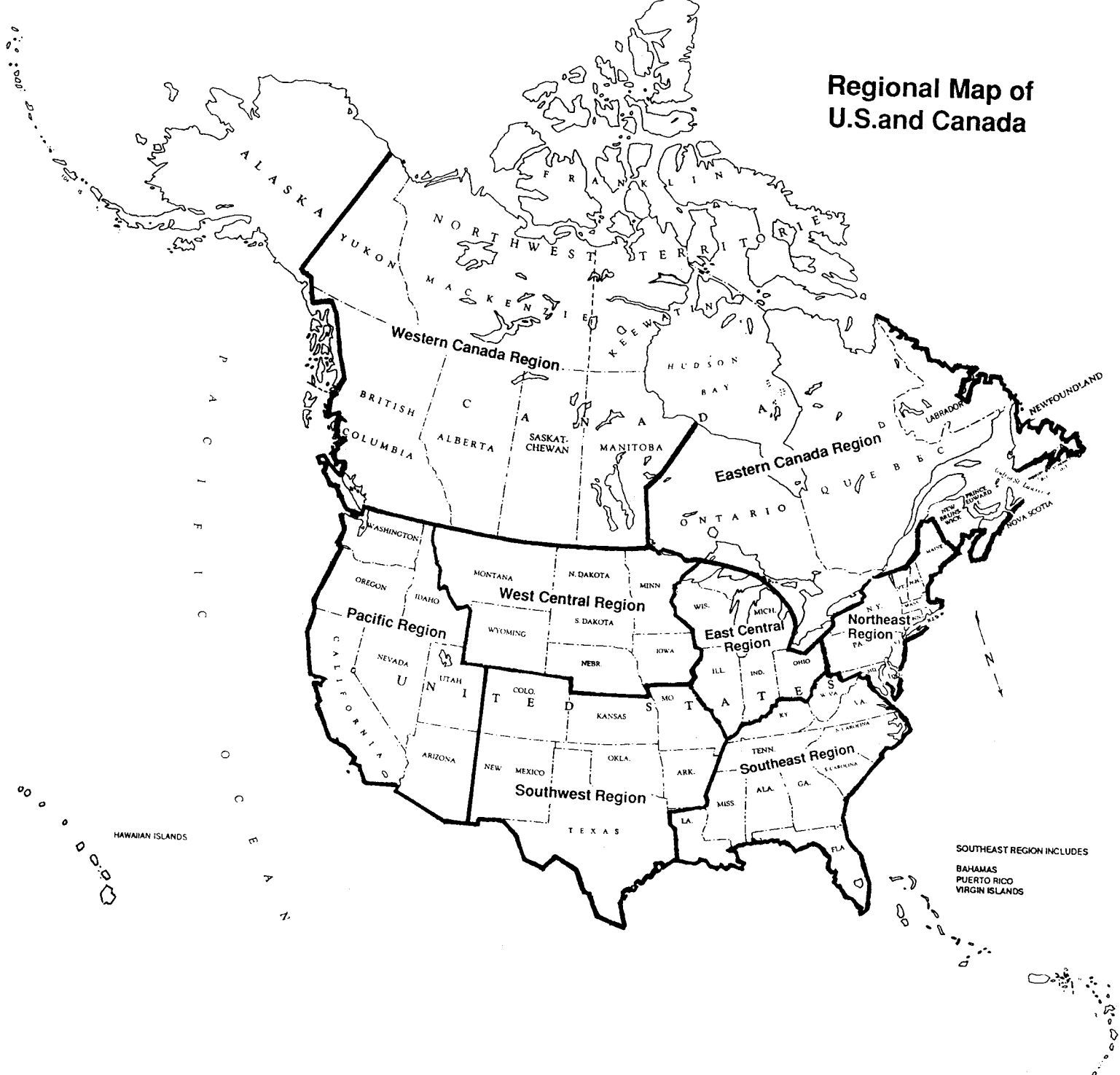
that eternal bugaboo, the "us and them" syndrome. We have begun to address our defects with workshops, more time for G.S.R.s at the assembly, and just plain old talking it out. No matter what the problem is, the solution is communication, action, and faith in a power greater than ourselves.
—*Susan Campbell*

Washington: Our area covers Washington State, Northern Idaho and a corner of British Columbia, with 54 districts representing 1,300 groups. Twenty-five of these districts have been added in the last three years in an effort to improve communications. We have three area committee meetings and one assembly each year; more than 40% of the registered groups are represented by a G.S.R. at our assemblies. Last year we added five regional "pre-Conference" mini-assemblies to discuss upcoming Conference topics so the groups could be more involved in the Conference process, and the delegate is better prepared. Each of our standing committees (P.I., C.P.C., Corrections, Treatment and Archives) holds quarterly meetings attended by up to 50 people from the district and group level. Each of these committees, except Archives, has a counterpart on the other side of the mountains which divide the area. The Grapevine and Literature committees jointly hold one annual workshop. Our monthly Washington Area Newsletter is sent without charge to all G.S.R.s and area committee members. Our traveling archives display is a popular addition to many service functions around the area.—*Burke Dykes*

West Virginia: In 1992 our area conducted an inventory beginning at the group level, continuing through the districts and culminating with a special assembly in July. The inventory illuminated many areas of service which stand to be improved. In August we hosted the Southeastern Regional Convention in Charleston, with an attendance in excess of 1,100. Unity throughout our area was greatly improved by this experience. Our spring assembly in March discussed a possible committee on finance and budget, a state-wide 800 number, archives, a quarterly area newsletter, and other topics. Problems within the area at present are: no permanent home for archives, group financial support of only about 50% and communication between all levels in service. Planning of assemblies and conventions (facilities, costs, coffee, etc.) continues to be burdensome due to large turnout of members, a nice problem to have!
—*Jon Mason*

Wisconsin (Southern): Our area serves 884 groups in 37 districts. We hold a spring and fall conference and six area assemblies a year. Each of our service committees holds four workshops a year. Our assembly voted to create a separate area committee, Bridging the Gap, to handle contacts for both treatment and corrections. Young people in our area are involved in service work, and have formed a committee called "G.S.R. Outreach." Our P.I. committees have been busy putting A.A. information into public libraries, public and private school libraries, and supplying recovery information to nursing homes. There has also been an increase in the use of public service announcements. Our new area newsletter, *Action News*, is published quarterly. Our districts hold monthly G.S.R. meetings and four districts have yearly mini-conferences. Our traveling archives display will be at all of our conferences. We have started an A.A. meeting in a shelter for homeless men. We strive to make service part of our recovery in Area 75.
—*Joan Johnson*

Regional Map of U.S. and Canada



Additional Committee Considerations Which Did Not Result in Recommendations

Advisory Action 40 of the 1990 General Service Conference states: "Items discussed, but no action taken or recommendation made, as well as committee recommendations which are not adopted, be included in a separate section of the Final Conference Report." Those committee recommendations which are not adopted (less than $\frac{2}{3}$ of the total Conference votes in favor), but which received at least a simple majority of the votes, are considered "strong suggestions" of the Conference. All items, listed by committee, are as follows:

AD HOC COMMITTEE ON CHIPS/MEDALLIONS*

Committee recommendations not adopted by Conference:

- The Conference find that the initiation of litigation involving trademarks and service marks is a violation of Warranty Five.

- The General Service Board take the steps necessary to bring all policies and practices into conformity with the spirit of the Warranties and the report and recommendations of the 1993 Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions.

Committee recommendation *withdrawn* prior to final vote by Conference:

Given the fact that the above two recommendations were not adopted by Conference, the following recommendation was withdrawn by the Committee:

- The General Service Board develop a new policy statement on the "Use of A.A.'s Trademarks and Logos" (*The A.A. Service Manual*, p. S103) that reflects the spirit of the committee's report and recommendations, and report back to the 44th General Service Conference on the policy and its implementation.



* For the complete report of the Ad Hoc Committee, see p. 9.

AGENDA

- The Annual General Service Conference Questionnaire was reviewed and accepted as presented.
- The committee investigated the possibility of forming an ad hoc committee, similar in intent to the inventory committee, proposed by an area, and decided not to pursue it.
- The committee requested that a sharing session entitled "The Spirit of Sacrifice: The Twelfth Step in Action" be scheduled after the workshop.

COOPERATION WITH THE PROFESSIONAL COMMUNITY

- The committee thoroughly considered, with appreciation, text revisions by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee in the pamphlet "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" and suggested that no changes be made at this time.
- In addition, the committee strongly suggested that the original intent of "How A.A. Members Cooperate with Other Community Efforts to Help Alcoholics" be investigated and provided to the Conference C.P.C. Committee as background information, and that the scope, focus and current need for the pamphlet be defined by the trustees' C.P.C. Committee and provided to the Conference C.P.C. Committee for consideration in 1994.
- The committee discussed concerns from several areas regarding expenses, value and Traditions involved in exhibiting at national professional conferences and was supportive of the current practice and policy. The committee also discussed the policy of providing financial assistance for local exhibits and several members of the committee expressed concern regarding the Seventh Tradition, while others viewed the practice as additional opportunities to carry the message.

CORRECTIONAL FACILITIES

- The committee considered the suggestion to clarify the status of correctional facility groups vis-a-vis "outside" A.A. groups and were in agreement that Warranty Six and the long form of Tradition Three are the best description of *any* A.A. group; and that whether the G.S.R. of a correctional facility group is an "outside" or "inside" A.A. member should be left up to local and/or group autonomy; and that whether correctional facility G.S.R.s have a vote at district and area meetings should also be left up to local autonomy.
- The committee reviewed the pamphlets "A.A. in Correctional Facilities" and "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" to determine whether they continue to be adequate to meet today's needs. The committee agreed that additional information pertaining to the duties of correctional facility group sponsors and "inside" G.S.R.s is needed and suggested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee prepare copy for review by the 1994 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee for their consideration for inclusion in the pamphlet "A.A. in Correctional Facilities."
- The committee also agreed that additional information with emphasis on prerelease contacts should be added to the pamphlet "A Message to Correctional Facilities Administrators" and suggested that the trustees' Correctional Facilities Committee revise the last paragraph of this piece for review by the 1994 Conference Correctional Facilities Committee.



- The committee discussed the Corrections Correspondence Service and agreed that this service is an important one. However, the committee recognizes the difficulty G.S.O. has in obtaining "outside" A.A.s to correspond with inmates and were in agreement that perhaps it is now time for areas to become more involved in this Twelfth Step work.
- During this transition period, the committee suggests that when feasible, G.S.O. contact the Correctional Facilities Committee chairperson when an inmate from that area writes requesting an "outside" correspondent. The committee is aware that in some instances inmates are not allowed to receive correspondence from "outside" A.A.s in the same state and when this occurs, other areas can be asked to help out.
- The committee also suggested that Correctional Facilities Committees obtain a permanent mailing address or post office box so that inmates can be given this information to use for some of their other A.A. needs, i.e., literature, prerelease contacts, "outside" A.A. speakers, etc.
- The committee discussed ways that Correctional Facilities Committees can keep members aware of the usefulness of A.A. tools, i.e., films, literature, and the A.A. Grapevine, in their service work, and suggested that Correctional Facilities Committees set up a table at area assemblies, conventions and roundups with this material available so that members can become better informed about this Twelfth Step opportunity; groups can also become involved by purchasing Grapevines and literature for their local correctional facility groups; districts can hold correctional facility workshops or a day of sharing; Correctional Facilities committees can hold weekend workshops or a day of sharing; area, district and central office newsletters can be used to share what information is available to help carry the A.A. message into correctional facilities.
- The committee reviewed the page proofs of the new format for the Correctional Facilities Workbook and made some minor editing changes, the committee enthusiastically endorsed the new soft-cover format.

FINANCE

- The committee decided not to reaffirm past Actions of 1986 concerning self-support. The committee strongly suggests that the Seventh Tradition is each member's responsibility, and has recommended a new pamphlet be prepared.
- The committee discussed a proposal concerning creation of a "self-support program and position" and determined that it was inadvisable.

GRAPEVINE

- The committee discussed the Grapevine's history of self-support and wanted to reestablish focus on the magazine and to affirm the desire that the magazine be self-supporting through subscription income only.
- The committee discussed and considered in all its deliberations the results of the questionnaire distributed to delegates by the Conference Grapevine Committee.
- The committee discussed the proposal from the Grapevine Corporate Board that the magazine be taped quarterly, but took no action.
- The committee endorsed the Grapevine Corporate Board's proposal for new materials to be produced: in 1994, an A.A. history tape or tapes of Grapevine articles; in 1995, a book of cartoons/humor taken from the magazine.
- The committee discussed a concern expressed by an area about advertising special items in the Grapevine, and its consensus was that including information and order forms for materials derived from the Grapevine is consistent with the intent of the Grapevine's founders and A.A.'s Twelve Traditions.
- By consensus, the committee felt that it is not necessary to add the words "Pass Me On" to the cover of the Grapevine.
- The committee discussed a suggestion that the Responsibility Declaration be moved to another space in the magazine; the committee agreed with the suggestion and referred it to the editors and the Editorial Advisory Board for decision.

Strong suggestion of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than $\frac{2}{3}$, but more than $\frac{1}{2}$ in favor):

- That, because the Wall Calendars and Pocket Planners do not seem to adhere to the Grapevine's primary purpose, these items be phased out after production and distribution of the 1994 Calendar and Pocket Planner; the committee also recognized that since the Grapevine should be self-supporting through magazine income, the financial impact of this loss must be made up by increased subscriptions, and urged all delegates to work toward this end.

Committee recommendations *not adopted* by Conference:

- That the "About Alcoholism" section (the gray pages) in the Grapevine be reinstated, with the disclaimer.
- That the words "Our meeting in print" be removed from the cover of the Grapevine.

INTERNATIONAL CONVENTION

- The committee discussed a request that the badges and the program for the 1995 International Convention not identify people by title, such as Doctor, Sister and so on. the committee agreed that people should use whatever names they wish to use, both on their badges and in the program, as long as anonymity is observed.



LITERATURE

- The committee discussed the trustees' subcommittee report on "minorities" and suggested that we continue to emphasize our commonality and discourage use of the term "minorities" whenever possible.
- The committee discussed the trustees' subcommittee report on Literature Review and made the strong suggestion that no new specialty pamphlets be produced for at least two years in order to reflect on how our singleness of purpose is affected by the use of specialty pamphlets. Further, the committee suggested that the Literature Review Subcommittee continue and forward their suggested revisions to the 1994 Conference Literature Committee.
- The committee, at this time, would like to extend their deep sense of gratitude to the members of the trustees' Literature Review Subcommittee for a superb job on the monumental task they undertook in reviewing all A.A. literature.
- The committee considered proposed changes in the pamphlet "Twelve Traditions Illustrated" and referred the pamphlet to the trustees' Literature Subcommittee for further study.
- The committee considered proposed changes to "The A.A. Group" pamphlet and decided none were needed at this time.
- The committee considered proposed changes to the pamphlet titled "G.S.R." and suggested that the pamphlet be revised and updated by the Literature Review Subcommittee.
- The committee considered a request for district and area literature committee "guidelines" and suggested that the trustees' Literature Committee develop literature committee guidelines comprised of shared experience from the Fellowship.
- The committee discussed proposed changes to the booklet *Living Sober* and decided that none were needed.
- The committee discussed suggested update to the flyer "A Message to Teenagers" and referred the flyer to the trustees' Public Information Committee where the pamphlet originated.
- The committee discussed a request for a simplified version of the Big Book and determined that there is not sufficient expressed need.

- The committee discussed a request for a new book containing stories similar to the ones in the Big Book and suggested we seek input from the areas regarding the need for a book containing *only* stories from the first, second and third editions of the Big Book.
- The committee considered a suggestion to add the Preamble to the Big Book and suggested that since most of the Preamble was taken from the foreword to the first edition of the Big Book, no action be taken.
- The committee discussed the following change in the foreword to the second edition of the Big Book and took no action:

Proposal: Change paragraph two of page XIX of the Big Book to read: "This was the substance of the short form of A.A.'s Twelve Traditions, as prepared for public information and the instruction of newcomers and found on page 564 of this book. The full and complete text (long form) of A.A.'s Twelve Traditions for all members may be found on pages 565–568 of this volume."

- The committee discussed a request to change the title of the story "Doctor, Alcoholic, Addict" in the Big Book and took no action.
- The committee discussed a request for reaffirmation of certain Literature Conference Advisory Actions from 1969, 1971 and 1986 and, in lieu of reaffirming these Actions, the committee suggested that they be included in the proposed Literature Committee Guidelines.
- In light of the heavy agenda at this year's Conference, the Conference Literature Committee suggested that delegates, when submitting Conference agenda items, have them, whenever possible, brought to area assemblies for broader exposure prior to their submission.

POLICY/ADMISSIONS

- The committee decided that formation of a standing Conference Committee on A.A.W.S. is unnecessary.
- The committee reviewed Conference policy as it relates to restricted or confidential matters, and agreed that restrictions apply only to legal matters that are pending, and to literature/ audiovisual projects that are works in progress.
- The committee considered suggestions both to create a review panel to edit Conference recommendations, and to implement new procedures for calling the question and tabling motions, and agreed that the present procedures are adequate.
- The committee suggested that the trustees' Committee on the Conference examine current smoking/nonsmoking arrangements at the Conference.

PUBLIC INFORMATION

- The committee considered the request from an area assembly to change the method for selecting groups to participate in the Membership Survey and decided that the proposed change would not result in a random sampling.
- The committee regretted that time constraints prevented a full discussion on the Public Information Workbook. The committee requests the trustees' Public Information Committee to begin work on updating the text for review by 1994 Conference Public Information Committee.

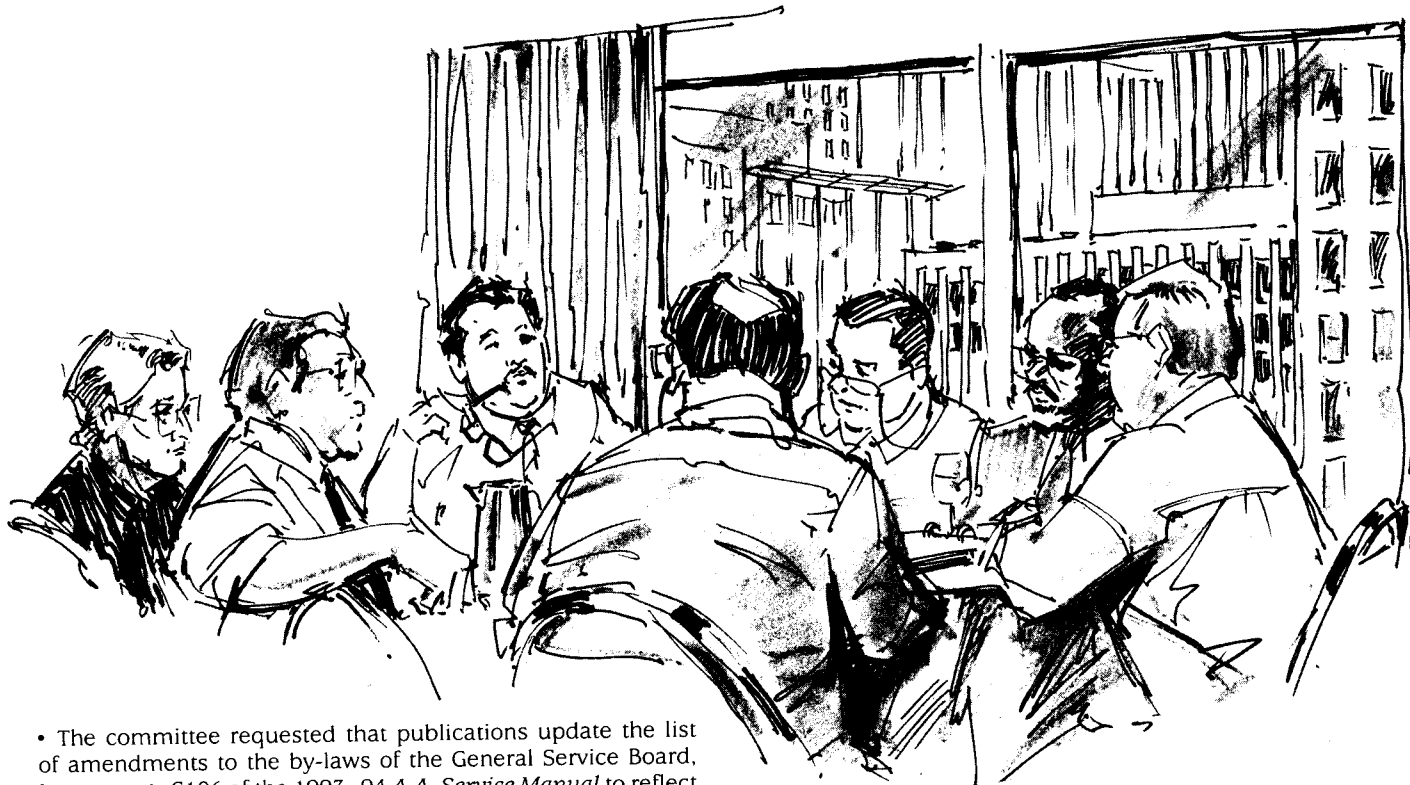
- The committee also requests that the trustees' Public Information Committee look into a simpler, more concise and less expensive format and bring their suggestions to the 1994 Conference Public Information Committee.
- It was suggested that the 1994 Conference Agenda Committee consider "Anonymity—Our Spiritual Foundation" as the theme for the 1995 General Service Conference.

Committee recommendations *not adopted* by the Conference:

- That distribution of any "A.A. Membership Survey" information be limited to the 1992 pamphlet, poster and one-way display.
- That there be a moratorium on any A.A. Membership Survey until the trustees' Public Information Committee's report is forwarded, no later than February 15, 1996, to the 1996 Conference Public Information Committee for consideration.

REPORT AND CHARTER

- The committee considered a report from the trustees' Literature Committee, written in response to the 1992 Conference Advisory Action to provide material on Service Sponsorship for possible inclusion in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee voted to send the material back to the trustees' Literature Committee with a request for them to consider adding the material to the Sponsorship pamphlet or as a service piece.
- The committee considered a proposal to delete a passage from the next-to-the-last paragraph that accompanies Concept XI, page 60 of *The A.A. Service Manual*, and decided that the committee did not want to rewrite Bill's essay.
- The committee considered a request to adopt the long form of the Traditions as the by-laws of the Conference, and decided that the Conference was adequately guided by the Conference Charter.
- The committee considered a request that wording, from Advisory Action No. 52 of the 1977 Conference, that "a delegate not be eligible as a trustee candidate until one year after his or her last Conference" be added to Chapter 9 of *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee voted to instruct Publications at the General Service Office to add that language to the section on qualifications of A.A. trustees in *The A.A. Service Manual*.
- The committee considered a request to label the descriptions on the contents page of the Concepts section of *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee directed Publications at G.S.O. to change the heading from "Contents" to "The Twelve Concepts (Short Form)."
- The committee considered a suggestion that trustee committee members be identified by position (trustee, director, appointed committee member, etc.) in *The Final Conference Report*. The committee voted to ask Publications to identify appointed committee members by asterisks in future *Final Conference Reports*.
- The committee considered a request to reconsider a 1988 Advisory Action that *The Final Conference Report* be sent to all G.S.R.s, and decided to continue distributing the report in the same manner, asking each delegate to be responsible for ordering only the appropriate number which would be used in his or her area.
- The committee requested that the General Service Office find a way to accent the names of towns in the group directories so they stand out from the group names within that town.



- The committee requested that publications update the list of amendments to the by-laws of the General Service Board, Inc. on page S106 of the 1993–94 A.A. *Service Manual* to reflect all amendments that have been made.

- The committee reviewed the page proofs of the Early Bird edition of *Box 4-5-9*. They also agreed on a two-week return deadline when they receive the uncorrected page proofs of the *Final Conference Report* in late May and *The A.A. Service Manual* revisions in the summer.

- The committee considered a request to reaffirm the 1962 Conference vote that unanimously accepted Bill's manuscript on "Twelve Concepts for World Service." The committee agreed the manuscript was well accepted in the Fellowship and did not need to be reaffirmed.

- The committee considered a request to include "Guidelines for Hiring the General Manager, G.S.O." in *The A.A. Service Manual*. The committee decided the hiring of the general manager was an employment, not a service, matter; that guidelines were readily available upon request from G.S.O., and did not need to be in *The A.A. Service Manual*.

- The committee considered a request to review, revise or expand material on the page in *The A.A. Service Manual* on the Past Delegate. The committee decided the section was adequate and no change was needed at this time.

- The committee considered a proposal to change the first paragraph of Chapter V, "The Delegate" in *The A.A. Service Manual* and voted not to make any change at this time.

- The committee considered a request that contributions of individual groups be deleted from the Canadian Directory. The committee voted for no change, as they felt the U.S. and Canadian Directories should be consistent with a 1977 Conference Advisory Action on the matter of individual group contributions being listed.

- The committee considered a request for guidelines for publication of *The Final Conference Report*, and decided that adequate guidelines were in place.

- The committee considered a proposal to add brief biographies of nontrustee corporate directors in *The Final Conference Report*. The committee saw no need at this time for additional biographies.

- The committee declined to consider a proposed change in the "Structure of the Fellowship" chart on page S23 of the 1993–94 A.A. *Service Manual*, and requested the General Service Office staff prepare a revised chart for consideration by the Report and Charter Committee at the 1994 General Service Conference.

TREATMENT FACILITIES

- The committee felt that the newly revised Treatment Facilities Workbook was clear and needed no revisions at this time. It was also felt that the 1½" three-ring binder is the most useful format for the Workbook.

- The committee discussed how the changes and cutbacks in treatment facilities services affected the work of A.A. in their areas. Most felt there were little or no changes as yet, but it would present a challenge in the future. One important thing we could do to prepare ourselves is to brush up on how to make a Twelfth Step call on a wet drunk.

- The committee discussed how A.A. might enhance cooperation with outpatient programs. Most areas maintain contact with counselors and administrators of outpatient programs, to keep them apprised of our services and availability for Twelfth Step work and also to keep abreast of new personnel.

Another aspect is to make the groups more aware of the importance of understanding and accepting prospective newcomers from the treatment facilities, even though some may have a strong allegiance to their treatment facility and/or be dually addicted and not confine their remarks to our primary

purpose. If the groups aren't prepared to welcome them unconditionally, they may not return. Sponsorship is important in helping to smooth the way.

- After considering how A.A. treatment facilities work might be expanded to include shelters and other residential facilities, the committee felt that in their areas all facilities that needed a meeting had one, whether under the auspices of the treatment facilities committee or another service committee. Further, if the meetings didn't flourish, A.A. volunteers could take people from the facility to local meetings, if permissible.

- In discussing ways that treatment facilities committees could keep members aware of the usefulness of A.A. tools, i.e., the Treatment Facilities Workbook, films, literature and the A.A. Grapevine, in their service work, it was generally felt that sponsoring new committee members and keeping them up-to-date on new things was vital. Some said they hold workshops at meetings, conferences and assemblies. If committee chairpersons are thoroughly familiar with the service material, they are better able to share with others. It was suggested that articles on how to effectively utilize A.A. tools be shared in the "Treatment Facilities Newsletter." While it is true that many A.A. groups aren't familiar with the films, service committees find them invaluable for presentations and an excellent introduction to discussion.

Treatment facilities workshops may include professional administrators and staff. Open informational exchange can serve to strengthen communications among us.

It was suggested that all service committees stay current on the activities and materials of other committees.

TRUSTEES

- The committee reviewed the resumes of candidates for East Central and Southeast regional trustees and resumes of candidates for trustee-at-large/U.S. and unanimously approved all candidates as eligible for election during the April 1993 General Service Conference.

- The committee discussed a request from an area delegate that the position of chairperson of the General Service Board not be restricted to a Class A trustee (page S109–110, 1992–1993 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*). The committee suggested that the position of chairperson of the General Service Board not be restricted to a Class A trustee, and that the trustees' Nominating Committee look at the procedure necessary to implement this and report back to the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee reviewed trustees' Nominating Committee Procedure No. 6—"Procedures for Election of Class A Trustees"—to find ways for the Conference Committee on Trustees to become more involved in the process (pages S114–115, 1992–93 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*). The committee suggested that item #6 of Nominating Procedure No. 6 be amended to read: "After approval by the Board of Trustees, the applicant's name is presented to the Conference Committee on Trustees and to the General Service Conference for disapproval, if any." (This amended wording is to be added to the next edition of *The A.A. Service Manual*.)

- The committee discussed the development of guidelines for forming new regions and referred this to the trustees' Nominating Committee for further study. The Conference Committee on Trustees requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee report back on this subject and that it be placed on the

agenda of the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees.

- The committee reviewed and discussed brief biographies of Class A trustees, as shown in *Final Conference Reports* from 1982–1992, with regard to balanced trusteeship (Concept VI, page 26, 1992–93 edition of *The A.A. Service Manual* combined with *Twelve Concepts for World Service*). The committee discussed their thoughts on balanced trusteeship for Class A trustees and suggested that—when considering applicants for the upcoming Class A trustee vacancies in 1994 and 1995—the trustees' Nominating Committee look at "friends of A.A." with spiritual and corporate backgrounds.

- The committee discussed and reviewed whether or not to add "four years' area committee experience" to the requirements for applicants for appointed committee member and nontrustee director vacancies. The committee strongly suggested that, when appointed committee member and nontrustee director vacancies occur, experience in the A.A. service structure be considered.

- The committee reviewed and discussed its Composition, Scope and Procedure and whether or not to add any information to it. The committee suggested adding nontrustee directors and appointed committee members to the "Scope" section of its Composition, Scope and Procedure.

- The committee referred to the trustees' Nominating Committee, for further study, the agenda item about deciding the method of Conference approval of trustees' slate, officers of General Service Board and directors of corporate boards. The committee requested that the trustees' Nominating Committee report back to the committee on this subject and that it be placed on the agenda of the 1994 Conference Committee on Trustees.

Strong suggestion of the Conference (recommendation where the vote was less than $\frac{2}{3}$, but more than $\frac{1}{2}$ in favor):

- Due to the importance the committee places on the principle of rotation and—in order to apply this principle to all levels of service—the committee recommended that no trustee should serve as chairperson of the same trustees' committee for more than two years during his/her term of service on the General Service Board.

Committee recommendation *not adopted* by the Conference:

- That appointed committee members and nontrustee directors be subject to the same rule as delegates in the one-year rotation policy currently in practice, and that this one-year rotation policy continue.

The Way We Were

O.B. Culley, delegate from Alaska, sober 35 years, remembers when G.S.O. general manager George Dorsey was flopping around drunk in Los Angeles A.A. meetings and had to be bailed out of jail a few times. That was over 30 years ago.

Twenty-four years ago, Gay Walters was sleeping on a grate not far from the hotel. Now he is the delegate from Utah.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.

Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

COMBINED STATEMENTS OF INCOME, EXPENSES AND CHANGES IN FUND BALANCES

Years Ended December 31, 1992 and 1991

	General Service Board of A. A.			A. A. World Services, Inc.	A. A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1992	Combined 1991
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
INCOME FROM LITERATURE							
Gross Sales				\$10,218,505	\$2,062,893	\$12,281,398	\$12,864,634
Less: Discounts				<u>413,891</u>	<u>41,970</u>	<u>455,861</u>	<u>465,483</u>
Net Sales				9,804,614	2,020,923	11,825,537	12,399,151
Cost of Literature Distributed							
Printing				(3,171,753)	(359,303)	(3,531,056)	(3,882,030)
Royalties on books				<u>(1,007,032)</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>(1,007,032)</u>	<u>(1,009,225)</u>
Gross Profit from Literature				5,625,829	1,661,620	7,287,449	7,507,896
CONTRIBUTIONS — A. A. groups and members	\$4,131,124			—	—	4,131,124	4,153,572
Investment Income	<u>6,145</u>	<u>\$ 474,276</u>		<u>10,305</u>	<u>89,147</u>	<u>579,873</u>	<u>690,873</u>
Total Income	<u>4,137,269</u>	<u>474,276</u>		<u>5,636,134</u>	<u>1,750,767</u>	<u>11,998,446</u>	<u>12,352,341</u>
EXPENSES							
Office Expenses (Schedule A-1)	4,047,389			3,567,822	1,464,929	9,080,140	9,146,877
Relocation construction and duplicate rent (includes expenditures on capital projects: 1992 — \$1,743,841; 1991 — \$548,116— see contra below)	<u>2,204,930</u>			<u>—</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>2,204,930</u>	<u>1,146,287</u>
Other Expenses (Schedule A-2)	<u>821,842</u>			<u>532,472</u>	<u>169,836</u>	<u>1,524,150</u>	<u>1,841,527</u>
Total Expenses	<u>7,074,161</u>			<u>4,100,294</u>	<u>1,634,765</u>	<u>12,809,220</u>	<u>12,134,691</u>
Excess of Income (Expense) for Year	(2,936,892)	474,276		1,535,840	116,002	(810,774)	217,650
Fund Balances							
Balance, January 1	57,013	7,315,141	\$ 859,369	2,512,463	569,775	<u>11,313,761</u>	<u>10,802,742</u>
						10,502,987	11,020,392
Increase—expenditures on capital projects (see contra above)			<u>1,743,841</u>			<u>1,743,841</u>	<u>548,116</u>
			<u>2,603,210</u>			<u>12,246,828</u>	<u>11,568,508</u>
Decrease—depreciation on capital projects			<u>(396,653)</u>			<u>(396,653)</u>	<u>(254,747)</u>
			<u>2,206,557</u>			<u>11,850,175</u>	<u>11,313,761</u>
Intercompany donations	<u>2,936,892</u>	<u>(1,064,995)</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>(1,735,697)</u>	<u>(136,200)</u>	<u>—</u>	<u>—</u>
Balance, December 31	<u>57,013</u>	<u>6,724,422</u>	<u>2,206,557</u>	<u>2,312,606</u>	<u>549,577</u>	<u>11,850,175</u>	<u>11,313,761</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

Years Ended December 31, 1992 and 1991

COMBINED OFFICE EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-1

	1992	1991
Salaries	\$4,220,967	\$4,115,291
Employee benefits, including pension plan	1,262,581	1,114,497
Total Labor Costs	5,483,548	5,229,788
Postage express	1,232,697	1,227,348
Warehousing and packing	358,594	440,871
Stationery and office supplies	124,081	120,088
Rent and electricity	645,867	898,884
Telephone	100,165	76,049
<i>Box 4-5-9</i>	175,224	197,775
A.A. Directories	49,017	51,278
Other service materials	297,664	331,156
Writers' fees	199,752	137,855
Office equipment	17,757	16,436
Insurance	30,056	23,564
Office services and expenses	283,914	312,793
Maintenance and repairs	36,677	21,251
Staff and committee meetings	45,127	61,741
	<u>9,080,140</u>	<u>9,146,877</u>
BY ENTITY:		
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund	\$4,047,389	\$4,094,133
A.A. World Services, Inc.	3,567,822	3,589,408
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	1,464,929	1,463,336
	<u>9,080,140</u>	<u>9,146,877</u>

COMBINED OTHER EXPENSES

SCHEDULE A-2

	1992	1991
Meetings, Forums and Committees		
General Service Conference	\$ 329,040	\$ 329,025
1992 World Service Meeting	35,324	—
Regional Forums	108,690	92,917
Other meetings and committees	288,588	272,072
	\$ 761,642	\$ 694,014
Data processing costs	142,408	189,764
Selling expense	157,850	158,018
Professional fees	245,994	305,230
Foreign literature assistance	100,338	62,386
Loss on bad debts	26,902	23,833
Severance benefits	—	272,248
Film projects	21,831	71,249
Travel and other	67,185	64,785
	<u>1,524,150</u>	<u>1,841,527</u>
BY ENTITY:		
The General Service Board of A.A.—General Fund	\$ 821,842	\$ 951,870
A.A. World Services, Inc.	532,472	713,877
A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	169,836	175,780
	<u>1,524,150</u>	<u>1,841,527</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
Alcoholics Anonymous World Services, Inc. • Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.
COMBINED BALANCE SHEETS

Years Ended December 31, 1992 and 1991

	General Service Board of A.A.			A.A. World Services, Inc.	A.A. Grapevine, Inc.	Combined 1992	Combined 1991
	General Fund	Reserve Fund	Capital Projects Fund				
ASSETS							
Cash							
On deposit	\$ 322,942	\$ 890,591		\$ 652,765	\$ 178,046	\$ 2,044,344	\$ 3,726,476
Accounts and interest receivable	—	135,288		251,367	33,039	419,694	369,306
Deposits on relocation/ construction project	—	—	—	—	—	—	263,015
Intercompany balances	(422,250)	(1,255,459)		421,720	1,255,989	—	—
Inventories							
Books, pamphlets, etc.	—	—		1,334,960	148,098	1,483,058	1,666,393
Paper, pre-publication costs, etc.	—	—		74,771	40,761	115,532	305,537
Investments							
U.S. Treasury Notes, due 1993/2002, at cost (market value: 1992 — \$7,383,863; 1991 — \$6,458,353)	—	6,954,002		—	—	6,954,002	5,967,328
Fixed Assets							
Leasehold improvements, computer hardware and software (net of accumulated depreciation: 1992 — \$1,019,134; 1991 — \$2,639,742)	—	—	\$2,206,557	—	—	2,206,557	859,369
Deferred charges	163,321	—	—	98,392	46,973	308,686	256,392
Other Assets	—	—	—	20,751	—	20,751	39,451
Total Assets	<u>64,013</u>	<u>6,724,422</u>	<u>2,206,557</u>	<u>2,854,726</u>	<u>1,702,906</u>	<u>13,552,624</u>	<u>13,453,267</u>
LIABILITIES							
Accounts payable	\$ 2,000	\$ —	\$ —	\$ 249,389	\$ 57,412	\$ 308,801	\$ 510,880
Accrued royalties	—	—	—	228,893	—	228,893	221,484
Accrued severance benefits	—	—	—	—	—	—	160,467
Deferred income	5,000	—	—	63,838	1,095,917	1,164,755	1,246,675
Total Liabilities	7,000	—	—	542,120	1,153,329	1,702,449	2,139,506
Fund Balances (Exhibit A)	57,013	6,724,422	2,206,557	2,312,606	549,577	11,850,175	11,313,761
Total Liabilities and Fund Balances	<u>64,013</u>	<u>6,724,422</u>	<u>2,206,557</u>	<u>2,854,726</u>	<u>1,702,906</u>	<u>13,552,624</u>	<u>13,453,267</u>

The accompanying notes are an integral part of these financial statements.

Report of the Independent Auditor

AUDITOR'S OPINION

The Board of Trustees
The General Service Board of
Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc.
475 Riverside Drive
New York, New York 10115

February 24, 1993

Ladies and Gentlemen:

We have audited the accompanying combined balance sheets of THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC. and its wholly owned subsidiaries, ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC. and ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC., as of December 31, 1992 and 1991, and the related combined statements of income, expenses and changes in fund balances for the years then ended. These financial statements are the responsibility of the organization's management. Our responsibility is to express an opinion on these financial statements based on our audits.

We conducted our audits in accordance with generally accepted auditing standards. Those standards require that we plan and perform the audit to obtain reasonable assurance about whether the financial statements are free of material misstatement. An audit includes examining, on a test basis, evidence supporting the amounts and disclosures in the financial statements. An audit also includes assessing the accounting principles used and significant estimates made by management, as well as evaluating the overall financial statement presentation. We believe that our audits provide a reasonable basis for our opinion.

In our opinion, the financial statements referred to above present fairly, in all material respects, the combined financial position of the three corporations named above as of December 31, 1992 and 1991, and the combined results of their operations for the years then ended in conformity with generally accepted accounting principles.

Respectfully submitted,

Owen J. Flanagan and Company
Certified Public Accountants

**THE GENERAL SERVICE BOARD
OF ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS WORLD SERVICES, INC.
ALCOHOLICS ANONYMOUS GRAPEVINE, INC.
NOTES TO COMBINED FINANCIAL STATEMENTS
DECEMBER 31, 1992 AND 1991**

Note 1 Organization

The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous, Inc. is a not-for-profit corporation organized for the purpose of assisting in the formation of A.A. groups and coordinating the A.A. program of rehabilitating alcoholics throughout the world. In furtherance of that objective, the organization also publishes books, magazines, pamphlets and other material directly related to the A.A. program through two wholly owned not-for-profit corporations, A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc.

The activities of the General Service Board of A.A. itself are conducted in three separate funds, as follows:

The RESERVE FUND—established in 1954 for the purposes of accumulating a prudent operating reserve, which during 1977, was redefined by a special General Service Board Committee as the prior year's combined operating expenses of A.A. World Services, Inc., A.A. Grapevine, Inc. and the General Fund of the

A.A. General Service Board. That committee also recommended that all investment activities of the operating entities be consolidated into the Reserve Fund. That Advisory Action was approved by the Board of Trustees and since that time, all funds of the operating entities, in excess of those required for working capital, have been transferred to the Reserve Fund. Included in such transfers from A.A. Grapevine, Inc. have been amounts held as a deferred liability to subscribers, and, therefore, they are reflected as a liability of the Reserve Fund. Any withdrawals from the Reserve Fund must be specifically authorized by the Board of Trustees on recommendation of the Finance and Budgetary Committee.

The CAPITAL PROJECTS FUND—This fund was established in 1990, with retroactive effect to 1989, to account for the costs of leasehold improvements and computer hardware and software incurred under major capital projects; and also to record annual depreciation on such assets.

The GENERAL FUND—is comprised of those assets not included in any of the other funds and may be used for any purposes for which the corporation was formed. These purposes presently include activities related to communication and information services to A.A. groups and members, public information, cooperation with the professional community and various regional, national and international meetings, conferences and conventions.

Note 2 Accounting Policies

The corporations use the accrual method of accounting, where income is recorded in the period earned and expenses are recorded in the period incurred and to which they pertain. Contributions are recorded as income when the cash is received.

Intercompany balances and donations have been eliminated in the combined totals in the accompanying financial statements.

Inventories

Inventories held by A.A. World Services, Inc. and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. are recorded at cost under the first-in, first-out, "FIFO" method of accounting. Proper allowance has been made for slow-moving or damaged merchandise.

Literature distributed without charge is not accounted for separately, but is included in the cost of printing as a reduction of inventory.

Fixed Assets

From its inception, The General Service Board of Alcoholics Anonymous had consistently followed an accounting policy under which all costs of leasehold improvements and equipment were charged against income in the year incurred, rather than being capitalized. That policy was responsive to A.A. Traditions of avoiding the accumulation of unnecessary wealth or property.

In August 1987, the Financial Accounting Standards Board issued a Statement of Financial Accounting Standards No. 93 which requires all not-for-profit organizations to recognize the cost of using up long-lived tangible assets—depreciation—in general purpose financial statements. The original effective date for implementation was May 1988, but was later extended to years beginning in 1990.

In order to comply with that FASB Statement and be in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles, responsible officers of the General Service Board of A.A., with concurrence of the independent auditors, authorized the establishment of a separate Fund in which the cost of major capital projects involving leasehold improvements and computer system acquisitions would be capitalized and depreciation provided over the term of the applicable lease, or the useful life of the equip-

ment. The costs of such expenditures continues to be recorded as an expense in the General Fund, but the effect on the overall Fund Balance is adjusted through changes in the Fund Balance of the new "Capital Projects Fund."

The following table sets forth, by classification of assets, the depreciation lives, the provision for depreciation for the year ended December 31, 1992 and the accumulated reserves for depreciation at that date:

	<u>Life</u>	<u>Cost</u>	<u>Current Year</u>	<u>Reserve</u>
Leasehold improvements				
475 Riverside Drive	Terms of Leases	\$1,625,457	\$ 128,326	\$ 128,326
Furniture	8 Years	689,598	86,200	100,636
Computer—hardware	5 Years	638,965	127,793	601,542
—software	5 Years	<u>271,671</u>	<u>54,334</u>	<u>188,630</u>
		<u>3,225,691</u>	<u>396,653</u>	<u>1,019,134</u>

All depreciation is provided on the straight line basis.

Investments

Investments held by the Reserve Fund of the General Service Board of A.A. are carried at cost. No recognition is made in the accounts for any changes in aggregate market value above or below cost because all of the investments are U.S. Treasury Notes with short or medium terms that are normally held to maturity.

Note 3 Retirement Plan

The trustees of General Service Board adopted a defined benefit pension plan effective January 1, 1965 to provide retirement benefits to eligible employees of A.A. World Services and A.A. Grapevine, Inc. The plan has been amended from time to time to improve benefits and to comply with current statutory requirements.

The report of the plan's actuaries stated that as of January 1, 1992, the most recent valuation date to these financial statements for which information is available, the present value of accrued benefits under the plan was \$3,598,825, of which \$3,346,195 was vested. The market value of the assets of the trust fund at the same date was \$6,151,756. The assumed rate of return used in determining the actuarial value of vested plan benefits was 7.5%.

Pension expense has been consistently reported as the contribution made to actuarially fund plan benefits, plus the actuarial, investment and custody fees paid by A.A. World Services related to the operation of the plan. That method of accounting was in accordance with generally accepted accounting principles that had been in effect since the issuance of Accounting Principles Board Statement No. 8 in 1966.

Effective as of 1987, however, Financial Accounting Standards Board (FASB) Statement No. 87 introduced a new concept of "net periodic pension cost," in which pension cost would be accrued ratably over an employee's years of service based upon actuarial factors which would not necessarily be the same as those presently used in calculating the annual funding requirement. In addition, FASB No. 87 would require, on a deferred recognition basis, an employer to report an asset or liability on the organization's balance sheet depending upon whether the plan was considered to be over or under funded. It is clear from the above actuarial data that there is no unfunded liability in the A.A. Retirement Plan. Management still believes the annual funding requirement is a more relevant measure of pension expense, and that the cost of additional actuarial calculations is not warranted. The actuaries have stated that the difference would not be a material amount.

Prior to 1990, A.A. World Service had always paid the actua-

rial, investment and custody fees incurred by the plan. As of January 1, 1990, however, the A.A.W.S. Board elected to utilize the discretion granted under the plan provisions to direct such expenses to be paid by the plan. Accordingly, no such expenses are included in pension expense for 1992 and 1991.

Pension expense for 1992 and 1991 was \$288,980 and \$208,258, respectively.

In addition to providing pension benefits, the corporations provide health care benefits for retired employees, substantially all of whom become eligible if they reach normal retirement age while working for the corporations. Benefits are provided through health insurance contracts maintained by the corporations, 25% of the cost of which is reimbursed by the retirees.

The cost of providing health care benefits to retirees is recorded as the insurance premiums are expensed, and were estimated to be \$50,000 and \$46,000 for 1992 and 1991, respectively.

Note 4 Lease Commitments

At December 31, 1992, A.A. World Services, Inc. as fiscal agent for the General Service Office, was subject to the following non-cancellable leases (exclusive of future operating increases) in New York City:

\$347,275 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective July 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

\$132,994 yearly office rental lease at 475 Riverside Drive effective September 1, 1991 through September 30, 2001.

The minimum lease commitment at December 31, 1992 is \$4,202,000.

The rental expense for the years ended December 31, 1992 and 1991, were as follows:

	<u>1992</u>	<u>1991</u>
Total Rent Expense	<u>\$ 620,600</u>	<u>\$ 780,400</u>
Allocated to:		
A.A. World Services	\$ 296,600	\$ 362,000
General Service Board	221,600	265,900
A.A. Grapevine	<u>102,400</u>	<u>152,500</u>
	<u>620,600</u>	<u>780,400</u>

In addition to the rental expense shown above, a rent premium of \$476,700 incurred for a one year extension to March 31, 1992 of the lease for the organization's previous office at 470 Park Avenue South, as well as the entire rent of \$382,300 paid at 475 Riverside Drive prior to occupancy on that same date, have been borne by the General Service Board as part of the overall cost of the construction and relocation project.

In connection with the lease for 475 Riverside Drive, a real estate brokerage firm claimed a commission of \$240,000 and commenced legal action. A payment of \$107,500 was made in September 1992 in full settlement of that claim.

Note 5 Tax Status

The organizations are exempt from federal income taxes under section 501(c)(3) of the Internal Revenue Code. They are also exempt from the New York State Franchise Tax.

A.A.s know that the strongest Twelfth Step is the power of example. Last year, during a quarterly board meeting (which also meets at the Crowne Plaza) a waiter became interested in our unusual group, made some inquiries, was sent to a meeting, and is now sober.

Budget Highlights

1993 G.S.O. Budget

Income: The sales income budget of \$9,806,000 is approximately \$400,000 less than the 1992 budget and the 1992 actual sales. This reflects lower anticipated sales volume. Gross profit from literature is projected at \$5,285,000, approximately \$370,000 less than 1992 actual.

Contributions for 1993 have been anticipated at \$4,000,000. This represents approximately \$131,000 less than the 1992 actual amount and approximately \$179,000 less than the 1992 budget.

Total Operating Expenses for 1993 have been budgeted at \$9,064,000. This represents approximately a one percent decrease from the 1992 revised budget and approximately a one percent increase over the 1992 actual expenses.

Net Operating Income for 1993 is budgeted at \$231,700. There are no nonrecurring expenses expected for 1993. No draw-downs from the Reserve Fund have been anticipated in this budget.

1993 Grapevine Budget

INCOME

Magazine Income: Magazine income is budgeted at \$1,508,400, based on an average monthly circulation of 123,000. Less direct costs of \$558,870, this will give us a magazine gross profit of \$949,530 (62.9%), as compared to \$976,315 (63.6%) for year-end 1992.

Other Publishing Income: Income from special items is budgeted at \$534,400, which takes into account the current trend toward falling sales of special items, but also includes income from the forthcoming Home Group booklet. Gross profit on special items is budgeted at \$329,500 (61.7%), compared to \$296,950 (61.0%) at year-end 1992.

EXPENSES

Salaries: An overall increase of 3% is budgeted.

Office Expense: Budgeted lower than 1992 actuals because we will not incur one-time move-related expenses this year. Bank charges, which came as a surprise at the end of 1992, are included in this line and are budgeted at \$10,000.

Product Development: The budgeted \$14,500 (almost \$10,000 higher than the 1992 budget) covers development of a quarterly cassette of the magazine, a poster, redesign of the magazine format, and exploration of desktop publishing.

Selling Expense—Regular: Budgeted somewhat higher to cover more comprehensive mailings to subscribers and groups.

SUMMARY: For 1993, we have budgeted a net income of \$78,590, of which \$7,410 is a loss from operations and the rest is interest.

The General Service Office

1993 OPERATING BUDGET

	<u>1992 Actual</u>	<u>1993 Budget</u>
INCOME		
Sale of literature	\$10,218,500	\$9,806,200
Less: Discount	<u>(413,900)</u>	<u>(422,800)</u>
<u>Net Sales</u>	9,804,600	9,383,400
Less: Cost of products	<u>(3,171,800)</u>	<u>(3,143,500)</u>
Royalties	<u>(1,007,000)</u>	<u>(954,200)</u>
<u>Gross profit from literature</u>	5,625,800	5,285,700
Contributions	4,131,100	4,000,000
Interest income	<u>16,400</u>	<u>10,000</u>
<i>TOTAL G.S.O. INCOME</i>	<u><u>9,773,300</u></u>	<u><u>9,295,700</u></u>
EXPENSES		
Salaries	3,553,300	3,683,000
Payroll taxes	276,300	293,000
Insurance	582,800	655,500
Rent & electricity	532,000	475,000
Shipping & mailing	1,180,600	1,246,200
Box 4-5-9	175,200	187,900
Other service printing	297,700	300,000
World Directories	49,000	47,300
Writers' fees	199,800	44,500
Staff & board meetings	251,700	260,400
Stationery & supplies	99,400	123,000
Office equipment	9,000	10,000
Telephone & telegraph	90,100	87,000
Office service & expense	263,100	245,500
Selling expense	42,100	49,100
E.D.P. expenses	141,700	130,400
Pension/retirement expense	261,800	288,000
C.P.C. Committee	31,500	56,000
P.I. Committee	26,200	30,200
Professional fees (legal & audit)	224,200	150,000
Archives	8,500	13,400
Travel, bad debts & other	78,300	49,500
Regional Forums	108,700	91,400
Conference	329,000	361,900
Foreign literature assistance (net)	100,300	154,300
Film projects	21,800	16,000
Board sponsored int'l trips	<u>35,300</u>	<u>15,500</u>
<i>TOTAL OPERATING EXPENSES</i>	<u><u>8,969,400</u></u>	<u><u>9,064,000</u></u>
Net Operating Income	803,900	231,700
Less: Nonrecurring expenses	<u>2,204,900</u>	<u>0</u>
<i>NET INCOME</i>	<u><u>(1,401,000)</u></u>	<u><u>231,700</u></u>

The Alcoholics Anonymous Grapevine, Inc.

1993 BUDGET

1993 Budget

PAID CIRCULATION — AVERAGE		<u>123,000</u>
INCOME FROM MAGAZINE		
Subscription income	\$1,476,000	
Single copies and back issues	<u>32,400</u>	
<u>Total magazine income</u>		\$ 1,508,400
<u>Total direct costs</u>		<u>558,870</u>
GROSS PROFIT ON MAGAZINE		<u>949,530</u>
OTHER PUBLISHING INCOME	534,400	
<u>Total direct costs</u>	<u>204,900</u>	
GROSS PROFIT ON SPECIAL ITEMS		<u>329,500</u>
<u>TOTAL GROSS PROFIT</u>		<u>1,279,030</u>
COSTS AND EXPENSES		
EDITORIAL COSTS		
Salaries, including temporary help	234,160	
Payroll taxes and benefits	37,820	
Occupancy costs	50,500	
Office supplies and expenses	19,850	
Product development	<u>14,500</u>	
<u>Total Editorial</u>		356,830
CIRCULATION AND BUSINESS		
Salaries, including temporary help	448,900	
Payroll taxes and benefits	145,440	
Occupancy costs	50,500	
Office expense	31,820	
Subscriber services	17,000	
Selling expense — regular	119,300	
— GvR program	38,100	
Postage	<u>9,600</u>	
<u>Total Circulation and Business</u>		860,660
GENERAL AND ADMINISTRATIVE		
Consultant fees	4,000	
Insurance	7,350	
Professional fees	21,900	
Meetings and conferences	25,700	
Furniture and equipment	5,000	
Canadian exchange and other	<u>5,000</u>	
<u>Total General and Administrative</u>		<u>68,950</u>
TOTAL COSTS AND EXPENSES		<u>1,286,440</u>
INCOME (LOSS) FROM OPERATIONS		(7,410)
Add: Interest earned		<u>86,000</u>
NET INCOME (LOSS) FOR PERIOD		<u><u>78,590</u></u>

() denotes red figures

1992 Contributions From Groups — by Delegate Area

(in U.S. dollars)

AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA	AREA #	GENERAL SERVICE CONFERENCE AREA	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	TOTAL GROUP CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
1.	Ala./N.W. Fla.	409	220	53.7%	\$ 28,973.85	7,492	\$3.87		Pennsylvania						
2.	Alaska	235	99	42.1	10,316.83	3,393	3.04	59.	East	1,373	707	51.4	101,290.45	34,517	2.93
3.	Arizona	821	345	42.0	50,400.62	14,851	3.39	60.	West	722	387	53.6	37,422.77	10,627	3.52
4.	Arkansas	265	125	47.1	13,985.71	4,067	3.44	61.	Rhode Island	247	107	43.3	11,584.93	4,991	2.32
	California							62.	South Carolina	297	176	59.2	23,994.96	5,699	4.21
5.	Southern	1,948	826	42.4	103,079.89	76,965	1.34	63.	South Dakota	160	64	40.0	4,775.30	3,545	1.35
6.	N. Coastal	2,118	1,192	56.2	181,749.17	60,275	3.02	64.	Tennessee	479	263	54.9	35,090.41	8,986	3.91
7.	N. Interior	713	352	49.3	41,878.72	17,825	2.35		Texas						
8.	San Diego/Imp.	840	429	51.0	57,103.36	25,804	2.21	65.	Northeast	436	225	51.6	50,495.46	15,630	3.23
9.	Mid-South.	1,734	783	45.1	92,608.75	53,875	1.72	66.	Northwest	228	105	46.0	12,267.85	7,298	1.68
10.	Colorado	656	355	54.1	42,684.65	16,793	2.54	67.	Southeast	553	255	46.1	31,635.31	16,943	1.87
11.	Connecticut	1,345	624	46.3	75,254.99	31,338	2.40	68.	Southwest	501	209	41.7	35,276.63	11,011	3.20
12.	Delaware	168	116	69.0	21,965.98	2,822	7.78	69.	Utah	277	167	60.2	20,099.99	5,010	4.01
13.	D.C.	449	261	58.1	54,622.44	14,475	3.77	70.	Vermont	235	102	43.4	11,978.95	4,366	2.74
	Florida							71.	Virginia	1,096	626	57.1	87,540.37	21,525	4.07
14.	North	639	367	57.4	53,840.89	12,856	4.19	72.	Washington	1,341	671	50.0	106,647.64	26,484	4.03
15.	South/							73.	West Virginia	295	157	53.2	12,149.85	3,401	3.57
	Bahamas/V.I.	1,541	783	50.8	115,241.12	28,246	4.08		Wisconsin						
16.	Georgia	678	468	69.0	64,442.08	16,116	4.00	74.	N. Wis./Upper						
17.	Hawaii	261	151	57.8	35,603.09	5,483	6.49		Pen. Mich.	617	285	46.1	25,778.46	10,100	2.55
18.	Idaho	198	102	51.5	9,057.87	2,843	3.19	75.	South	928	466	50.2	46,611.57	17,502	2.66
	Illinois							76.	Wyoming	128	71	55.4	6,578.23	2,154	3.05
19.	Chicago	1,124	396	35.2	50,344.38	26,290	1.91	77.	Puerto Rico	119	78	65.5	4,188.75	1,500	2.79
20.	North	983	438	44.5	39,849.84	20,220	1.97	78.	Alberta/N.W.T.	597	265	44.3	34,146.83	7,963	4.29
21.	South	441	182	41.2	24,764.86	7,695	3.22	79.	B.C./Yukon	735	400	54.4	58,440.62	12,436	4.70
	Indiana							80.	Manitoba	161	66	40.9	7,917.46	3,992	1.98
22.	North	643	298	46.3	33,203.96	10,532	3.15	81.	N.B./P.E.I.	218	94	43.1	8,068.86	3,424	2.36
23.	South	489	269	55.0	30,241.04	9,980	3.03	82.	N.S./Nfld./Lab.	283	143	50.5	13,841.11	3,543	3.91
24.	Iowa	679	332	48.8	39,617.29	13,335	2.97		Ontario						
25.	Kansas	387	238	61.4	24,620.86	9,891	2.49	83.	East	603	289	47.9	52,214.32	14,321	3.65
26.	Kentucky	613	365	59.5	48,461.34	10,451	4.64	84.	Northeast	185	85	45.9	14,545.04	2,475	5.88
27.	Louisiana	530	238	44.9	27,941.00	10,022	2.79	85.	Northwest	90	30	33.3	5,216.54	1,368	3.81
28.	Maine	497	193	38.8	18,058.99	9,080	1.99	86.	West	504	211	41.8	40,539.46	9,666	4.19
29.	Maryland	826	439	53.1	55,706.72	12,489	4.46		Quebec						
	Massachusetts							87.	Southwest	582	379	65.2 ①	38,435.34	15,219	2.53
30.	East	1,563	632	40.4	76,113.76	53,610	1.42	88.	Southeast	248	198	79.9 ①	22,054.50	3,690	5.98
31.	West	223	125	56.0	15,064.33	5,178	2.91	89.	Northeast	376	357	95.0 ①	16,431.48	7,294	2.25
	Michigan							90.	Northwest	398	368	92.5 ①	46,579.39	6,984	6.67
32.	Central	551	260	47.1	38,633.06	12,452	3.10	91.	Saskatchewan	338	184	54.4	19,665.78	4,610	4.25
33.	Southeast	605	283	46.7	55,959.90	15,342	3.65		Total U.S./						
34.	West	429	228	53.1	35,350.98	9,013	3.92		Canada	55,600	27,623	49.7	\$3,600,590.77 ^②	1,230,381	2.93
	Minnesota								Individual, in-memoriam, & special meetings				200,637.29		
35.	North	532	280	52.6	19,218.42	8,203	2.34		Specials				290,545.61		
36.	South	1,017	458	45.0	48,490.98	24,377	1.99		Total for U.S. & Canada				\$4,091,773.67		
37.	Mississippi	237	121	51.0	10,684.99	3,671	2.91		FOREIGN AND OTHER						
	Missouri								Birds of a Feather				250.00		
38.	East	576	316	54.8	44,857.64	9,077	4.94		Correctional facility groups				431.52		
39.	West	223	127	56.9	16,125.60	6,284	2.57		Foreign				26,478.26		
40.	Montana	349	154	44.1	15,787.46	5,004	3.15		International Lawyers in A.A.				6,010.00		
41.	Nebraska	683	366	53.5	52,246.18	14,691	3.56		International Young People in A.A.				5,000.00		
42.	Nevada	367	169	46.0	16,239.56	7,255	2.24		Internationalists				30.00		
43.	New Hampshire	525	208	39.6	18,696.23	8,090	2.31		Loners				565.50		
	New Jersey								Treatment facility meetings				485.29		
44.	North	1,279	547	42.7	76,399.52	31,271	2.44		World Hello				100.00		
45.	South	404	244	60.3	38,152.96	7,748	4.92		Grand Total				\$4,131,124.24		
46.	New Mexico	311	156	50.1	15,985.01	5,028	3.18								
	New York														
47.	Central	699	302	43.2	45,675.84	11,232	4.07								
48.	H./M./B.	748	322	43.0	26,962.39	10,711	2.52								
49.	Southeast	1,781	839	47.1	162,334.27	52,165	3.11								
50.	West	299	146	48.8	14,149.42	4,482	3.16								
51.	N. Carolina	798	479	60.0	75,099.95	12,528	5.99								
52.	North Dakota	184	60	32.6	3,768.81	3,087	1.22								
	Ohio														
53.	Cent. & S.E.	582	197	33.8	15,617.96	7,944	1.97								
54.	Northeast	1,150	381	33.1	43,786.45	24,058	1.82								
55.	N.W. Ohio/														
	S.E. Mich.	268	135	50.3	15,266.25	3,695	4.13								
56.	S.W. Ohio	511	266	52.0	33,382.48	10,419	3.20								
57.	Oklahoma	391	257	65.7	29,716.72	6,560	4.53								
58.	Oregon	735	389	52.9	51,758.75	13,428	3.85								

CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON — 1992-1991

(in U.S. dollars)

	#GPS. RE-PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER-SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. & Canada 1992	55,600	27,623 ^①	49.7% ^①	\$3,600,590.77 ^②	1,230,381	\$2.93
U.S. & Canada 1991	53,920	27,798 ^①	51.6 ^①	3,670,001.45 ^②	1,170,454	3.14
Increase (Decrease)	1,680	(175)	(1.9%)	\$ (69,410.68)	59,927	\$(.21)

① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

② Group contributions reported on this schedule *do not* include contributions received as specials, individual, in-memoriam, and special meetings.

1992 Total Contributions — by State / Province

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U.S.	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alabama	304	162	53.3%	\$ 23,690.43	5,502	\$4.31
Alaska	235	99	42.1	11,933.00	3,393	3.52
Arizona	804	345	42.9	58,286.07	14,632	3.98
Arkansas	266	125	46.9	15,097.71	4,083	3.70
California	7,376	3,613	49.0	538,861.53	237,798	2.27
Colorado	656	355	54.1	46,667.12	16,793	2.78
Connecticut	1,361	638	46.8	96,757.92	31,724	3.05
Delaware	167	116	69.4	22,231.98	2,813	7.90
District of Columbia	193	93	48.1	17,975.29	6,224	2.89
Florida	2,271	1,203	52.9	237,019.24	42,831	5.53
Georgia	677	467	68.9	66,680.52	16,105	4.14
Hawaii	261	151	57.8	42,773.87	5,483	7.80
Idaho	263	134	50.9	13,100.25	3,629	3.61
Illinois	2,548	1,017	39.9	141,697.87	54,043	2.62
Indiana	1,167	587	50.2	77,302.47	21,006	3.68
Iowa	678	331	48.8	45,446.92	13,329	3.41
Kansas	388	239	61.5	29,730.10	9,894	3.00
Kentucky	579	345	59.5	50,667.83	10,005	5.06
Louisiana	530	238	44.9	32,396.09	10,022	3.23
Maine	484	186	38.4	19,446.94	8,944	2.17
Maryland	1,071	598	55.8	96,206.70	20,541	4.68
Massachusetts	1,807	756	41.8	96,028.10	58,799	1.63
Michigan	1,771	847	47.8	146,234.05	39,758	3.68
Minnesota	1,544	734	47.5	72,055.41	32,176	2.24
Mississippi	237	121	51.1	11,396.06	3,671	3.10
Missouri	798	443	55.5	68,407.30	15,417	4.44
Montana	352	155	44.0	17,071.90	5,047	3.38
Nebraska	683	366	53.5	54,767.39	14,691	3.73
Nevada	327	153	46.7	18,226.03	6,206	2.94
New Hampshire	522	206	39.4	22,888.92	8,017	2.86
New Jersey	1,685	791	46.9	124,500.76	39,024	3.19
New Mexico	311	156	50.1	18,247.26	5,028	3.63
New York	3,548	1,608	45.3	286,371.18	78,410	3.65
North Carolina	799	480	60.0	80,401.82	12,544	6.41
North Dakota	184	60	32.6	5,005.81	3,087	1.62
Ohio	2,483	972	39.1	113,645.60	45,463	2.50
Oklahoma	392	258	65.8	32,389.32	6,577	4.92
Oregon	738	389	52.7	55,247.03	13,431	4.11
Pennsylvania	2,125	1,101	51.8	153,709.29	45,560	3.37
Rhode Island	246	107	43.4	11,853.92	4,991	2.38
South Carolina	297	176	59.2	25,098.21	5,699	4.40
South Dakota	160	64	40.0	10,001.93	3,545	2.82
Tennessee	476	259	54.4	42,828.51	8,977	4.77
Texas	1,718	793	46.1	148,357.77	50,990	2.91
Utah	277	167	60.2	21,046.99	5,010	4.20
Vermont	236	102	43.2	14,085.80	4,399	3.20
Virginia	1,106	636	57.5	100,999.44	21,688	4.66
Washington	1,261	631	50.0	112,874.25	25,522	4.42
West Virginia	285	151	52.9	13,224.47	3,297	4.01
Wisconsin	1,402	693	49.4	73,269.41	25,376	2.89
Wyoming	130	72	55.3	6,915.09	2,186	3.16
Commonwealth of Puerto Rico	119	78	65.5	4,487.53	1,500	2.99
Bahama Islands	11	1	9.1	100.00	88	1.14
Virgin Islands of U.S.	16	5	31.2	1,095.03	427	2.56
TOTAL for U.S.	50,325	24,573	48.8%	\$3,646,801.43	1,135,395	\$3.21

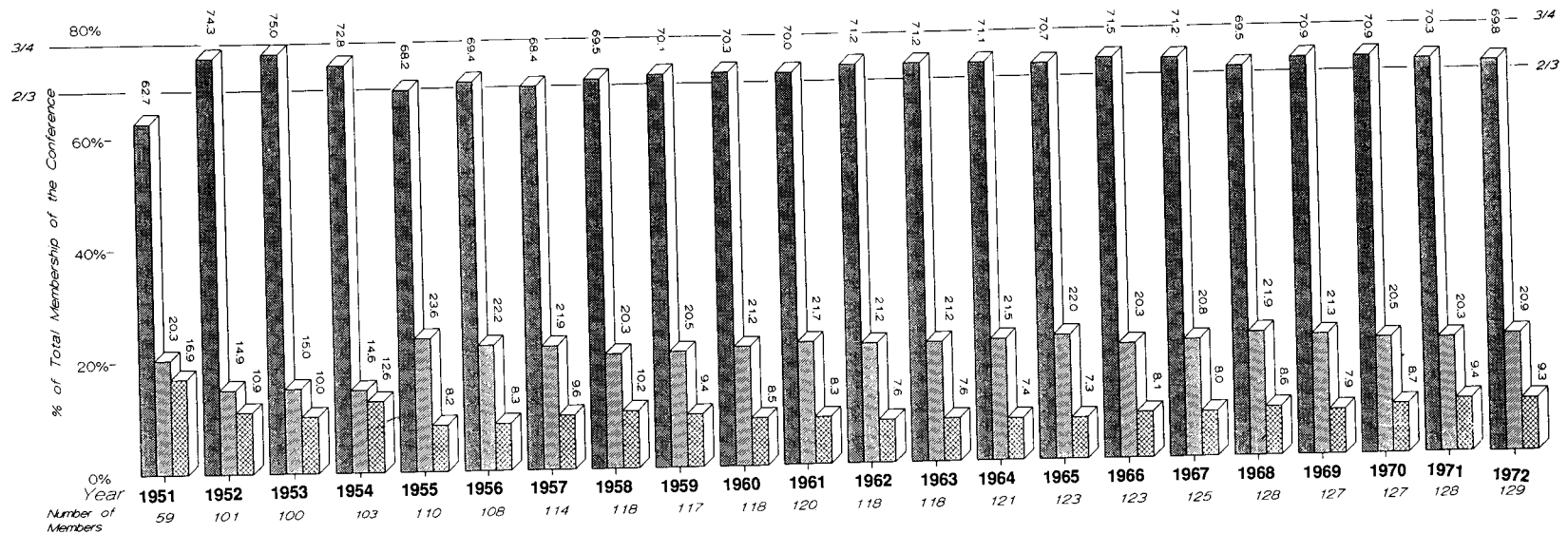
① Reflects not only those groups that contributed directly to G.S.O., but also those groups that contributed to G.S.O. through their Conference areas (per lists of percentages submitted by areas).

CANADA (stated in Canadian dollars)	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
Alberta	516	238	46.1%	44,137.67\$	7,125	6.19\$
Atlantic Provinces						
New Brunswick	168	75	44.6	9,964.90	2,375	4.20
Newfoundland	97	52	53.6	8,424.44	917	9.19
Nova Scotia	184	91	49.4	9,564.98	2,583	3.70
Prince Edward Island	71	28	39.4	3,353.78	1,345	2.49
Labrador	3	0	0.0	0.00	66	0
British Columbia	771	418	54.2	91,561.19	12,798	7.15
Manitoba	160	66	41.2	9,908.98	3,990	2.46
N.W. Territories	37	8	21.6	753.16	361	2.09
Ontario	1,327	594	44.7	173,425.68	27,150	6.39
Quebec	1,586	1,289	81.2 ①	156,660.35	31,450	4.98
Saskatchewan	340	184	54.1	29,839.37	4,630	6.44
Yukon Territory	15	7	46.6	1,470.93	196	7.50
TOTAL for CANADA (Canadian dollars)	5,275	3,050 ①	57.8% ①	538,965.43\$	94,986	5.67\$ ①
(converted to U.S. dollars \$						\$4.68)
TOTAL for U.S. (U.S. and CANADA dollars)	55,600	27,623 ①	49.7% ①	\$4,091,473.67	1,230,381	\$3.33 ①
FOREIGN AND OTHER						
Birds of a Feather				250.00		
Correctional facility groups				431.52		
Foreign				26,778.26		
International Doctors in A.A.				0.00		
International Lawyers in A.A.				6,010.00		
International Young People in A.A.				5,000.00		
Internationalists				30.00		
Loners				565.50		
Treatment facility meetings				485.29		
World Hello				100.00		
GRAND TOTAL				\$4,131,124.24		

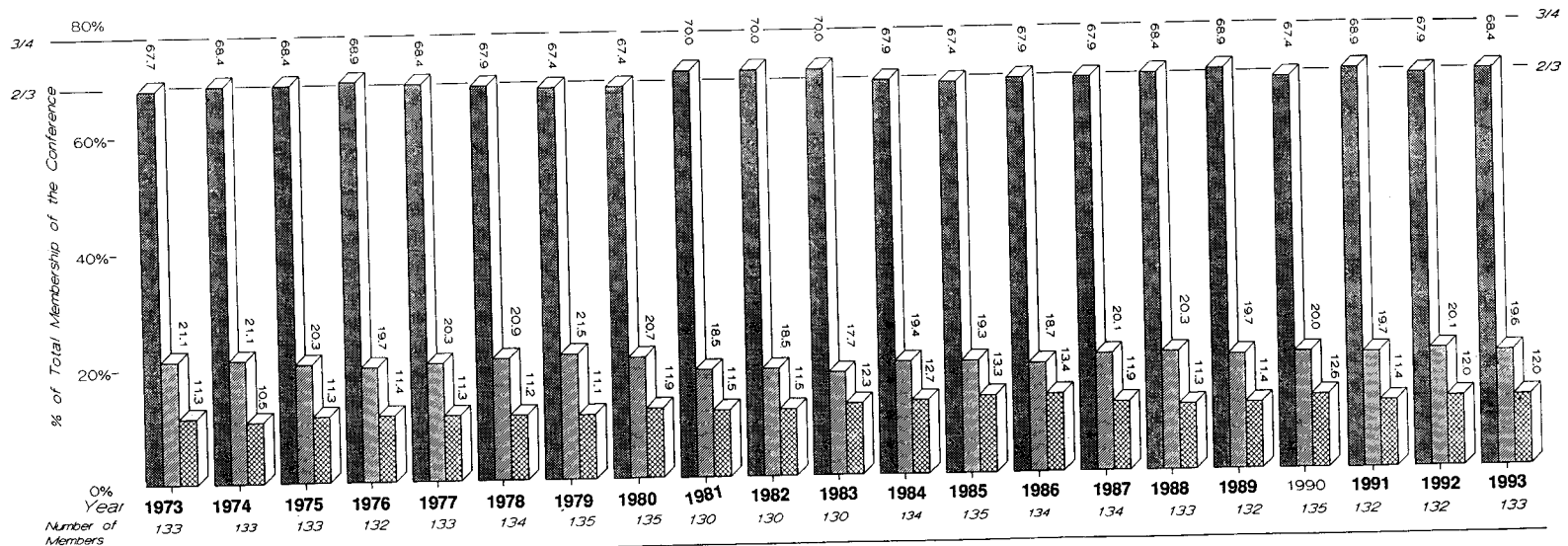
CONTRIBUTION COMPARISON 1992-1991 (IN U.S. DOLLARS)

	#GPS. RE- PORTED	#GPS. CONTRIB.	% OF GPS. CONTRIB.	AMOUNT OF CONTRIB.	MEMBER- SHIP	CONTRIB. PER CAPITA
U.S. 1992	50,325	24,573	48.8%	\$3,646,801.43	1,135,395	\$3.21
U.S. 1991	48,747	24,791	50.9	3,624,650.84	1,079,719	3.36
Increase (Decrease)	1,578	(218)	(2.1%)	\$ 22,150.59	55,676	\$(.15)
Canada 1992	5,275	3,050 ①	57.8% ①	\$ 444,672.24	94,986	\$4.68 ①
Canada 1991	5,173	3,007 ①	58.1 ①	492,192.39	90,735	5.42 ①
Increase (Decrease)	102	43	(0.3%)	\$ (47,520.15)	4,251	\$(.74)
U.S. and Canada 1992	55,600	27,623 ①	49.7% ①	\$4,091,473.67	1,230,381	\$3.33 ①
U.S. and Canada 1991	53,920	27,798 ①	51.6 ①	4,116,843.23	1,170,454	3.52 ①
Increase (Decrease)	1,680	(175)	(10.4%)	\$ (25,369.56)	59,927	\$(.19)

CONFERENCE MEMBERSHIP



1951-1993



Percentage of Delegates, Boards, Staffs

Delegates Boards Staffs

1993 Conference Committees

Conference Agenda

George Bellefeuille
¹Dick Brummel
 Esther Hall
 Mark Langsam
 Sam Reams
 George Rollins
 Gay Walters
²Dian Wright

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

Finance

¹Tom Barlow
 Denise Bell
²O.B. Culley
 Chuck Hickson
 Joan Johnson
 Pete Litano
 Jonathan Mason
 John Sweeney

Secretary: Donald Meurer

Literature

¹Paul Cleary
 Russell Cook
 Cathy Ferrante
²Bob Halvorson
 Bert Kluthe
 Julie Newton
 Wayne Reed
 Elaine Strome
 Hugh Vaughan

Secretary: John Grant

Report and Charter

Caroline Bradley
 Dick Clark
 Tom Dougherty
 Burke Dykes
 Anne Mabery
 Hugo McKissic
 Randy Sellers
¹Joe Sostarich

Secretary: Richard Bush

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Susan Campbell
 Mary Ellen Davis
 Michel Girard
 Gary Kluksdahl
²Melvin Larkin
 Jack Layden
¹Maryjane Roy
 John Verdon

Secretary: Valerie O'Neill

Grapevine

Charlie Burns
¹Bill Cross
 Jack Griffith
 Shaaron Johnson
 Marvin Rumery
 Larry Schlosser
²Ted Stoa
 Don Swallow

Secretary: Ann Warner

Policy/Admissions

¹Jim Clough
²John Curtin
 Harold Dredhart
 Janice French
 Vivien Gerten
 Michael O'Connor
 Cena Robbins
 Davis Tolleson

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Treatment Facilities

Regis Chenard
 Lois Concelman
¹Harold Douse
 Santiago Rodriguez
²Chuck Stokes
 Diane Watson
 Terry Wymer
 Wally Zoller

Secretary: Sarah Price

Correctional Facilities

²Jim Burke
 Rene Desharnais
 Al George
 John Hughes
 Vail Jenson
 Tom Lawrence
 Norman Litwin
¹Edward Prince

Secretary: Helen Turnquest

1995 International Convention/Regional Forums

Dick Clark
 Hucky Dredhart
 Bob Halvorson
 Chuck Hickson
 Anne Mabery
 Bob McElroy
 Edward Prince
 Ron Sharpe

Secretary: Eileen Gatza

Public Information

Bill Baker
 Conley Byrd
¹Anna Cushman
²Carlos Flores
 Verna Robinson
 Ron Sharpe
 Bob Taylor
 George Wasyluk
 John Wampler

Secretary: Joanie Moncrief

Trustees

Bob Barnes
 Gene Benson
 Pat Dawson
 Greg Gits
 Gene Hughey
 Al Johnson
 Bob McElroy
²Howard Lowery
¹Helen McConnell

Secretary: Susan Ulseth

Ad Hoc Committee on Chips/Medallions

Conley Byrd
 Anna Cushman
 Tom Dougherty
 Carlos Flores
 Jack Griffith

Mark Langsam
 Larry Schlosser
 Ted Stoa
¹Elaine Strome

Secretary: Pat Rosenstiel

1994 CONFERENCE CHAIRPERSONS AND ALTERNATE CHAIRPERSONS

Committee	Chairperson	Alternate
Agenda	Mark Langsam, District of Columbia	Gay Walters, Utah
Cooperation With the Professional Community	Susan Campbell, Virginia	Gary Kluksdahl, Colorado
Correctional Facilities	John Hughes, N. New Jersey	Norman Litwin, N.W. Ontario
Finance	Pete Litano, Nevada	Joan Johnson, S. Wisconsin
Grapevine	Larry Schlosser, British Columbia/Yukon	Don Swallow, E. Ontario
Literature	Hugh Vaughan, Iowa	Cathy Ferrante, N. Indiana
Policy/Admissions	Janice French, Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador	Mike O'Connor, Louisiana
Public Information	Bob Taylor, Connecticut	Conley Byrd, Arkansas
Report and Charter	Burke Dykes, Washington	Tom Dougherty, N. Florida
Treatment Facilities	Wally Zoller, Illinois (Chicago)	Regis Chenard, S.E. Quebec
Committee on Trustees	Bob McElroy, E. Massachusetts	Gene Hughey, W. Missouri

¹ Chairperson

² Alternate Chairperson

1993 Trustees' Committees

Archives

Jan Whitney, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Harold Greene
John King
David O'Leary
George Gordon, Ph.D., *consultant*
Frank Mauser, *secretary*

Conference

Ann Bruning, *chairperson*
Gerry Flegel
Harold Greene
Jacob Ham
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Les Leuthaeuser
Jacqueline Martin
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Pat Rosenstiel, *secretary*

Cooperation With the Professional Community

Marc Pineau, *chairperson*
Peter Brock
John N. Chappel, M.D.
*Dorothy Driscoll
*Anne Geller, M.D.
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Amos Reed
Jane Murphy Schulberg
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
*Ray Stiver
Francine Ward
Valerie O'Neill, *secretary*

Correctional Facilities

David O'Leary, *acting chairperson*
John N. Chappel, M.D.
*Roy Drake, S.J.
Les Leuthaeuser
Amos Reed
*Warren Stafford
*Martha Watson
Helen Turnquest, *secretary*

Finance & Budgetary

Robert Morse, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Peter Brock
Ann Bruning
Harold Greene
Michael McPherson
Greg Muth
Fran Polek
John Quinn
Amos Reed
Stanley Silverman
Jean Smith
Owen Flanagan, C.P.A., *consultant*
Gary Glynn, *consultant*
Dennis Manders, *senior advisor*
Donald Meurer, *secretary*

International

John Quinn, *chairperson*
David O'Leary
Marc Pineau
Amos Reed
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Jan Whitney
Lois Fisher, *secretary*

International Convention / A.A. Regional Forums

Jacqueline Martin, *chairperson*
Gerry Flegel
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Les Leuthaeuser
David O'Leary
Fran Polek
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Jan Whitney
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*
— *International Convention*
Richard Bush, *secretary*
— *Regional Forums*

Literature

Jacob Ham, *chairperson*
Peter Brock
John N. Chappel, M.D.
John King
Michael McPherson
Jacqueline Martin
Fran Polek
Jean Smith
*Richard Steins
Vincina McCarthy, *consultant*
Eleanor Widdoes, *consultant*
John Grant, *secretary*

Nominating

Greg Muth, *chairperson*
Ann Bruning
Jacob Ham
John King
Jacqueline Martin
Robert Morse
Marc Pineau
John Quinn
Stanley Silverman
Jean Smith
Jan Whitney
Susan Ulseth, *secretary*

Public Information

Stanley Silverman, *chairperson*
Bernard Benziger
Isadora Drayton
Jacques Filteau
Gerry Flegel
Sarah Holland
F. Bradley Lynch
John Quinn
Jane Murphy Schulberg
Ben Shapiro
Francine Ward
Joanie Moncrief, *secretary*

Treatment Facilities

John N. Chappel, M.D.,
chairperson
John Dunn
Gerry Flegel
Elaine Johnson, Ph.D.
Joyce King
Les Leuthaeuser
Terry Lindgren
John Hartley Smith, M.D.
Francine Ward
Sarah Price, *secretary*

General Sharing Session

Harold Greene, *chairperson*
Eileen Gatza, *secretary*
All members of the General Service Board, A.A.W.S. and GV Boards, G.S.O. and GV staffs, and trustees' committees participate in this "town meeting."

Michael Alexander and George Dorsey are ex officio members of all committees.



Officers of the General Service Board

Chairperson
Michael Alexander
First vice-chairperson
John King
Second vice-chairperson
John H. Smith, M.D.
Secretary
John Quinn
Treasurer
Robert Morse
Assistant secretary
Eileen Gatza
Assistant treasurer
Donald Meurer

The new slate of officers is given on page 37.

1993 Conference Members

NONALCOHOLIC (CLASS A) TRUSTEES

¹**Michael Alexander** (460 Park Ave., New York, NY 10022) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1988 Conference. Mike served as a trustee from 1976 to 1985, after 20 years as legal advisor to the board. A partner in the law firm of Smith, Steibel, Alexander, and Saskor, he was an associate of the late Bernard Smith—so significant in A.A. history. Mike is a director and past president of the British American Chamber of Commerce, director and national secretary of the Ireland-United States Council for Commerce and Industry, and trustee and past president of the Consular Law Society.

John N. Chappel, M.D. (University of Nevada, School of Medicine, Reno, NV 89557) was elected to the board in 1989. A graduate of the University of Alberta Medical School, John has been professor of psychiatry, University of Nevada School of Medicine since 1974. He serves as consultant to many professional organizations and is widely published in the field of alcoholism. John chairs the Treatment Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Correctional Facilities, and Literature Committees.

²**W.J. (Jim) Estelle, Jr.** (3681 Mesa Verde Dr., El Dorado Hills, CA 95762) was elected chairman of the board at the meeting following the 1993 Conference. Jim was director of the Texas Department of Corrections for 12 years, and brought his background in correctional administration to the board when he served as Class A trustee, 1977–86. Now retired, he is involved in many professional societies on criminal justice and corrections and is on the board of a California service organization that serves the needs of families of indigent jail and prison inmates.



²**Gary A. Glynn** (1112 Park Ave., New York, NY 10128) was elected to the board in April 1993 after serving as a consultant to the trustees' Finance Committee, A.A.W.S.'s Employee's Retirement Committee and the A.A.W.S. Board. A graduate of the Wharton School, University of Pennsylvania, he has been an investment analyst and portfolio manager for over 20 years. Gary is active in various professional organizations and committees.

Elaine M. Johnson, Ph.D. (6631 Hunters Wood Circle, Catonsville, MD 21228) was elected to the board in May 1992. A graduate of Morgan State University, Baltimore, and the University of Maryland, Elaine has a distinguished background in the fields of alcoholism and substance abuse. She has lectured widely, been a consultant to regional and government agencies and published many articles in professional journals. Elaine is acting administrator of the Alcohol, Drug Abuse and Mental Health Administration. She serves on the Conference, Cooperation With the Professional Community, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

John E. King (423 Hawthorn, Fayetteville, AR 72701) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of St. Mary's College, Kentucky, and Tulane University, Louisiana, John was an ordained priest and has a background in social work. Currently, he is on the faculty of the University of Arkansas in the Social Work Program, where he serves as consultant to many local, state, and regional agencies as well as in a treatment capacity. John has received numerous awards and honors for his professional and civic/community service. He serves on the Archives, Literature and Nominating Committees, and on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

¹**Robert P. Morse** (230 Park Ave., 20th Fl., New York, NY 10169) was elected to the board in April 1984 after serving as a consultant to the Finance Committee from April 1981. A graduate of the Wharton School and the University of Pennsylvania, he has over 23 years' experience in the investment business, with an in-depth background in the fixed-income sector and management of equity portfolios. Robert is president of Morse Williams Holding, Inc., investment counselors, and is chairperson of the Wall Street Fund, Inc., a public mutual fund, and a principal in Hambrecht & Quist Group, Inc., San Francisco, investment bankers. He is also treasurer and an executive committee trustee of the Biological Station for Research, Inc., and serves as a director of the Arlington Institute for Policy Research, Inc. in Washington, D.C. He has served as an officer in the U.S. Navy and is an active member of various fraternal and charitable organizations. Robert is treasurer of the General Service Board and chairperson of the Finance & Budgetary Committee; he also is a member of the trustees' Nominating Committee.

Amos E. Reed (2840 Holiday Dr. S., Salem, OR 97302) was elected to the board in April 1986. A graduate of McKendree College and Northern Illinois University, he has extensive background in corrections, education, and public welfare. He is past president of the American Correctional Association, National Association of State Correctional Administrators, and National Association of Training Schools and Juvenile Agencies, and has received many awards for his services in corrections and other agencies. Retired from his position as Washington Secretary of Corrections, Amos has also held leadership positions in North Carolina, Florida, Oregon, and Illinois. He chairs the Correctional Facilities Committee and serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, Finance and Budgetary and International Committees. Amos rotated off the board in April 1993, due to ill health.

John Hartley Smith, M.D. (828 West 10th Ave., Vancouver, BC V5Z 1L8, Canada) was elected to the board in 1986. A graduate of the Queens' University Medical School, Belfast, he has specialized in occupational medicine and public health and has served on many professional committees and advisory councils, both local and national. John has been assistant deputy minister in the British Columbia Ministry of Health since 1979; in 1986 he was appointed senior medical consultant in occupational and environmental health to the government. In 1988 he resigned to do private consulting. He was also a director of the American Board of Preventive Medicine, 1978-87, and is a part-time clinical associate professor in the Faculty of Medicine at the University of British Columbia. John serves on the Cooperation With the Professional Community, the International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

May 1992, is a former Panel 38 delegate. He is a member of the P.I./C.P.C. committee in Humboldt. Gerry has taught in high schools for 29 years. He was a computer and math consultant for three years—and is now back in the classroom. He serves on the Conference, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

Gay Garner (528 Hammet Dr., Decatur, GA 30032) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Gay has also served her area as G.S.R. and D.C.M., and has been active in local P.I./C.P.C. activities. Her professional background is in the entertainment business, management and advertising sales.

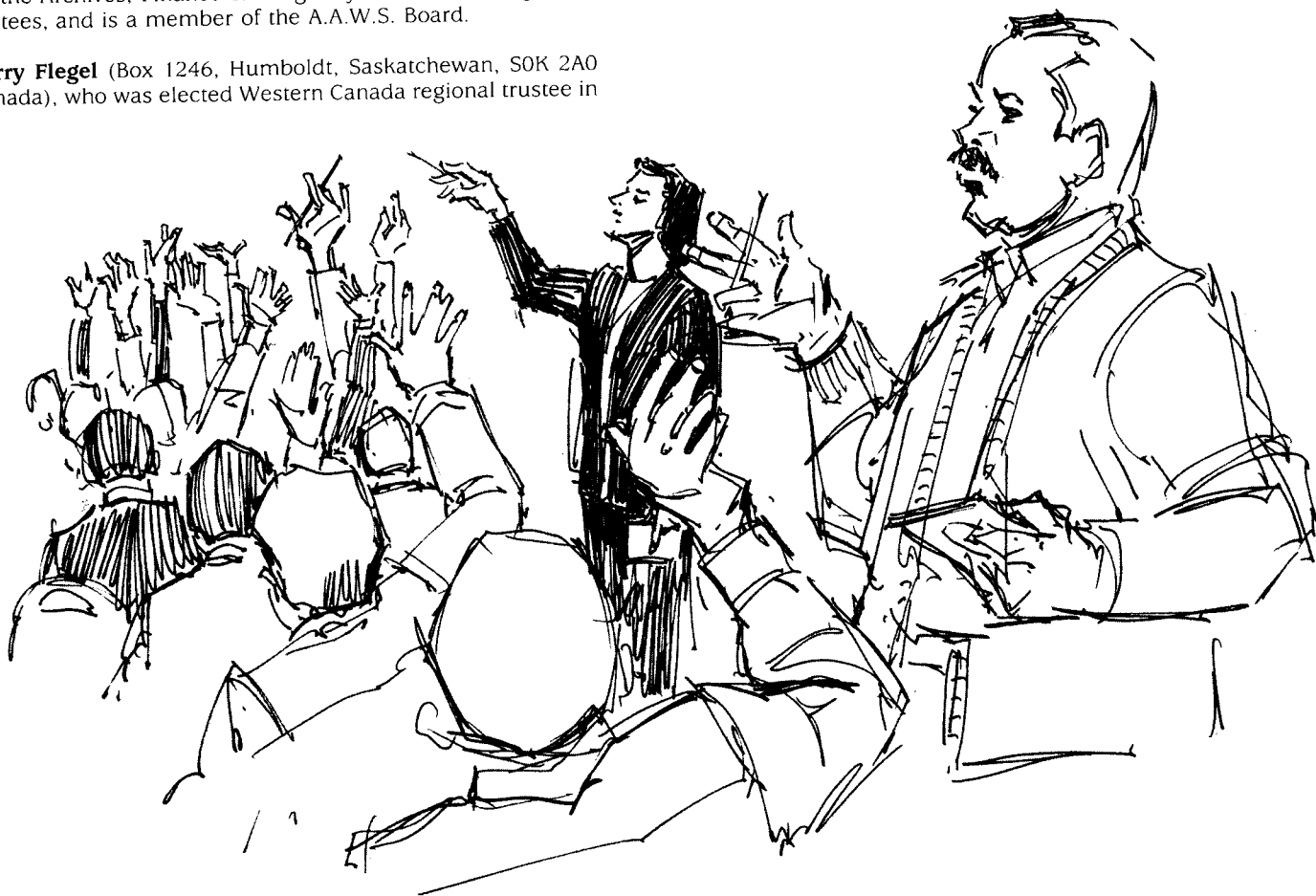
Harold Greene (695 Americana Dr., Annapolis, MD 21403) was elected general service trustee in April 1989. Harold's service commitment began at the group level in Staten Island, N.Y.; he has served as a D.C.M. and as a member of the N.Y. Intergroup Steering Committee. From 1985-88 he was a director on the A.A.W.S. Board. Harold currently heads an agency involved in developing and financing rehabilitation of housing for the homeless. He serves on the Archives, Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

ALCOHOLIC (CLASS B) TRUSTEES

Ann Bruning (10728 Hunters Point Rd., Fort Smith, AR 72903), who was a Panel 37 delegate, was elected Southwest U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Ann has also served her area as G.S.R., area chair, and has been active in P.I. work, mostly in schools. A registered nurse, Ann now works at an in-hospital hospice, and serves on the boards of several community organizations, as well as presenting workshops for various organizations. Ann chairs the Conference Committee and serves on the Archives, Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees, and is a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

Jacob B. "Jake" Ham (RFD 1, Box 1400, Winthrop, ME 04364) was elected Northeast U.S. regional trustee in April 1991. Jake began his service work in California as G.S.R., D.C.M., and H&I coordinator. After returning to his home state of Maine in 1980, he served in similar service jobs, including Maine area chair, and was a Panel 38 delegate. In his spare time, away from his job with a large nationwide corporation, he enjoys carpentry.

Gerry Flegel (Box 1246, Humboldt, Saskatchewan, S0K 2A0 Canada), who was elected Western Canada regional trustee in



gardening and camping. Jake chairs the Literature Committee and serves on the Conference and Nominating Committees, and on the Grapevine Board.

Les Leuthaeuser (1912 Ave. B, Scottsbluff, NE 69361) was elected West Central U.S. regional trustee in May 1992. In service work for over 20 years, Les was a Panel 30 delegate and has served as area chair and area finance committee chair. He is self-employed in the home improvement/repair business. Les serves on the Conference, Correctional Facilities, International Convention/Regional Forums and Treatment Facilities Committees.

²**Michael McPherson** (315 W. 86th St., New York, NY 10024) was elected general service trustee in April 1993. Prior to that Michael was an A.A.W.S. director, where he served as chair for the A.A.W.S. Publications Subcommittee and was a member of the trustees' Finance Committee. He is chief administrative officer for large nonprofit corporation.

Jacqueline (Jackie) Martin (1305 Bluff Springs Ct., Louisville, KY 40223) was elected Southeast regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 30 delegate, Jackie has been active in her area's intergroup and treatment facilities committees. With a background in real estate, Jackie recently went back to school to prepare for a new career in management. She serves on the Conference, Literature and Nominating Committees.

Greg Muth (P.O. Box 30068, Honolulu, HI 96820) was elected Pacific U.S. regional trustee in April 1990. Greg, who has been active from group coffee maker on, served as a Panel 37 delegate, where he chaired the Conference Report and Charter Committee. An executive of a commercial construction company, he is also involved in local community organizations. Greg chairs the Nominating Committee and serves on the Conference and Finance & Budgetary Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Larry Nelson** (192 Elm Ave., Imperial Beach, CA 91932) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1993. A former Panel 38 delegate, Larry has been active in many service activities in his area. He is a pharmacist on the staff of a large health maintenance organization clinic.

David F. O'Leary (37 Wabush Pl., St. John's, NF, Canada A1E 5V5) was elected trustee-at-large/Canada in April 1991. A Panel 35 delegate from Nova Scotia/Newfoundland/Labrador, Dave has remained active in his area, serving on intergroup, convention and institutions committees. He is a maintenance technician with a large corporation. Dave serves on the Archives, Correctional Facilities, International and International Convention/Regional Forums Committees.

Marc Pineau (185 - 14th Ave., Iberville, PQ J2X 1B5, Canada), who was a Panel 36 delegate, was elected Eastern Canada regional trustee in April 1990. He has served as G.S.R., D.C.M. and area secretary and chair. Marc is an engineer with a Canadian corporation, where he has participated in employees' programs, as well as setting up other rehabilitation programs. He chairs the Cooperation With the Professional Community and serves on the International and Nominating Committees. Marc also serves on the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Fran Polek (2301 E. 61st Ave., Spokane, WA 99223) was elected general service trustee in May 1992, after serving four years as a Grapevine director. A Panel 27 delegate, Fran also served

as area chair. During his time as a director, he served as treasurer of the Grapevine Corporate Board and as a member of the trustees' Literature and International Committees. Fran is a university professor, involved in teaching, research, lecturing, and writing. He chairs the Grapevine Corporate Board and serves on the International Convention/Regional Forums and Literature Committees.

¹**John J. Quinn** (66 Brookwood Pkwy., Jackson, NJ 08527) was elected trustee-at-large/U.S. in April 1989. A Panel 35 delegate, he has also served his area as D.C.M., treasurer and area committee member. With a background in accounting, taxation and personnel, John is currently a first vice-president of a major international bank with U.S. headquarters in New York City. He chairs the International Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Nominating and Public Information Committees. He is also a member of the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Jane Murphy Schulberg** (138 E. 38th St., New York, NY 10016) was elected a general service trustee in April 1993, after serving four years as a director on the Grapevine Corporate Board. Jane, who is a producer/writer with a television media house, has been active at many levels of local A.A.

¹**Stanley N. Silverman** (137 E. 36th St., New York, NY 10016), who was elected a general service trustee in April 1989, served on the Grapevine editorial board and later on the Grapevine Corporate Board from 1983-87. During that time he was a member of several trustees' committees, as well as serving as treasurer of the Grapevine. Active at the group level, Stanley is a member of the American Institute of C.P.A.s and the New York State Society of C.P.A.s. He is chairperson of the Public Information Committee and serves on the Finance & Budgetary and Nominating Committees. He is also a member of the Grapevine Corporate Board.

Jean Smith (100 Bank St., New York, NY 10014) was elected general service trustee in April 1990. Jean has served on the Grapevine editorial board and was an A.A.W.S. director from 1987 to 1990, when she served on several trustees' committees. She is a senior vice-president of a publishing company and a division director. Jean serves on the Finance & Budgetary, Literature and Nominating Committees, and is chairperson of the A.A.W.S. Board.

²**Donald Weaver** (1325 Seemore, Kalamazoo, MI 49001) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1993. Don currently chairs a prison meeting and has held many service jobs in his area, including Panel 34 delegate. A landscaper, he is also involved with various community activities.

¹**Jan Whitney** (9700 Avalon Rd., Greenville, MI 48838) was elected East Central regional trustee in April 1989. A Panel 36 delegate, she has served as area secretary, chairperson for the area assembly, and program chair for area conferences. She also served as area Grapevine chairperson. Now retired, Jan's professional background was in business and real estate. She serves on the International, International Convention/Regional Forums and Nominating Committees.

¹ Rotating at the close of the 1993 Conference meeting.

² New trustee, elected by the General Service Board, April 1993.

A.A. World Services Directors

Jean Smith, *chairperson*
 Peter Brock
 Ann Bruning
 George Dorsey
 Eileen Gatz

Harold Greene
 Michael McPherson
 Greg Muth
 John Quinn

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 Cynthia White, *staff assistant*
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Gordon Patrick

Area Delegates

What do panel numbers mean? Delegates to each Conference are made up of two "panels." One is even-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an even year. The other is odd-numbered and includes those elected to start serving in an odd year. The 43rd Conference includes Panel 42 (delegates now serving for their second year) and Panel 43 (new delegates).

UNITED STATES

State	Area no.	Panel	
Alabama/N.W. Florida	1	43	Julie Newton, 1908 Fieldcrest Apts., Dothan, AL 36301
Alaska	2	42	O.B. Culley, Box 783, Soldotna, AK 99669-0783
Arizona	3	42	Bert Kluthe, Box 2669, Camp Verde, AZ 86322
Arkansas	4	43	Conley Byrd, Box 3, Redfield, AR 72132
California Southern	5	43	Mary Ellen Davis, 10248 Mossy Rock Circle, Los Angeles, CA 90077
Northern Coastal	6	43	Diane Watson, 101 W. 24th Ave., #303, San Mateo, CA 94403
Northern Interior	7	42	Bill Cross, 4588 N. Meridian, Fresno, CA 93726
San Diego/Imperial	8	42	Paul Cleary, 2963 Butler St., Oceanside, CA 92054
Mid-Southern	9	42	Jim Clough, 1873 Parkview Circle, Costa Mesa, CA 92627
Colorado	10	43	Gary Kluksdahl, 522 S. Carr St., Lakewood, CO 80226
Connecticut	11	43	Bob Taylor, 239 Jefferson Ave., New London, CT 06320
Delaware	12	42	George Wasylyk, R.R. 3, Box 183-C, P.O. Box 479, Lewes, DE 19958
District of Columbia	13	43	Mark Langsam, 4907 Strathmore Ave., Kensington, MD 20895-1208
Florida North	14	43	Tom Dougherty, 3806 Callo-way Dr., Orlando, FL 32810
S. Florida/ Bahamas/V.I.	15	43	Patrick Dawson, 418 Mayflower Rd., West Palm Beach, FL 33405
Georgia	16	42	Randy Sellers, Rt. 1, Box 346 A, 3605 Minchew Rd., Waycross, GA 31503
Hawaii	17	43	Anne Mabery, 1843 Alewa Dr., Honolulu, HI 96817

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>		<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Idaho	18	42	Carlos Flores, 4842 Cole Rd., Pocatello, ID 83202	Missouri <i>Eastern</i>	38	43	John Verdon, 49 Willow Brook Dr., St. Louis, MO 63146
Illinois <i>Chicago</i>	19	43	Walter (Wally) Zoller, 35591 N. Franklin Ave., Ingleside, IL 60041	<i>Western</i>	39	43	Gene Hughey, 8700 Holmes, Apt. 211, Kansas City, MO 64131
<i>Northern</i>	20	42	Thomas Barlow, 609 Clarke Ave., Waukegan, IL 60085	Montana	40	42	Robert Halvorson, 2104 Rd. 4 North, Huntley, MT 59037
<i>Southern</i>	21	43	William Baker, 4711 W. Main St., Decatur, IL 62522-1060	Nebraska	41	42	Marvin Rumery, 1812 W. Arlington, Lincoln, NE 68522
Indiana <i>Northern</i>	22	43	Cathy Ferrante, 301 Navajo Trail, Lowell, IN 46356	Nevada	42	43	Peter Litano, 155 Leo Dr., Sparks, NV 89436
<i>Southern</i>	23	42	Charles (Chuck) Hickson, 1124 North East St., Lebanon, IN 46052	New Hampshire	43	42	John Sweeney, 8 Donald St., Manchester, NH 03102
Iowa	24	43	Hugh Vaughan, 1624 S. Lake- port St., Sioux City, IA 51106	New Jersey <i>Northern</i>	44	43	John Hughes, 1889 Rt. 9, Bldg. 15, Unit 119, Toms River, NJ 08755
Kansas	25	42	Richard Brummel, 300 N. Cedar, Garnett, KS 66032	<i>Southern</i>	45	42	Jack Layden, 705 Echelon Towers, Voorhees, NJ 08043
Kentucky	26	42	Joseph Sostarich, 2210 Douglas Woods Court, Louisville, KY 40205	New Mexico	46	42	Richard Clark, Box 22536, Santa Fe, NM 87502-2536
Louisiana	27	43	Michael O'Connor, 867 Willow Dr., Shreveport, LA 71118	New York <i>Central</i>	47	43	Charles Burns, RR3, Box 328, Carthage, NY 13619
Maine	28	42	Cena Robbins, Box 1147, Scarborough, ME 04070	<i>Hudson/Mohawk /Berkshire</i>	48	42	Caroline Bradley, 511 E. German St., Herkimer, NY 13350
Maryland	29	42	John Curtin, 11510 Georgia Ave., #225, Wheaton, MD 20902	<i>Southeast</i>	49	43	Denise Bell, 245 Bennett Ave., 4E, New York, NY 10040
Massachusetts <i>Eastern</i>	30	43	Robert McElroy, Box F, Raynham, MA 02767	<i>Western</i>	50	42	Terry Wymer, 824 N. Union St., Olean, NY 14760
<i>Western</i>	31	42	Thomas Lawrence, 34 C St. Kolbe Dr., Holyoke, MA 01040	North Carolina	51	43	Ronald Sharpe, 456 Home- stead Dr., Fayetteville, NC 28303-2609
Michigan <i>Central</i>	32	43	Alfred George, 515 N. Butler Blvd., Lansing, MI 48915	North Dakota	52	42	Vail Jensen, 1016 Arthur Lane, Minot, ND 58701
<i>Southeast</i>	33	43	Samuel Reams, 17405 Pershing, Livonia, MI 48152-3822	Ohio <i>Central & Southeast</i>	53	43	Shaaron Johnson, 1584 S. Southfield Dr. So., Columbus, OH 43207
<i>Western</i>	34	42	Anna (Cush) Cushman, Box 2691, Kalamazoo, MI 49003-2691	<i>Northeast</i>	54	43	Emery (Al) Johnson, 21795 North Lane, Oakwood Village, OH 44146
Minnesota <i>Northern</i>	35	42	Gregory Gits, Box 753, Bemidji, MN 56601-0753	<i>N.W. Ohio/S.E. Mich.</i>	55	42	Vivien Gerten, 323 Ridge St. S., Willard, OH 44890
<i>Southern</i>	36	43	Esther Hall, 7503 W. Shore Dr., Edina, MN 55435	One Conference member left the general session for a cold drink. Caught up in the hype of the Conference he returned with a glass full of ice but no drink. It would never have happened in the old days!			
Mississippi	37	42	Howard Lowery, 808 Highway, 98 Bypass, Box 684, Columbia, MS 39429				

<u>State</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
<i>Southwest</i>	56	42	Dian Wright, 450 Wilson Rd., Troy, OH 45373
Oklahoma	57	43	Gene Benson, 2529 W. Eubanks, Oklahoma City, OK 73112
Oregon	58	42	Helen McConnell, 8480 S.W. Cecelia Terrace, Portland, OR 97223
Pennsylvania <i>Eastern</i>	59	45	Hugo McKissic, Box 27729, Philadelphia, PA 19118-0729
<i>Western</i>	60	45	Lois Concelman, 418 Santa Rosa Lane, Pittsburgh, PA 15237
Rhode Island	61	42	MaryJane Roy, 65 Narragansett Ave., Narragansett, RI 02882
South Carolina	62	42	*George Rollins, 2864 Kirkover Dr., Lancaster, SC 29720
South Dakota	63	42	Ted Stoa, 402 S. Kline St., Aberdeen, SD 57401
Tennessee	64	42	John Wampler, 505 E. Scott Ave., Knoxville, TN 37917
Texas <i>Northeast</i>	65	43	Davis Tolleson, 702 Common St., Jefferson, TN 75657
<i>Northwest</i>	66	42	Robert Barnes, 19 Concord Rd., San Angelo, TX 76903
<i>Southeast</i>	67	43	Russell Cook, Box 1972, La Porte, TX 77572
<i>Southwest</i>	68	42	Jim Burke, 5439 Vista Trail Dr., San Antonio, TX 78248
Utah	69	43	Gay Walters, 963 Henderson Dr., #8, Ogden, UT 84404
Vermont	70	42	Harold Douse, Box 283, Milton, VT 05468
Virginia	71	43	Susan Campbell, 4405 W. Franklin St., Richmond, VA 23221
Washington	72	43	Burke Dykes, 4071 SW Holgate St., Seattle, WA 98116
West Virginia	73	43	Johnathan (Jon) Mason, 402 Palmer Dr., Parkersburg, WV 26104
Wisconsin <i>N. Wisconsin/ Up. Pen. Mich.</i>	74	42	Chuck Stokes, 133 W. Grant Ave., Eau Claire, WI 54701
<i>Southern</i>	75	43	Joan Johnson, 1905 Melody Lane, Brookfield, WI 53005
Wyoming	76	42	Wayne Reed, Box 97, Guernsey, WY 82214
Puerto Rico	77	42	Santiago (Chago) Rodriguez, 20 St. Block 52, #2 Santa Rosa, Bayamon, PR 00959

CANADA

<u>Province</u>	<u>Area no.</u>	<u>Panel</u>	
Alberta / Northwest Territories	78	42	Elaine Strome, 9 Elizabeth Dr., Ft. Saskatchewan, AB T8L 2M2
British Columbia / Yukon	79	43	Larry Schlosser, 310-5454 Balsam St., Vancouver, BC V6M 4B4
Manitoba	80	42	Edward Prince, 62 Jemima Bay, Selkirk, MB R1A 0E2
New Brunswick / Prince Edward Island	81	42	Melvin Larkin, 20 Vista Dr., Charlottetown, PEI C1A 3J9
Nova Scotia / Newfoundland / Labrador	82	43	Janice French, 99 Craigmillar Ave., St. John's, NF A1E 1Z9
Ontario <i>Eastern</i>	83	43	J. Don Swallow, 209 E. Craig Henry Dr., Nepean, ON K2G 4B6
<i>Northeast</i>	84	43	Harold (Hucky) Dredhart, 38 Pine St. N., Ste. 109, Timmins, ON P4N 6K6
<i>Northwest</i>	85	43	Norman Litwin, Box 184, Balmerton, ON P0V 1C0
<i>Western</i>	86	42	John (Jack) Griffith, 1024 Ferrier Ave., LeFroy, ON L0L 1W0
Quebec <i>Southwest</i>	87	42	Georges Bellefeuille, 7375 Roi Rene, Anjou, PQ H1K 3G7
<i>Southeast</i>	88	43	Regis Chenard, 76 Rue Delage, Riviere du Loup, PQ G5R 3P8
<i>Northeast</i>	89	43	Rene Desharnais, 611-A, St. Wilbrod St., Hebertville Station, PQ G0W 1T0
<i>Northwest</i>	90	42	Michel Girard, 67 Boul Aubert, Repentigny, PQ J6A 4N9
Saskatchewan	91	42	Verna Robinson, 1424 Ninth Ave. N., Saskatoon, SK S7K 2Z5

